CHAGEE

# CHAGEE SINGAPORE

## THE OPPORTUNI-TEA — UNLOCKING GROWTH AT CHAGEE SG WITH AI

OPIM639 · GROUP 3 · KEZIAH, JIN, AYUMI, REVAN · OCTOBER 2026



SPEAKER NOTES · TITLE

Good morning. We are Group 3. Our company is Chagee in Singapore, and our story has three solutions: online retailing, matching each online order with a convenient pickup; in-store management, serving that demand well at the counter; and new store expansion, opening where customers are underserved.

Each solution has its own decision-maker: the digital commerce manager with operations, the operations manager or outlet GM, and the expansion manager. After the close, an optional extension on Australia and an appendix hold the detail for questions.

Timing: title and agenda together, about twenty seconds.

AGENDA

# Spilling the Tea

01 **Introduction**
Chagee Singapore, our scope and why

02 **Executive Summary and Business Plan**
Two key challenges and one strategic decision

03–07 **Our Business Recommendations**
Online retailing · in-store management · new store expansion

08 **Execution Plan**
Three pilots and when to proceed

\+ **Business Impact**
What the plan is worth, in our model · appendix, draft

09 **Q & A**

\+ **Appendix**
Earlier slides (data trail, scope, membership), derivations, tables and sources; the Australia extension comes just before it



SPEAKER NOTES · AGENDA

Not presented: go straight from the title to the introduction. For reference: the introduction and the executive summary; our recommendations as three solutions, each with its decision-maker (online retailing for the digital commerce manager with operations, in-store management for the operations manager or outlet GM, new store expansion for the expansion manager); the execution plan, which is our recommendation slide with the pilots and when to proceed; and Q&A. Business impact has no main slide yet: the line opens the draft in the appendix. The Australia extension sits after Q&A, just before the appendix, which now also holds the data trail, the earlier scope slide and the membership chapter. Click any line to jump there.

# Today, we're presenting Chagee

A tea brand most of you know: order in the app, collect at the counter, or have it delivered to your location.



## Our scope

### Chagee Singapore's management and its customers

Outlets are **company-owned, not franchised**, so the counter, roster and equipment are Chagee's own calls.

## Why Chagee?

1. **Many stores, managed by one company**, one data system, with lots of data appendix →
2. **App-centric**: collects personal and transactional data
3. **Fast-growing, playful**: rapid expansion, room for improvements with AI
4. **An insider's view**: we were fortunate to interview a staff member (anonymous )

FROM FARM TO CUP · OUR PROJECT FOCUS IS DOWNSTREAM

**Source**
Yunnan tea; local milk and fruit

**Warehouse**
Restocking from forecasts

Upstream data and decisions sit with **Chagee corporate**

**Outlets**
Make and hand over

via Chagee App

**Last mile**
Collection or delivery

Downstream data is analysed and decisions are made by **Chagee SG** (APAC HQ)

OUR FOCUS | The downstream operational challenges: some of the most pressing issues for Chagee Singapore's management.

## SPEAKER NOTES · CHAGEE SINGAPORE AND OUR SCOPE

Today we are presenting Chagee: a tea brand most of you know. Order in the app and collect at the counter, or have it delivered; the app is for ordering ahead, and delivery goes through third-party apps such as Grab (anonymous Chagee source).

Our scope is Chagee Singapore, its management and customers. Singapore outlets are company-owned, not franchised, as our project owner confirmed, so the counter, roster and equipment are Chagee's own decisions. If asked: group-wide, about 88% of FY 2025 net revenue came from franchising (secondary source); that is global context, not Singapore.

Why Chagee: many stores under one company and one data system (anonymous Chagee source); app-centric: an order-ahead, self-pickup app (App Store listing), in-app ordering after the reopening queues (Vulcan Post), and personal and transactional data collected (Form 20-F, FY 2025); fast-growing and playful, with room for AI. The app's share of Singapore orders, and whether searches or location are logged, are to confirm. And we interviewed a Chagee staff member, who asked not to be named.

Farm to cup: tea comes from Yunnan through standard channels, only fresh milk and fruit are local (YF Chuhai), and restocking is planned from forecasts (Form 20-F). Downstream, the outlet makes each cup and the app links it to collection or delivery; which of these Chagee records is to confirm. Upstream sits with Chagee corporate; downstream is analysed and decided by Chagee Singapore, so that is our focus. Caution: this split, and the APAC HQ label, come from our team's storyboard with no public source; confirm before presenting.

So we focus on the downstream operational challenges. That leads into the executive summary. About one minute.

# Our business plan to solve Chagee's problem statements



CASE STUDY · OUR INTERVIEW

"Mei"

**Membership Operations · APAC, Chagee**

Persona: name changed, interviewee anonymised

WHAT MEI TOLD US

Through the interview, we learnt about Chagee's **business model**, its **local operations**, and some of its most **pressing concerns and strategic needs**, which AI could potentially help solve.

TWO KEY CHALLENGES + ONE STRATEGIC DECISION POINT

KEY CHALLENGE

## Online retailing

Use data for better sales, customer loyalty and cost management. Customer management and reduction of wastage.

PROPOSAL 1 · OUR TEAM

AI-enabled demand management: offer customers an outlet with room, and recommend delivery actions for managers to approve

slides 03 to 05 →

DECISION-MAKER

**Digital commerce manager, with operations**

KEY CHALLENGE

## In-store management

A faster, smoother counter: in-store operations management for shorter waits and a crew matched to demand.

PROPOSAL 2 · OUR TEAM

As toppings come in, test whether a bucket brigade lets the same crew absorb the extra work, before adding dedicated staff or equipment

appendix exploration →

DECISION-MAKER

**Operations manager / outlet GM**

STRATEGIC EXPANSION DECISION

## New store openings

Where to open next, so a new store is profitable and adds customers instead of moving them.

PROPOSAL 3 · OUR TEAM

Identify underserved search clusters, evaluate candidate locations and assess net additional demand and financial outcomes

slides 06 and 07 →

DECISION-MAKER

**Expansion manager**

SPEAKER NOTES · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Our business plan starts from Chagee's own problem statements. We interviewed a member of Chagee's Membership Operations team for APAC, shown here as a persona, "Mei": the name is changed and the interviewee asked not to be cited openly.

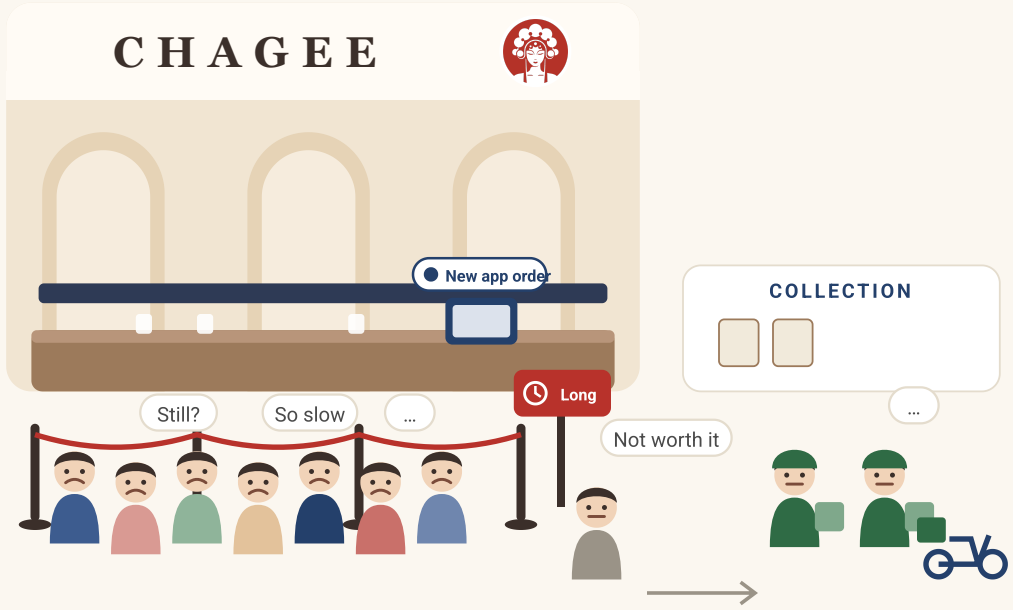
Through the interview, we learnt about Chagee's business model, its local operations, and some of its most pressing concerns and strategic needs, which AI could potentially help solve.

We frame them as two key challenges and one strategic decision point. Challenge one, online retailing: using data for better sales, customer loyalty and cost management, through customer management and reducing wastage. Challenge two, in-store management: a faster, smoother counter, through in-store operations management for shorter waits and a crew matched to demand. And the strategic decision: new store openings, where to open next so a new store is profitable and adds customers rather than moving them from nearby outlets.

The top of each column is what we heard; the shaded part below is our team's proposal, not something Chagee asked for, with its decision-maker in green. Solution one, online retailing: AI-enabled demand management, offering customers an outlet with room and recommending delivery actions for managers to approve, for the digital commerce manager with operations. Solution two, in-store management: as toppings come in, a possible menu change we still need to confirm with Chagee, test whether a bucket brigade lets the same crew absorb the extra work before adding dedicated staff or equipment, for the operations manager or outlet GM. Solution three, new store expansion: identify underserved search clusters, evaluate candidate locations and assess net additional demand and financial outcomes, for the expansion manager. We do not address wastage in this deck; the membership-squad analysis is in the appendix. We walk through them in this order next. About forty-five seconds.

# Proposal 1: AI-enabled demand management

**KEY CHALLENGE** Demand management: crowded outlets lose sales, and the customer experience suffers.




## WHAT IT COSTS CHAGEE TODAY · click a point, a person or the counter

### Drop-offs
Customers see the wait and leave without ordering.

### Crowding
Those who stay crowd the outlet, so it sells less and delivery orders slow down.

### Long waits
Customers wait longer than they expected; the experience suffers.

### Delivery orders arrive blind
Delivery customers cannot see the in-store queue, so orders keep arriving and riders wait at the counter.

### Congestion undermines the store experience
Chagee's stores are part of the brand; a frustrated crowd at the door undoes the experience they are built for.

## With AI, this could change

PROPOSED OUTCOMES, NOT MEASURED CHAGEE RESULTS

- ✓ **More orders retained** — demand spread across nearby outlets instead of lost
- ✓ **A better customer experience** — faster, well-managed collection
- ✓ **Calmer counters** — riders do not wait long or crowd the counter

SPEAKER NOTES · WHEN AN OUTLET IS SWAMPED

Proposal one starts with a problem every Chagee customer has seen: at the peak, one outlet is swamped while another nearby has room. The scene is an illustration, not observed data; treat the points as a problem to investigate with Chagee.

Click Next through five points; each lights up its part of the scene. One, drop-offs: a customer checks the wait and walks away, a sale lost before it is placed. Two, crowding: those who stay crowd the outlet, so it sells less and delivery orders slow down. Three, long waits: customers wait longer than they expected. Four, delivery orders arrive blind: delivery customers cannot see the queue, so orders keep arriving and riders wait by the collection shelf. Five, congestion undermines the in-store experience the brand is built on. Click a person or the counter for a short explanation; Pause stops the motion.

The last Next shows what could change with AI: more orders retained, a better customer experience and calmer counters. These are proposed outcomes, not measured Chagee results. About forty-five seconds.

# From Chagee's data to better-balanced demand

**THE SOLUTION** Predictive AI recommends, generative AI explains, and people decide.

### 1 Data flows in

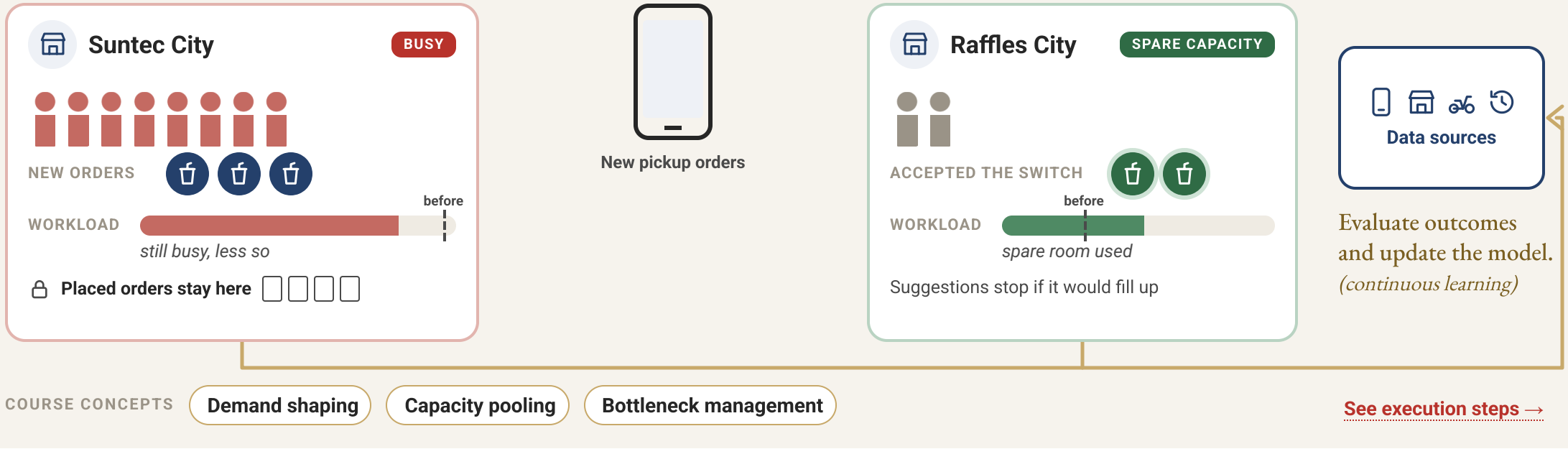
App and sales, outlet operations, delivery apps and past outcomes feed one planning workspace. Only orders by outlet and time are recorded today; the rest is access to confirm.

### 2 AI recommends; people decide

A predicted wait crossing an illustrative trigger prompts the proposal "Offer a nearby outlet with available capacity". Generative AI explains it; the customer accepts or keeps the pickup, and the zone manager approves or declines any delivery pause or promotion.

### 3 Demand is better distributed

Some new orders move to the outlet with room; placed orders stay. Outcomes are logged to evaluate and update the model.




COURSE CONCEPTS **Demand shaping** **Capacity pooling** **Bottleneck management**

See execution steps →

**TAKEAWAY** | Help customers find convenient options while making better use of nearby capacity.

Expected outcomes to test in the pilot, not a promised increase in sales or profit.

SPEAKER NOTES · HOW THE SOLUTION WORKS

How the solution works, in three steps; Next, Previous and Replay drive it, and the small i icons open the detail. Step one, data flows in. Four sources feed one planning workspace: app and sales, meaning orders, customer location and drink margins; outlet operations, meaning open orders, crew and machines; delivery apps, meaning delivery orders and rider waits; and past outcomes, meaning earlier recommendations, decisions and results. Only orders by outlet and time are recorded today, as far as we know; location needs the customer's permission, and the rest needs access or logging that Chagee would have to confirm.

Step two, AI recommends and people decide. The busy outlet's predicted wait rises and crosses the trigger; the forty minutes is the reference example, an illustrative setting, not a validated rule. Predictive AI proposes one thing: offer a nearby outlet with available capacity. Generative AI only explains that in plain words; it does not add figures or reasons. Then people decide: the customer accepts or keeps the original pickup, and the zone manager approves or declines any delivery pause or promotion.

Step three, demand is better distributed. A few new orders go to the outlet with room, others keep their choice, and orders already placed stay where they were placed. The busy outlet is still busy, just less so. Every decision and outcome goes back to the data, to evaluate it and update the model. The course ideas: demand shaping, capacity pooling, limited by travel, delivery coverage and willingness to switch, and bottleneck management. The takeaway: help customers find convenient options while making better use of nearby capacity. These are outcomes to test in the pilot, not promised sales. Then try the customer experience on the next slide. About one minute.

# From Chagee's data to demand spread across outlets

An AI agent uses predictive AI to recommend, generative AI explains, and people make the final call.

## 1 The data

What Chagee collects, or could collect

**Chagee app & sales**
Orders by outlet and time · Customer location · Margin per drink

**Outlet operations**
Live queue of open orders · Crew on shift · # of machines

**Delivery apps**
Delivery orders · Rider waits

**Historical events**
Decisions made · Profitability outcomes

## 2 Proposed AI agent

Trigger, recommend, decide, with guardrails

TRIGGER

**Wait runs long**
A store's wait is, or is about to go, above 40 min.

AI AGENT

**Recommend outlet, action, incentive**
Predictive AI on live store data and patterns learnt from past decisions, within approved rules.

PEOPLE DECIDE

**Customers and managers choose**
Generative AI explains each recommendation; they accept or decline.

## 3 What it does

Example of actions at peak, and it keeps learning

**Offers a faster outlet**
Routes pickups to the outlet that can hand over sooner.

**Recommends a delivery pause**
Recommends pausing third-party delivery orders and redirecting demand; the zone manager reviews and approves.

CONTINUOUS LEARNING

**Gets smarter over time**
Every new decision and its outcome feed back in, so future decisions keep improving.

THE OPERATIONS IDEAS BEHIND IT

| | |
|---|---|
| Demand shaping | moving demand strategically |
| Capacity pooling | with nearby outlets |
| Reducing bottlenecks | dynamically |

KEY BENEFITS

- ✓ **Balances the zone**, thereby increasing sales
- ✓ **Learns from past decisions and live data from stores** to raise profit while enhancing customer experience

SPEAKER NOTES · PROPOSAL 1: HOW IT WORKS

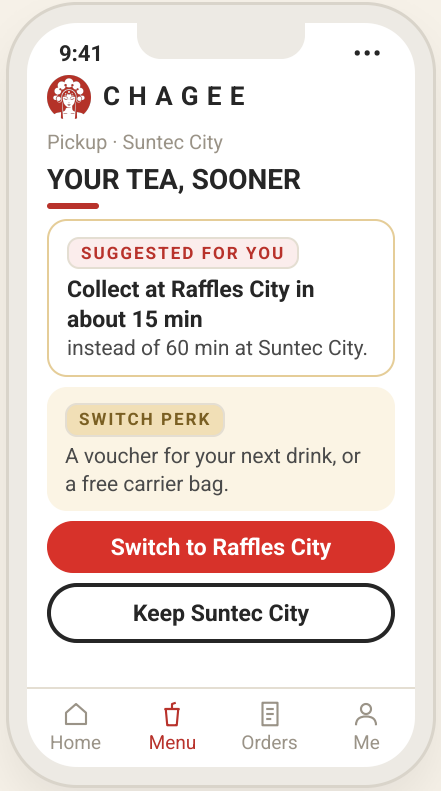
A one-page summary of Proposal 1. The data: Chagee's app and sales, outlet operations, delivery apps and historical events, meaning decisions made and their profitability outcomes. The proposed AI agent: a trigger when a store's wait is, or is about to go, above 40 minutes, an illustrative setting; predictive AI recommends an outlet, an action and an incentive within approved rules; generative AI explains it, and customers and managers accept or decline.

What it does at the peak: offers a faster outlet for pickups, and recommends a delivery pause that the zone manager reviews and approves. Every decision and its outcome feed back in, so the model keeps learning. The operations ideas: demand shaping, capacity pooling with nearby outlets, and reducing bottlenecks dynamically. The benefits we expect, to be tested in the pilot: a better-balanced zone and more sales, and higher profit with a better customer experience. About thirty seconds.

# Customers get a faster outlet; managers approve delivery actions

**ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO** Suntec City is swamped and Raffles City, nearby, has room. The outlets are the reference deck's example; every time is illustrative.

## PICKUP · CHAGEE APP




### A faster outlet, offered

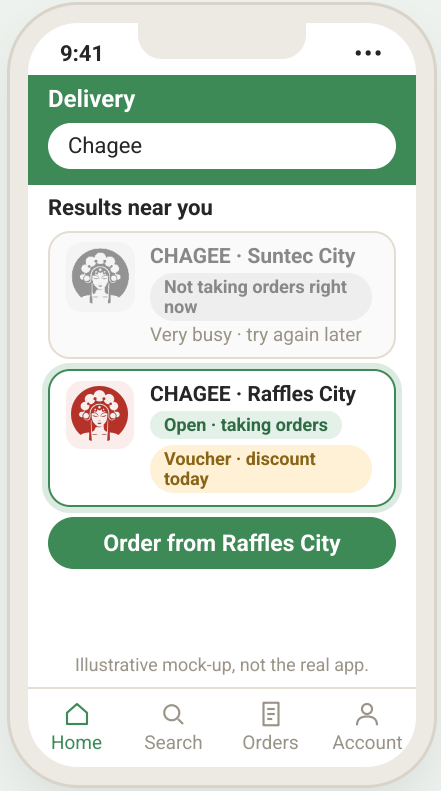
Suntec City is swamped, so the app suggests Raffles City and explains why.

**45 min sooner**
collect in about 15 min instead of 60, walk included

**DYNAMIC PRICING**
A voucher or a carrier bag nudges and rewards the switch, offered only while Suntec City is swamped.

**Customer chooses** before paying.

## DELIVERY · E.G. GRABFOOD




### The busy outlet steps back

The agent recommends pausing Suntec City on delivery apps and redirecting demand; the zone manager reviews and approves.

**Orders flow to Raffles City**
no riders stuck at the busy counter

**DYNAMIC PRICING**
Instead of closing Suntec City on delivery altogether, a voucher at Raffles City can draw demand to the outlet with room.

**Zone manager approves** the pause and redirection. Placed orders stay put; platform permissions to confirm.

SPEAKER NOTES · THE CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE

What the customer sees, in two channels; switch with the toggle. Pickup, in the Chagee app: the customer near Suntec City sees their outlet and an estimated collection time, a suggested alternative at Raffles City with its collection time, including the walk, and an optional switch incentive. Choose Switch outlet or Keep my outlet: the confirmation and both outlets' workload update. The customer chooses before paying. Tick the fill-up box: once Raffles City is busy too, the saving falls below the approved minimum and the suggestion is withdrawn.

Delivery, in an illustrative third-party app: the agent's recommendation goes to the zone manager first, who can approve a temporary pause at the busy outlet, promote the alternative outlet instead, or decline. Only then does the customer-facing screen change. Orders already placed are not moved, customers are free to order elsewhere or not at all, and the platform, not Chagee, controls its ranking; platform integration and permissions are requirements to confirm.

See execution steps opens the plan: confirm data access and instrument outcomes, run in shadow mode, pilot customer choices and manager-approved actions, then evaluate before scaling, on the online roadmap's phases and gates. The same steps are printed in the appendix. Every time here is an illustrative scenario from the reference deck, not Chagee data. Then the transition: with orders sent to an outlet with room, where should the next outlet be? About one minute.

# Open where an outlet adds customers, not where it moves them

**BUSINESS PROBLEM** Chagee needs to identify locations with sufficient additional demand and attractive economics: a new outlet may look successful while mostly moving sales from nearby stores. Context Chagee aims to expand rapidly in Singapore; the number of stores is confidential (Chagee source, anonymous). Simulated searches below.

## 1 WHO

### Where should we open next?



Which location brings us new customers?
HEAD OF EXPANSION

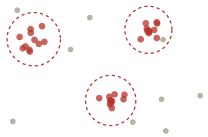
- **A** **Beside an existing outlet**: its sales may come from the store next door.
- **B** **Near underserved customers**: people searching with no outlet nearby.

The manager needs to compare locations, customer access and potential sales—not rely on intuition alone.

## 2 WHAT

### Bring the signals together

- **App searches and unmet demand** — IN THIS DEMO · SYNTHETIC
- **Existing outlets and historical orders** — IN THIS DEMO
- **Residents, workers and transit access** — PROPOSED · NEEDS DATA ACCESS
- **Footfall and nearby competitors** — PROPOSED · NEEDS DATA ACCESS
- **Area delivery demand, if available** — PROPOSED · NEEDS DATA ACCESS
- **Rent and operating costs** — ASSUMED VALUES · P&L VIEW



**DBSCAN**: unsupervised machine learning that finds dense groups of searches. These clusters suggest locations to investigate. A separate demand model estimates sales and how much would shift from nearby outlets.

## 3 RESULT

### Compare the options. Make the call.

This site looks promising. Let's compare the assumptions and downside before we commit.
HEAD OF EXPANSION



**Site comparison** synthetic app data · our assumptions

NET ADDITIONAL CUPS A DAY FOR CHAGEE

- **B** +731 cluster near Choa Chu Kang
- **A** +216 beside 34 · West Mall

SALES MOVED FROM NEARBY OUTLETS

**B** 106 of the 837 cups it sells · **A** 64% of its 604

DEMAND, DELIVERY AND COMPETITION hand-set scores, illustrative pin (appendix)

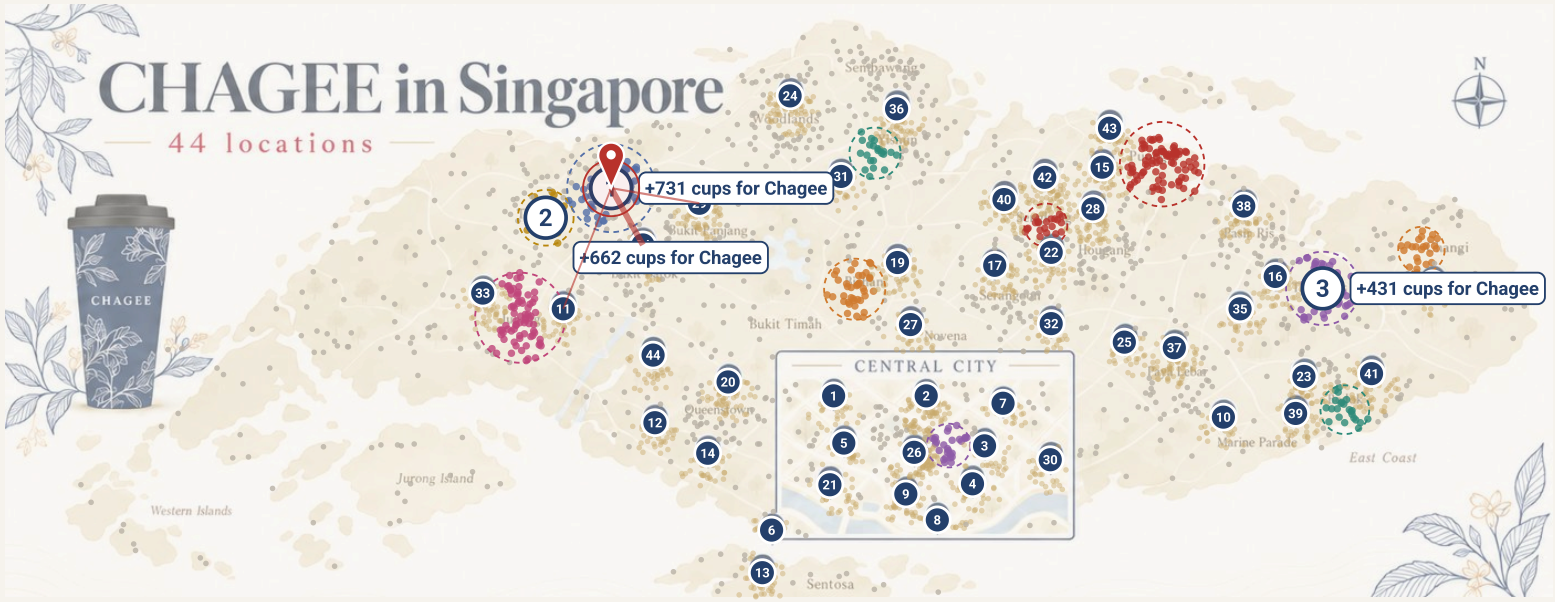
Demand | Delivery | Competition

An AI-assisted dashboard helps the team make an evidence-informed decision. The manager makes the final call.

# Open where an outlet adds customers, not where it moves them

**BUSINESS PROBLEM** Chagee needs to identify locations with sufficient additional demand and attractive economics: a new outlet may look successful while mostly moving sales from nearby stores. Context Chagee aims to expand rapidly in Singapore; the number of stores is confidential (Chagee source, anonymous). Simulated searches below.

NEW-STORE FORECAST




**SUGGESTED SITE 1 · 2.7 KM FROM 34 · WEST MALL**

**Strong site: mostly new cups**

+731 cups a day for Chagee

The new store sells 837 a day (1.5× an average outlet). 106 of those move from outlets nearby:

| | |
|---|---|
| 34 · West Mall, 2.7 km | −77 |
| 29 · Bukit Panjang Plaza, 3.3 km | −28 |

Peak hour 13:00: **92 cups** → **2 people** on today's counter (counter pages, appendix).

Synthetic app data on the team's map; outlet positions approximate (the central inset is enlarged). Not a trained model: the point is the method. Its five-year P&L: appendix.

**TAKEAWAY** | Judge a site by the cups it adds to Chagee, not the cups it sells: the cluster near Choa Chu Kang adds about **+731** a day; beside an existing outlet, the same store adds **+216**.

SPEAKER NOTES · PREDICT DEMAND FOR A NEW STORE

Solution three, new store expansion. The business problem: Chagee needs locations with enough additional demand and attractive economics. It has two sides: a new outlet can look successful while mostly moving sales from the stores around it, and customers elsewhere may have no convenient outlet at all. Context, from a Chagee source who asked not to be named: Chagee is looking to expand rapidly in Singapore, and how many stores it is going for is confidential. Chagee Singapore runs on its app, with few kiosks. If Chagee logs searches and their location, which we have to confirm, every search is a demand signal, including searches where no store is close. Here the searches are synthetic. That makes the app the forecasting input for a new store, before it has any sales.

Step one: synthetic app sessions on our map. Gold are within walking distance of an outlet; red found no store nearby. Step two: DBSCAN, unsupervised machine learning, groups red searches that are dense; scattered ones are noise. Step three: cluster centres are candidate sites.

Step four: click the map to test a site. The card leads with the gain for Chagee, which is the store's sales minus the cups it takes from nearby outlets, and gives a verdict: strong, mixed, or mostly moving cups. Try a pin next to Tampines West CC: it sells, but most of it moves from the two Tampines outlets nearby. Step five: the forecast's peak hour gives the opening roster for the counter pages in the appendix.

If asked how DBSCAN works, press How it works: it replays the algorithm one search at a time on a toy set. The appendix lists every simulated number.

The three sliders are the only inputs: cluster radius, minimum searches per cluster, and how far people will walk. The data is synthetic; with Chagee's real app logs, the same steps would run unchanged. About one and a half minutes.

# Investigate the site that adds customers, then check the downside

THE SAME NEW OUTLET AT TWO SITES · SYNTHETIC APP DATA · FIVE YEARS, OUR ASSUMPTIONS

| CRITERION | BESIDE 34 · WEST MALL<br>OUR ASSUMED BASELINE | CLUSTER NEAR CHOA CHU KANG<br>DBSCAN + DEMAND MODEL |
|---|---|---|
| Customer access: cups from people with no outlet within walking distance | 47% | **98%** |
| Cups a day the store sells | 604 | 837 |
| Net additional cups a day, after cups moved from nearby outlets | +216 | **+731** |
| Incremental operating profit, five years, base volume | −S$0.6m | **S$1.9m** |
| Investment at opening | S$0.4m | S$0.5m incl. AI share |
| Payback | not within 5 years | about 1.4 years |
| Downside: low volume, five years | −S$1.2m | S$0.03m, not paid back in 5 years |
| Upside: high volume, five years | −S$0.2m | S$3.6m |

DBSCAN only finds where unserved searches gather; a separate demand model, on our assumptions, estimates sales. Synthetic searches. Operating profit before depreciation, interest and tax, after the contribution lost at nearby outlets. Every input and year: appendix, Expand.

MANAGER'S DECISION
**Expansion manager**

**Which location should we investigate or pilot next?**

PROPOSED

Investigate the cluster near Choa Chu Kang: rerun the method on Chagee's app logs before any lease or pilot.

PROCEED IF, ON REAL DATA

- most of its cups come from customers without convenient access
- net additional cups, not moved cups, carry the case
- profit covers the investment, with an acceptable downside

NEXT Our recommendation: three managers, three pilots.

SPEAKER NOTES · THE EXPANSION MANAGER'S DECISION

The decision for solution three belongs to the expansion manager: which location should we investigate or pilot next? The solution: identify underserved search clusters, evaluate candidate locations, and assess net additional demand and financial outcomes. The test: do its expected incremental returns justify the investment?

The table puts the same new outlet at two sites and reads down the criteria. Customer access: about 98% of the cluster site's cups come from people with no outlet within walking distance, against 47% beside the existing outlet. Net additional demand: about 731 cups a day against 216. Incremental operating profit over 5 years: about S$1.9m against −S$0.6m, on S$0.5m invested, paying back in about 1.4 years. Then the downside: at low volume the cluster site makes about S$0.03m and does not pay back within 5 years.

Say it plainly: DBSCAN does not predict sales or profit. It finds where unserved searches gather; a separate demand model, on our assumptions, estimates sales and cannibalisation, and the searches are synthetic. So the proposal is to investigate, not to open: rerun the method on Chagee's app logs before any lease. For a new market without app history, external area features and demand scenarios stand in: the optional extension after the close. About fifty seconds.

If asked about existing outlets, press What about existing outlets? on the table. The same network view can investigate locations Chagee already has: select an outlet and explore it being temporarily unavailable. The same demand model, run in reverse, shows how much of its demand nearby outlets might keep, how much Chagee might lose, how far customers would travel and how much extra work lands on the receiving outlets. Say clearly: it is an illustrative scenario, not a closure recommendation. The manager's question is whether the location needs operational improvement, relocation or a deeper consolidation review, and that needs costs actually avoided, lease and exit costs, customers' willingness to switch, nearby capacity and service levels, and the store's

08 · OUR RECOMMENDATION

# Three managers, three pilots, each judged on its own evidence

*A connected story, not one combined model: no simulated benefit is carried between parts or added up.*

ONLINE RETAILING · DIGITAL COMMERCE MANAGER

## Where should peak demand go?

RECOMMEND

Pilot AI-enabled demand management in one zone: shadow mode first, then customer choices and manager-approved delivery actions, over the online roadmap's three phases.

PROCEED IF

at Gate 2, collection is faster, walk-aways fall, support outlets stay reliable and incremental contribution after incentives is positive, against normal checkout.

IN-STORE MANAGEMENT · OPERATIONS MANAGER / OUTLET GM

## How should that outlet fulfil it?

RECOMMEND

As toppings launch, trial a bucket brigade against fixed responsibilities in 3 outlets, with a topping-share forecast in shadow mode.

PROCEED IF

order-to-ready time and orders completed hold as topping share rises, with the same crew; if not, cost dedicated topping staff or equipment.

EXPAND ACCESS · EXPANSION MANAGER

## Which location justifies investment?

RECOMMEND

Investigate the cluster near Choa Chu Kang on Chagee's real app logs before any lease.

PROCEED IF

it adds net new customers, and its profit covers the investment with an acceptable downside.

**TAKEAWAY** | Coordinate online demand and pickup → serve demand reliably → open where we add new customers.

SPEAKER NOTES · OUR RECOMMENDATION

Our recommendation mirrors the three chapters: three decisions, three owners, and each one is a pilot judged on its own evidence.

For the digital commerce manager, with operations: pilot AI-enabled demand management in one zone, a busy outlet and a nearby support outlet. Confirm data access, run forecasts and recommendations in shadow mode, then pilot customer choices and manager-approved delivery actions, through the online roadmap's three phases and two gates. Proceed at Gate 2 only if collection is faster, walk-aways fall, support outlets stay reliable and incremental contribution after incentives is positive against normal checkout. The earlier online initiatives and their business case are in the appendix.

For the outlet GM or operations manager: if toppings come in, a plan we still need to confirm with Chagee, the extra work lands unevenly. First confirm the toppings plan and time the counter, and check training, space and safe hand-over points. Then, as toppings launch, trial a bucket brigade against fixed responsibilities in 3 outlets, with the topping-share forecast in shadow mode. Proceed if order-to-ready time and orders completed hold as the topping share rises, with the same crew and paid hours. If they do not, or the topping bar is the limit, cost dedicated topping staff or topping-dispensing equipment; a robotic arm stays an investigation in the appendix.

For the expansion manager: count the cups a new outlet adds, not the ones it sells. Investigate the cluster near Choa Chu Kang on Chagee's real app logs before any lease, and proceed only if its incremental returns justify the investment with an acceptable downside.

One caution to say out loud: these parts connect as a story, but we never add their simulated benefits together or count an order retained by online rerouting again in the counter or expansion numbers. About forty-five seconds.

# THANK YOU

## QUESTIONS AND DISCUSSION

OPIM639 · GROUP 3 · KEZIAH, JIN, AYUMI, REVAN



SPEAKER NOTES · THANK YOU

Recap the chain and its owners: the CRM manager makes membership worth joining, the operations manager serves the demand reliably, the expansion manager opens where demand remains underserved. Each part rests on its own assumptions; no simulated uplift is carried from one to the next.

Likely questions: is the brigade always better? No; with spare staff fixed stations are as good. Is the forecast real? No, it is an illustration of the chain, built on stated assumptions.

# OPTIONAL EXTENSION

## A NEW MARKET WITHOUT APP HISTORY: AUSTRALIA

WHAT WE CAN KNOW BEFORE OPENING · WHICH AREAS · WHICH SETUP · PILOT, LEARN, THEN EXPAND

SPEAKER NOTES · OPTIONAL EXTENSION: A NEW MARKET

Optional, after the close, for questions about a new market. It sits outside the three-part story and none of it feeds the main slides' numbers. Skip to the appendix with the agenda or the slide number box.

 New-market worked example · Australia · scenario assumptions

# No Chagee sales history is not the same as no data: profile each area on what a new market can measure

*Archetype candidate areas in one Australian state capital, standing in for real suburbs until the data is pulled. We assume Chagee has no operating history there.*

CANDIDATE-AREA PROFILES · CONSISTENT FEATURES, EVERY AREA

| FEATURE | STANDS IN FOR | A | B | C | D | A REAL VALUE WOULD COME FROM | VALUE HERE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Residents within 1 km** | proxy walk-in demand from people living nearby | 12k | 18k | 25k | 20k | national census, usual residents by small area | assumption |
| **Workers within 1 km** | proxy weekday lunch and after-work demand | 90k | 20k | 12k | 5k | census place-of-work counts | assumption |
| **Tertiary students within 1 km** | proxy the young, app-first customer base | 15k | 40k | 5k | 2k | university and TAFE enrolment by campus | assumption |
| **Household income index** | proxy willingness to pay for a premium tea | 115 | 80 | 95 | 90 | census median household income | assumption |
| **Transit access** | proxy footfall past the counter | 0.95 | 0.75 | 0.70 | 0.35 | public-transport timetable data, services per hour at the nearest stops | assumption |
| **Competitors within 500 m** | proxy rival bubble-tea and cafe supply (lowers the score) | 9 | 6 | 4 | 2 | business listings or a map-places count | assumption |
| **Rent, A$ a month** | proxy local cost (lowers the score) | A$22,000 | A$12,000 | A$10,000 | A$8,000 | retail lease listings or an agent quote | assumption |

**Areas (archetypes):** A CBD office core · B University precinct · C Suburban rail interchange · D Outer-suburb shopping centre

FOUR KINDS OF INPUT

Sourced observation none yet: no Australian data retrieved for this deck

Proxy what each feature stands in for, such as workers for weekday demand

Scenario assumption every value in the table

Unavailable before opening; left out, below

LEFT OUT · NEEDS CHAGEE ACTIVITY

- **Chagee app searches nearby**: needs Chagee app users in the market
- **Delivery orders from the area**: needs Chagee on the local delivery platforms
- **Distance to the nearest Chagee outlet**: there is none yet
- **Sales of existing Chagee outlets nearby**: there are none yet

### Missing is unknown, not zero

No area has app searches or delivery orders yet. Set to zero, they would read as no demand; left out, the areas are compared only on what all of them have.

WHAT IS AI HERE Nothing yet. This is the data step the models on the next slides need; every value stays a scenario assumption until census and market data are pulled.

SPEAKER NOTES · NEW MARKETS: WHAT CAN WE KNOW BEFORE OPENING?

To consider: a new market. The main story was Singapore, where Chagee already trades. Now the harder case: a new market where Chagee has no local operating history. We use Australia as the worked example, and we assume no Chagee history there; that is to confirm.

No sales history does not mean no data. Before opening, a market still has residents, workers, students, income, transport access, competitors and rents. Step one: those are the features, and each is a proxy for something we care about, such as workers for weekday lunch demand. Step two: the same features for every candidate area, so the areas compare like for like.

Step three, be honest about the values. The areas are archetypes, a CBD office core, a university precinct, a suburban rail interchange and an outer-suburb shopping centre, not real suburbs. Every value is a scenario assumption. The table says where a real value would come from, such as the census, but we have not retrieved any Australian data, so there are no sourced observations on this slide yet.

Step four, what we leave out. App searches, delivery orders, distance to the nearest Chagee outlet and the sales of outlets nearby all need Chagee to be trading already. We leave them out rather than set them to zero: zero would read as no demand, when the truth is that we do not know. About forty-five seconds.

New-market worked example · Australia · scenario assumptions

# B, A and C can each rank first as the weights move; the score shortlists areas, it does not forecast their sales

SUITABILITY SCORE OUT OF 100 · ILLUSTRATIVE WEIGHTS



| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **B · University precinct**<br>rank 1–3 across 15 weightings · first in 6 | **52** | cannibalisation 0% |
| **A · CBD office core**<br>rank 1–3 across 15 weightings · first in 6 | **52** | cannibalisation 0% |
| **C · Suburban rail interchange**<br>rank 1–3 across 15 weightings · first in 3 | **50** | cannibalisation 0% |
| **D · Outer-suburb shopping centre**<br>rank 4 across 15 weightings · first in 0 | **32** | cannibalisation 0% |

Residents · Workers · Students · Income · Transit · Competitors · Rent · bar = score; rank range across the weight check

DEMAND SCENARIOS, CUPS A DAY · THE SAME FOR EVERY AREA

Low 278 Base 556 High 833

A placeholder scale: our Singapore per-outlet volume assumption, reused. With no calibration from real outlets, the score cannot turn into cups, so every area faces this range.

WEIGHTS USED

Residents 1.00 · Workers 1.00 · Students 1.00 · Income 0.50 · Transit 1.00 · Competitors 0.50 · Rent 0.50. Competitors and rent count against.

WEIGHT CHECK · 15 WEIGHTINGS

Each weight dropped, then doubled, one at a time. **B** first in 6, **A** first in 6, **C** first in 3, **D** first in 0. The top spot is not robust: treat the leaders as a shortlist.

WITH REAL OUTCOMES · SUPERVISED LEARNING

If outlets in existing markets had real sales, with these same features measured around each, a supervised model could learn the weights instead of us choosing them, tested on markets it has not seen. The supervised site model, also under Things to consider, is trained on synthetic Singapore data: **not validated for Australia**, and not used here.

Illustrative. Archetype areas and scenario assumptions: not Australian data, not Chagee data.

SPEAKER NOTES · AUSTRALIA CASE STUDY: WHICH AREAS SHOW POTENTIAL?

Same features, same definitions, every area. Step one: each feature is scaled across the 4 areas from worst to best, competitors and rent count against, and the weights add them up. At our weights the University precinct scores 52, the Outer-suburb shopping centre only 32.

Step two, and this is the point: move the weights. The check re-ranks 15 times, with each weight dropped and then doubled. B, A and C each come first in some of them; the Outer-suburb shopping centre is last in every one. So the score gives a shortlist, not a winner.

Step three: the score does not become a sales forecast. Turning it into cups needs a calibration from real outlets, which we do not have. So every area faces the same low, base and high range, 278, 556 and 833 cups a day, borrowed from our Singapore per-outlet assumption as a placeholder scale.

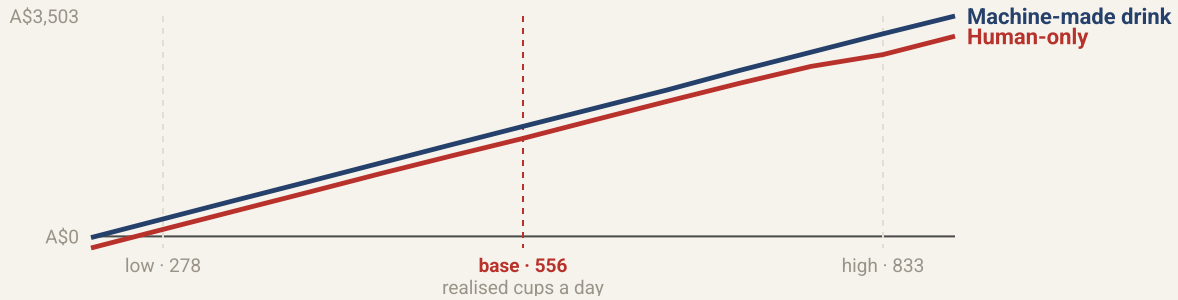
Where supervised learning fits: with real outcomes from outlets in existing markets, a model could learn these weights, tested on markets it has not seen. Our supervised site model is trained on synthetic Singapore data, so it is not validated for Australia, and we do not use it here.

Step four, cannibalisation. For the first opening it is zero: there is no Chagee outlet in any catchment. Switch to the next opening and it appears: an area within 5 km of the pilot loses up to 30% of its cups to it. About one minute.

New-market worked example · Australia · A$ scenario assumptions

# With our A$ assumptions, machine-made drink holds up best in the worst case; human-only wins if a machine unit costs more than about A$3,258 a month

OPERATING CONTRIBUTION, A$ A DAY, YEAR AVERAGE · WITH AI STAFFING, EXACT FORECAST




| EVENT DAY, BASE DEMAND (556 CUPS) | PEAK CREW | MEDIAN WAIT | WALK AWAY | A$ A DAY |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Human-only · no machines** | | | | |
| Without AI · one crew all day | 2 | 5:33 | 40.1% | A$1,766 |
| With AI · forecast −30% | 3 | 4:28 | 10.2% | A$2,139 |
| **With AI · forecast exact** | **4** | **1:25** | **0.0%** | **A$2,218** |
| With AI · forecast +30% | 5 | 1:08 | 0.0% | A$2,146 |
| **Machine-made drink · 4 machine units** | | | | |
| Without AI · one crew all day | 1 | 5:51 | 5.4% | A$2,448 |
| With AI · forecast −30% | 1 | 5:51 | 5.4% | A$2,448 |
| **With AI · forecast exact** | **1** | **5:51** | **5.4%** | **A$2,448** |
| With AI · forecast +30% | 2 | 1:18 | 0.0% | A$2,491 |

SHOWN

Event day, base demand, forecast exact in the band. Wage A$36, machine unit A$2,000 a month, rent A$12,000 a month (University precinct).

BREAK-EVEN, CUPS A DAY · AREA B

**Human-only** 268 with AI, 267 without; **Machine-made drink** 236 with AI, 235 without. Normal day, no walk-aways; low scenario 278.

PREFERRED SETUP · WORST CASE

Worst year-average day, any scenario and forecast error: human-only **A$108**, machine-made drink **A$276**. **Machine-made drink** is safer; the two cross at a machine unit of about **A$3,258** a month (now A$2,000); they do not cross within the wage range. With an exact forecast, machine-made drink leads at low, base and high demand.

**Machines = automation**: equipment sized before opening, held fixed. **AI = AI-assisted staffing**: the forecast sets the crew; realised demand unchanged. Event day, base demand · peak hour · 20 runs · illustrative

WITHOUT AI INTELLIGENCE
one crew, all day

**Human-only**: 2 people · away **40.1%** · wait 5:33 · A$1,766/day
**Machine-made drink**: 1 person · away **5.4%** · wait 5:51 · A$2,448/day

WITH AI INTELLIGENCE
forecast roster

**Human-only** (forecast exact): 4 people · away **0.0%** · wait 1:25 · A$2,218/day
· +2 at the peak, +4 staff hours, +A$452
**Machine-made drink** (forecast exact): 1 person · away **5.4%** · wait 5:51 · A$2,448/day
· same crew: the forecast changes nothing here

## SPEAKER NOTES · WHICH OPERATING SETUP WORKS UNDER UNCERTAIN DEMAND?

Now feed the demand scenarios into the same counter simulation as the counter pages in the appendix, with Australian costs in Australian dollars: a wage of A$36 an hour, A$2,000 a month per machine unit, A$8.5 a cup and A$12,000 a month rent at the University precinct. All scenario assumptions, none sourced. We compare human-only with machine-made drink. Equipment is sized before opening for the base scenario and does not change.

The chart is the year-average operating contribution, before set-up cost, delivery and overheads, as realised demand moves. Machine-made drink is above human-only across the range here, and both are below zero at the low end: break-even is about 236 cups a day for machine-made drink and 268 for human-only, against a low scenario of 278.

Then the AI layer, revealed in the band. Without AI the counter runs one crew all day, set once for a normal day's planned peak. With AI the forecast sets the roster for the day type, but the forecast is not perfect: it can miss realised demand by 30% either way. On an event day at base demand, human-only without AI loses about 40% of peak-hour orders; with an exact forecast, 4 people bring that to 0%, and the day's contribution rises to about A$2,218 from A$1,766. An under-forecast puts on 3 and gives some back: 10% walk away. On machine-made drink the forecast keeps 1 person even on an event day, so 5.4% still walk away: the staffing rule's own capacity estimate is the limit there, not the forecast.

When does the answer change? We judge by the worst case across demand scenarios and forecast errors. Machine-made drink keeps about A$276 a day, human-only A$108. That flips if a machine unit costs more than about A$3,258 a month; across our wage range, A$30 to A$45 an hour, machine-made drink stays ahead. Move the sliders to test it. Walk-aways are counted at the peak-hour rate over the busiest hours only, an approximation. About one and a half minutes.

EXTENSION · NEW MARKET · PILOT, LEARN, THEN EXPAND

New-market worked example · Australia · scenario assumptions

# Pilot one machine-made drink counter in the University precinct, then let the pilot's own data decide the next step

RECOMMENDATION · CONDITIONAL

### Where: the University precinct (B)

First at our weights; B, A and C are the shortlist. No own-store cannibalisation.

### Setup: machine-made drink, AI staffing

Best worst case, A$276 a day against A$108 for human-only.

### Holds only if

- a machine unit costs under about A$3,258 a month
- volume lands in the placeholder range, 278 to 833 cups a day; break-even is about 236
- the A$ wage, price and rent hold
- the forecast misses by no more than 30%

WHAT THE PILOT MEASURES, AND WHAT IT UPDATES

| MEASURE | HOW | UPDATES |
|---|---|---|
| **Orders, cups a day** | till and app records, daily | the placeholder low, base and high range |
| **Hourly demand** | order times by hour, by day type | the hourly shape and peak the roster is built on |
| **Conversion, where measurable** | store-locator views or footfall against orders | the first link from score to cups |
| **Service times** | order to hand-over, per station | station seconds in the counter simulation |
| **Labour needed** | crew against waits and walk-aways each hour | the staffing rule and minimum crew |
| **Machine cost and uptime** | the lease quote, downtime log | the A$ machine cost and the setup choice |

**Then rerun:** the area ranking with the area's real outcome, the setup comparison with real demand and times. Once several outlets trade, outcomes can train the supervised model; until then, weights stay a judgement.

EVIDENCE TO ACT · HELD 4 WEEKS IN A ROW

Example result, illustrative: 556 cups a day, 0.0% peak walk-aways, a quote of A$2,000.

- **Keep the pilot running.** 556 cups a day against about 236 (machine-made drink, University precinct).
- **No extra staff.** Peak walk-aways 0.0% against the 2% limit.
- **Keep machine-made drink.** Quote A$2,000 against the flip at about A$3,258 a month.
- **Open the next outlet, CBD office core.** It keeps 486 cups after 12.5% cannibalisation, against about 301 to break even.

EXPAND WHEN the pilot clears break-even for 4 weeks in a row, and the next area, the CBD office core, still clears it after losing about 13% of its cups to the pilot. Every figure here is a scenario assumption until the pilot replaces it.

SPEAKER NOTES · PILOT, LEARN, THEN EXPAND

So the answer to where, with what, and what next. Where: the University precinct, first at our weights, with B, A and C as the shortlist. With what: a machine-made drink counter with AI staffing, because it keeps the most in the worst case, about A$276 a day. It is conditional: it holds only while a machine unit costs under about A$3,258 a month, the A$ wage, price and rent hold, and volume lands in our placeholder range. Break-even is about 236 cups a day.

Step two, what the pilot measures: orders and cups a day, demand by hour and day type, conversion where we can measure it, service times per station, the labour each hour actually needs, and the real machine cost and uptime. Step three, how that updates the analysis: real volume replaces the placeholder range, real hourly demand replaces the Singapore shape, service times replace our station seconds, and the area's real outcome is the first calibration from score to cups. Once several outlets trade, those outcomes can train the supervised model.

Step four, the evidence to act, each held for 4 weeks in a row. Add staff when peak-hour walk-aways stay above 2% on the forecast roster. Revisit the setup if the firm machine quote is above about A$3,258 a unit a month. Open the next outlet, the CBD office core, only if the pilot clears break-even and the next site still clears it after losing about 13% of its cups to the pilot. Try a pilot result on the right. About one minute.

# Appendix: the detail behind each chapter

*Derivations, tables, sources and earlier analyses. Click a line to open it; use the agenda to return.*


### ONLINE RETAILING

Proposal 1: execution steps and scenario

Earlier version: overview

Earlier version: capacity-aware ordering

Earlier version: targeted discounts

Earlier version: self-pickup rewards

Earlier version: business case and decision

Online retailing: business case and reconciliation

Online retailing: offers, plan, team and sources

### GROW DEMAND

Members: when does joining feel worth it?

The proposed squad experience

Every group order helps us serve customers better

Pilot squads with personalised suggestions?

Members: the model and its checks

Members: break-even, assumptions and sources

Group orders to forecasts: method and results

### ACROSS THE STORY

The data trail

### SERVE DEMAND

Proposal 2: execution steps and settings

Alternative: flexible assistance, the tablet

Alternative: try the tablet

Tablet: steps, inputs and rules

Earlier version: forecasting the crew

Earlier version: sharing the work at the peak

Equipment: a separate investigation

Earlier version: the operations manager's decision

Bucket brigade: sharing the work

Counter comparisons, every day type

The modelled decisions in detail

The size of the benefit

The benefit in detail

Machine ladder

Machine ladder: tiers and sources

### OPTIONAL EXTENSION

New market: inputs and method

### IN-STORE MANAGEMENT: TOPPINGS AND BUCKET-BRIGADE EXPLORATION

Can the same crew handle a more complex menu?

What a bucket brigade actually does

Fixed responsibilities or a bucket brigade?

### EXPAND ACCESS

How the site forecast works

The new store in money: five-year P&L

Four scores for every location

The supervised model

From pin to net profit

Further application: existing outlets

SPEAKER NOTES · APPENDIX

The appendix holds everything moved off the main slides: derivations, the full tables, sources and earlier analyses. Click a line to jump to it.

# Orders are recorded; the other forecast inputs are still to confirm

WHICH SOURCE FEEDS WHICH DECISION · STEP THROUGH

| | Store and production | App and members | Delivery | Supply and context |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Demand forecasts | Cups per hour by drink and channel | Member repeat demand | Orders per hour by platform | Weather, holidays, launches |
| Staffing and prep | Wait times, machine logs | Pickup no-shows | Hand-over peaks | Labour hours vs cups per hour |
| Replenishment | Drink mix per outlet | Launch trial rates | Group-order toppings | Ingredient use, expiry, par |
| Queue and capacity | Wait time, footfall vs sales | Store-select drop-offs | Rider wait at counter | Stock-outs at peak |
| Site selection | Sales density per outlet | "No store nearby", home and work | Distance and fee by postcode | Mall footfall, competitors |
| Menu and promos | Drink share, customisation | Trial and repeat, voucher uplift | Delivery basket mix | Collab calendar |

White chips: core input; grey: refines it; red rows: our scope. Wait times, footfall, searches and location are to confirm.

**TAKEAWAY** | Orders by hour are recorded; searches, location, waits and walk-aways need confirming. Today, GM and outlet teams deploy people on local expertise (Chagee source, anonymous); we show how a forecast could support those calls.

SPEAKER NOTES · THE DATA TRAIL

Each step lights up one decision and the data that feeds it. Skip to the last step under time pressure: our scope is the three counter rows: forecast, staffing, queue.

Only the app ties a cup to a person, so any use of it needs consent and care under Singapore's data protection law (PDPA). This list is our reading of what Chagee's systems could record. Orders by channel and time are known; searches, customer location, wait times and walk-aways are candidates to confirm, based on public material and our industry conversation, not a Chagee data dictionary. About fifty seconds.

# Grow demand, serve it well, then expand access

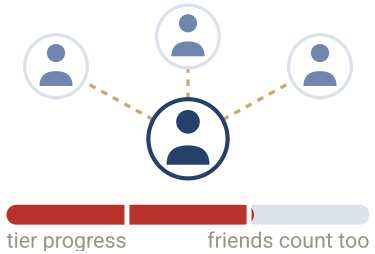
*Three connected decisions, three owners. Each chapter: business problem → demonstration → manager's decision.*

THREE CONNECTED DECISIONS

1

## Grow demand

Make membership more rewarding.




**CRM MANAGER**

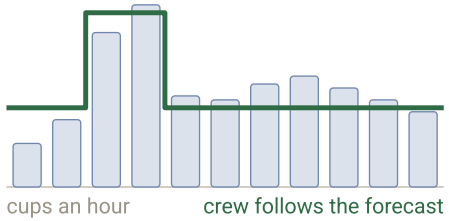
Which features and rewards should we pilot?

**Appendix**

2

## Serve demand

Match staffing and workflow to demand.




**OPERATIONS MANAGER**

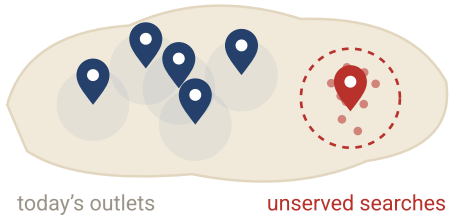
What crew and counter setup should we use?

**Appendix exploration**

3

## Expand access

Open where we add new customers.




**EXPANSION MANAGER**

Which location justifies investment?

**Slides 06 and 07**

SPEAKER NOTES · OUR SCOPE

Our scope is three connected decisions, each with its own owner, and each chapter runs the same way: the business problem, a demonstration, then the manager's decision.

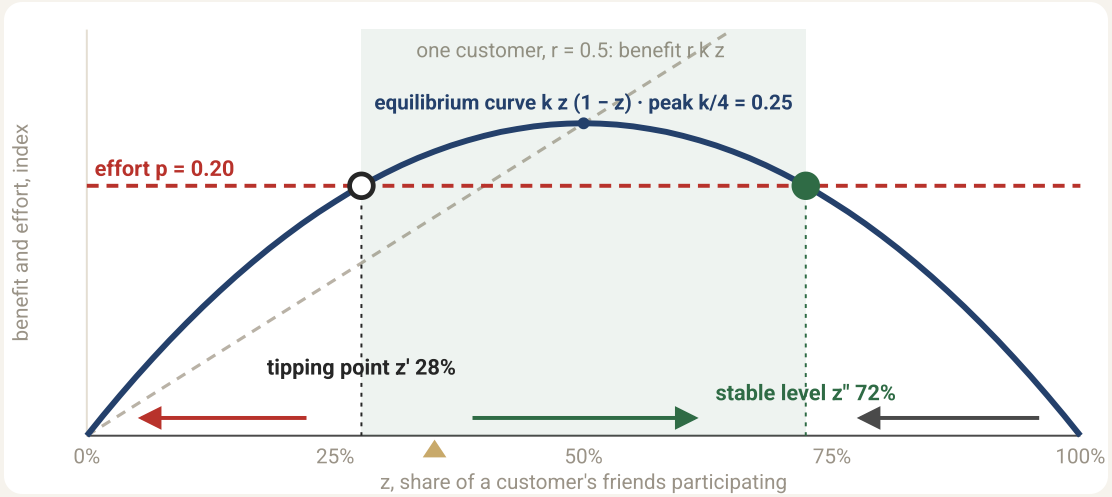
One, grow demand, for the CRM manager: make membership more rewarding. Which features and rewards should we pilot? Two, serve demand, for the operations manager: a more engaging membership has to be matched by reliable fulfilment, so match staffing and workflow to demand. What crew and counter setup should we use? Three, expand access, for the expansion manager: serving customers better also means being where demand is still unserved. Which location justifies the investment?

It is a connected story, not one model: we never carry a simulated membership uplift into the counter or expansion numbers. The tools each part uses come up in its own chapter. About forty seconds.

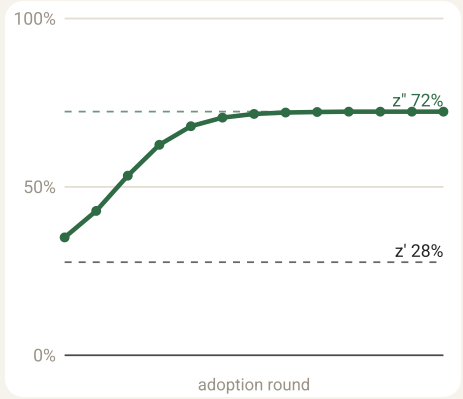
# Squads add value only once enough friends take part

**BUSINESS PROBLEM** Chagee's Membership Operations team told us the problem they want to solve is **moving customers up the membership tiers**: customers may not think the effort of progressing is worthwhile.

BENEFIT AGAINST EFFORT · NETWORK-EFFECTS MODEL, NOT AI · ILLUSTRATIVE INDEX




PARTICIPATION, ROUND BY ROUND




**SHOWN**
Effort score 0.20 (an illustrative index, not money), value of friends k 1.00, starting participation 35%.

**TAKEAWAY** | Tipping point **28%**, stable level **72%**. Starting at 35%, participation rises to about **72%**. Illustrative.

## SPEAKER NOTES · MEMBERS: WHEN DOES JOINING FEEL WORTH IT?

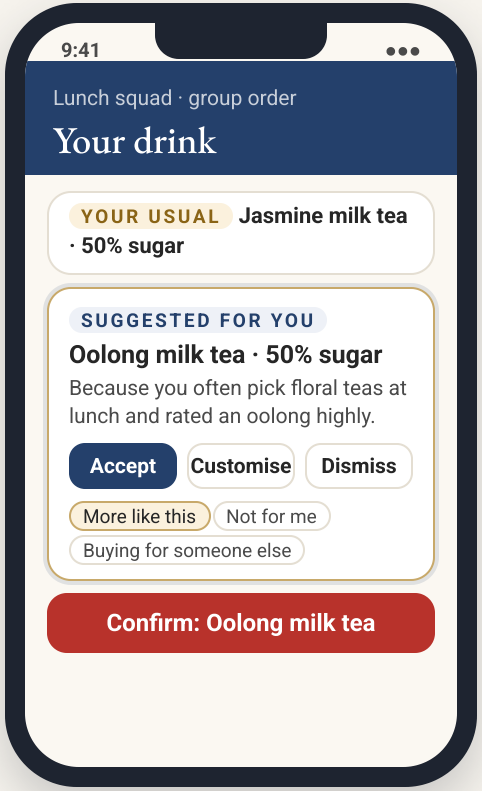
Part one starts with a business problem. Chagee's Membership Operations team told us the problem they want to solve is moving customers up the membership tiers: the barrier is whether customers think the effort of tiering up is worth it. We paraphrase them, and it is their view, not a measured finding: we have no data showing customers never move tiers. Our proposed answer is squad-based progression, where friends taking part make membership worth more. To see when that works, we use the network-effects model from Topic 8. It is an analytics model, not AI. One customer joins when the benefit beats the effort: interest times the value of friends times the share of friends on, against the effort score. Customers differ in interest, so the share who would join traces a hump.

Where the effort line crosses the hump there are two points. Below the lower one, the tipping point, participation falls back to zero; above it, it climbs to the stable level. At our default the tipping point is about 28%. Raise the effort and the two points close in, then vanish: the app stalls from any start. The symbols and equations sit behind How it works; the derivation and tables are in the appendix. About thirty seconds.

# In the app, friends' orders count for everyone

PROPOSED EXPERIENCE · ILLUSTRATIVE PROTOTYPE

1. See your progress and start a squad
2. Invite friends from the share sheet
3. Choose your drink: your usual, or a suggestion
4. Each friend confirms their own drink
5. Collect the order: everyone's progress moves
6. Send a friend a drink
7. The friend picks from suggestions made for them




BASELINE AND AI

Recalling your last order is the baseline. The proposed AI part ranks other drinks from your own choices, acceptances and dismissals. Your feedback teaches it; "Buying for someone else" keeps that drink out of your profile.

WHY IT MATTERS

Easier choices may lower the effort, p, further. A hypothesis to test, like k.

Proposed experience with illustrative data and rules, not Chagee's; nothing is learned from real customers.

**TAKEAWAY** | At the members slide's effort of **0.20**, squads (assumed k 1.00 → 1.30) would move the tipping point from **28%** to **19%**: fewer friends need to be on before joining feels worth it. Assumptions to test, not measured effects.

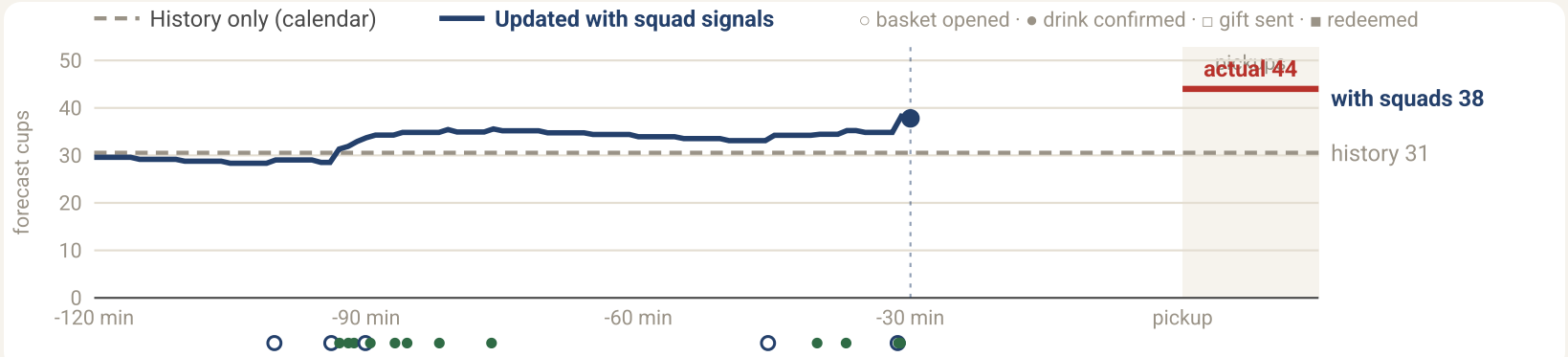
SPEAKER NOTES · THE PROPOSED SQUAD EXPERIENCE

This is the solution, as an illustrative prototype; the rules are ours, not Chagee's. Two parts, kept apart: squads, a product design, and personalisation, the AI part, which suggests a drink from each member's own choices and lets a gift's recipient choose privately. Click through: a member sees their progress and starts a squad, invites friends, then chooses a drink, with a suggestion they can accept, customise or dismiss and feedback such as not for me. In the shared basket each friend confirms their own drink, and preferences are saved to whoever chose, not whoever paid. When the order is collected everyone's progress moves. Last, gifting: the recipient picks privately from options ranked for them. Those picks and that feedback are the signals on the next slide.

Why it matters for the model: our hypothesis is that shared progress raises the value of friends, k, so the hump rises and the tipping point falls, from about 28% to 19% at the default effort. The stalled case is the headline: at a high effort the app never takes off without squads, and with them it can. These are assumptions to test, not measured effects. About thirty seconds.

# Every group order helps the outlet prepare for demand

CUPS FOR THE 13:00 TO 13:30 PICKUPS · SYNTHETIC




**Predict**

**38 cups** expected at -30 min =

**21** usual, from history + **13** confirmed in squads + **3.4** likely

**Likely**: invites not yet confirmed and gifts not yet redeemed, each counted at the chance it converted in past windows (21% and 19%), plus baskets not yet opened.

**Act**

**Prepare**
Jasmine 14 · Oolong 13 · Black 6
drinks to have ready

**Staff**
1 person, 13:00 to 13:30
the window's crew

**Counter**
one person, machines on tea and milk · load 76%
how the line is run

**Pickup estimate**
ready in about 3 min
shown to customers (rough)

SHOWN

Squad rush (synthetic), squad share 30%, forecast at -30 min, actual revealed. Window 13:00 to 13:30.

HOW TO READ IT

1. **Grey dashed**: what history alone predicts for these pickups.
2. **Navy**: the same forecast, updated as squad orders come in (dots under the chart).
3. **Act**: the outlet prepares, rosters and quotes pickup times from the navy number.
4. **Reveal actual**: see which forecast was closer.

TAKEAWAY | Squad rush: actual **44** cups. At -30 min the history-only forecast was off by **13.4**, the squad forecast by **6.2**: squad orders showed the rush coming before history could. Across 300 synthetic windows the squad forecast was closer on 67% of them.

The squad experience is also a data source. As the course put it for online retailers, an app can capture demand data, not just sales data. Press Play: squad signals arrive before one outlet's pickup window, and each forecast uses only what was known at that minute. What the app would record, and which of it is already documented, sits behind What the app records; the squad fields are proposed and need consent.

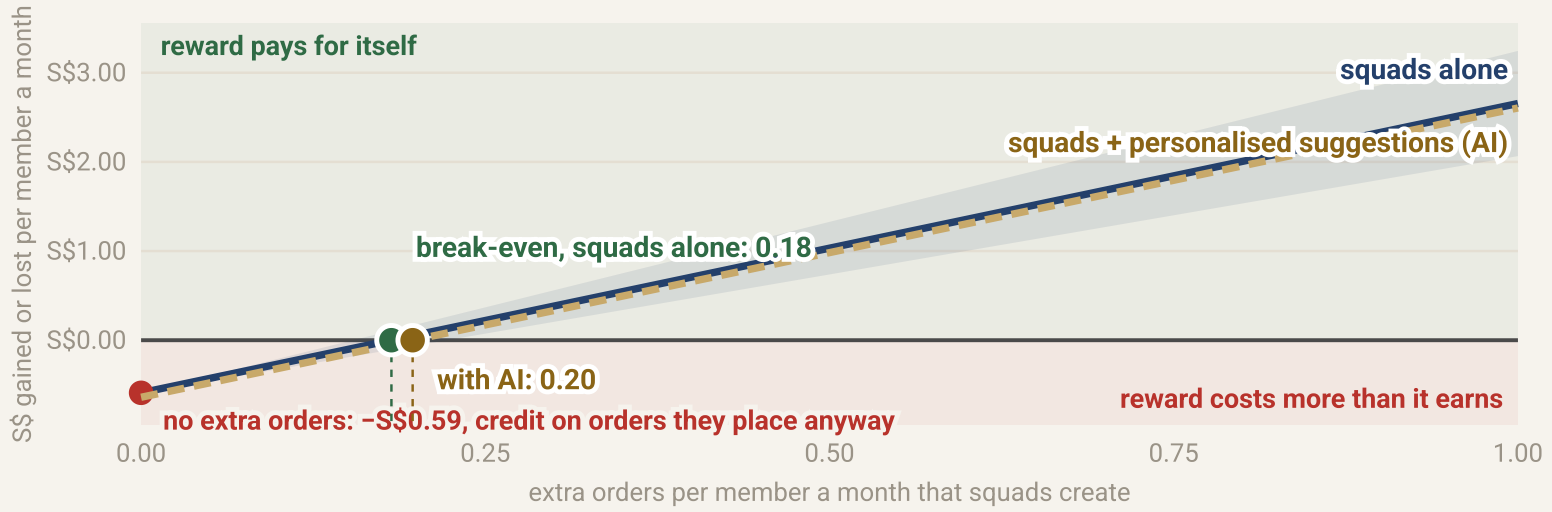
Step two, predict: expected cups are the cups already confirmed, plus a prediction of those not yet confirmed. An open basket or an unredeemed gift is not a drink; it counts only at the chance learned from past windows, and a confirmed cup is never counted twice. Step three, act: the forecast sets what to prepare, the crew for the window, how the counter is organised and the pickup time customers see.

Then play it. This is synthetic: the squad signals help only because we assumed they carry information, so watch the mechanics, not the score. On some days the enhanced forecast is worse, because walk-in surges are invisible to squads. Averaged over 400 synthetic windows it is off by about 5.3 cups ten minutes before, against 7.3 for the calendar baseline; with no squad share the two are identical. The appendix has the table.

Both sides gain: easier choices and reliable pickup for customers, a clearer view of what to prepare for Chagee. Personalisation may lower the effort on the members slide, but that is a hypothesis, and we do not turn adoption into extra orders. How the outlet organises people and machines to serve this demand is part two. First, the CRM manager's decision: is it worth piloting, and at what reward level? About one minute.

# Pilot squads only at a reward their extra orders can pay for

DOES THE REWARD PAY FOR ITSELF? · AFTER REWARD AND AI COSTS · ILLUSTRATIVE




**SHOWN**

Credit 5.0% of the S$5.90 price; 2.0 group orders a month anyway; AI cost S$0.05 a member a month; margin 60% (band 50%–70%).

**HOW TO READ IT**

1. **Start**: no extra orders costs **S$0.59** a member a month, the credit on orders placed anyway.
2. **Rise**: each extra order earns its margin (band: 50%–70%).
3. **Break-even**: **0.18** extra orders a member a month, about one every 5 months.
4. **AI** adds S$0.05 a month, so **0.02** more.

**MANAGER'S DECISION**

**CRM manager**

**Which features and rewards should we pilot?**

**PROPOSED**

Three arms in Singapore (today's membership, squads, squads with suggestions) at a **5.0%** credit: squads must add **0.18** orders a member a month, suggestions **0.02** more.

**PROCEED IF, ARM AGAINST ARM**

- tier progression and orders rise against today's membership
- satisfaction holds
- contribution after reward and AI costs is positive

**NEXT** A more engaging membership must be matched by reliable fulfilment.

## SPEAKER NOTES · PILOT SQUADS WITH PERSONALISED SUGGESTIONS?

The decision for part one belongs to the CRM manager: which features and rewards should we pilot? The line is the contribution per member a month after the reward, the group-order credit. It starts below zero, because the credit is also paid on orders members would have placed anyway, and rises with each extra order. At a credit of 5% squads alone break even at about 0.18 extra orders a month at our base margin. Push the credit up to the margin and it never breaks even.

Step four adds personalised suggestions. They cost something to run; we assume S$0.05 a member a month, a placeholder to replace with a real quote. That shifts the line down: break-even moves to about 0.20 extra orders, so personalisation must add about 0.02 orders a month of its own on top of squads.

That is why the pilot has three arms: today's membership, squads, and squads with personalised suggestions. Squads against today shows the squad effect; adding suggestions shows the personalisation effect. Proceed only if tier progression rises, satisfaction holds, the extra orders reach these break-evens, and contribution after reward and AI costs is positive. We measure orders directly and do not read purchases off the adoption model. Then the transition: a more engaging membership experience must be matched by reliable fulfilment. About forty-five seconds.

1

BUILD AND TEST · MONTHS 1–6

### CONFIRM DATA ACCESS AND INSTRUMENT OUTCOMES

Which order, queue, crew, equipment, location and delivery data Chagee can use; log every recommendation, decision and outcome from the start.

Owners: Product manager, data scientists, app engineers, store-operations lead

2

BUILD AND TEST · MONTHS 1–6

### RUN FORECASTS AND RECOMMENDATIONS IN SHADOW MODE

Predict waits and readiness and log what the tool would recommend, without showing it to customers; compare with what actually happened.

Owners: Data scientists, zone managers

3

PILOT · MONTHS 7–12

### PILOT CUSTOMER CHOICES AND MANAGER-APPROVED ACTIONS

One zone: a busy outlet and a nearby support outlet. Customers choose whether to switch; the zone manager approves any delivery action. Compare with normal checkout.

Owners: Digital commerce manager, zone and outlet managers, CRM analyst

4

SCALE · MONTHS 13–18

### EVALUATE BEFORE SCALING

Collection times, walk-aways, support-outlet reliability, incremental contribution after incentives, and whether managers and outlets can run it. Scale only past the gate.

Owners: Digital commerce manager, with finance and operations

**Gate 1 · ready to pilot** · month 6: data access, outcome logging and platform permissions confirmed (or delivery actions dropped); shadow-mode readiness and wait predictions accurate enough to act on

**Gate 2 · ready to scale** · month 12: against normal checkout in the pilot zone: faster collection, fewer walk-aways, support outlets that stay reliable, positive incremental contribution after incentives, and managers able to run it

**Decision-maker:** the digital commerce manager, with zone and outlet managers, decides whether to pilot in one zone and, at each gate, whether to continue. Phases, months and gate names reuse the online roadmap (team brief); the steps' scope and the gate tests are ours.

#### THE ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO ON SLIDES 03 TO 05

| | |
|---|---|
| Busy and support outlet | Suntec City and Raffles City (the reference deck's example) |
| Trigger threshold | 40 min, adjustable 20–60; illustrative, not a validated rule |
| Busy outlet | walk 3 min, ready in 60 min |
| Support outlet | walk 15 min, ready in 10 min; 50 min once it fills up |
| Offer rule | suggest a switch only if it saves at least 15 min; collection = the later of walk and readiness |
| Switch perk | A voucher for your next drink, or a free carrier bag; cost and uptake not estimated |

#### DATA THE TOOL WOULD NEED

Recorded today, as far as we know: orders by outlet and time. Proposed, needing access, consent or logging: customer location (with permission), margin per drink, crew and equipment availability, delivery orders and rider waits (where platforms share them), and a log of recommendations, decisions and outcomes.

#### WHAT WE CHECKED, AND WHAT WE DO NOT CLAIM

CHAGEE Singapore's Help Centre (October 2026): in-app delivery is available within coverage, with partners such as Grab elsewhere; rewards are redeemable only on in-app pickup orders. Pausing an outlet or promoting another on a delivery platform depends on that platform's tools and permissions, to confirm. No sales or profit uplift is estimated for this proposal; the earlier online business case, with its reconciliation, follows in this appendix. Back to the customer experience →

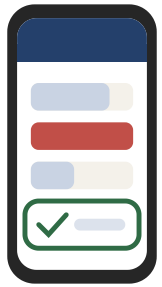
SPEAKER NOTES · PROPOSAL 1: EXECUTION STEPS

The printed copy of slide 05's execution steps, with the illustrative scenario's values and what we checked. The steps reuse the online roadmap's phases, months and gates; their scope and the gate tests are ours. No sales or profit uplift is claimed for this proposal.

DECISION-MAKER **Digital commerce manager, with CRM and operations**

# Coordinate online demand, rewards and pickup to improve customer experience and contribution

BUSINESS PROBLEM Peak congestion can discourage purchases, promotions can subsidise orders that would happen anyway, and fulfilment channels have different costs.



1

## Capacity-aware ordering

Offer only pickup times and nearby outlets that have room, window by window.

**Predicted** demand and preparation speed · **calculated** capacity from staff, equipment and queued work

open the page →



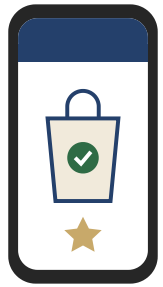

2

## Targeted discounts

Discounts only, never surcharges, timed and targeted where an offer is likely to add an order.

**A model estimates** demand and each member's incremental response · **policy** sets the offer

open the page →



3

## Reward convenient self-pickup

Show transparent savings and an eligible reward when a customer collects it themselves.

**Two journeys, valued apart** · delivery to pickup, and third-party pickup to Chagee-app pickup

open the page →

ONE JOURNEY | A feasible pickup, an offer only where it adds an order, and a reward for collecting: the business case and the decision follow.

SPEAKER NOTES · ONLINE RETAILING: THREE CONNECTED INITIATIVES

Solution one, online retailing, for the digital commerce manager, supported by CRM and operations. The business problem has three parts: peak congestion can discourage purchases; promotions can subsidise orders that would have happened anyway; and the fulfilment channels, Chagee-app pickup, in-app delivery and Grab, carry different costs.

Click through three connected initiatives in one app journey. One, capacity-aware ordering: offer only pickup times and outlets with room. Two, targeted discounts: discounts only, timed and targeted where an offer is likely to add an order. Three, reward convenient self-pickup: transparent savings and an eligible reward, with two different journeys valued separately.

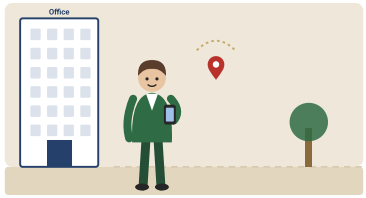
Where the AI is: predictions of demand, preparation speed and each member's incremental response to an offer. Capacity is calculated, and the offer amounts are policy. The next three slides unpack one initiative each; the last page has the business case and the decision. About forty seconds.

# Match each online order with a convenient pickup option

**INITIATIVE ONE** Forecast demand and estimate available capacity in ten-minute windows, then offer feasible pickup times and nearby outlets. Switching stays optional.

## 1 CUSTOMER

### I want to order ahead.




I want to **order ahead** and know when it will be ready.

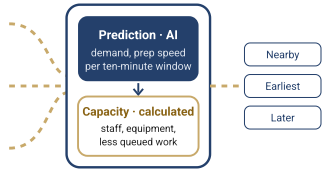
OFFICE WORKER, LUNCHTIME

The customer's goal: convenient collection with a dependable time estimate.

## 2 INTELLIGENCE

### Match the order to capacity.

- **Current orders and drink mix** — INPUT · RECORDED TODAY
- **Staff, equipment and queued work** — CAPACITY · CALCULATED
- **Forecast incoming demand** — PREDICTION · AI
- **Preparation speed** — PREDICTION · AI
- **Customer travel time** — INPUT · NEEDS LOCATION, WITH CONSENT
- **Preferred collection time** — INPUT · THE CUSTOMER ENTERS IT




**AI predicts** demand and preparation speed. **Capacity is calculated** from staff, equipment and outstanding work; the app offers only outlet and time options with room.

Illustrative demonstration: made-up outlets and values. Predictions are estimates; capacity is a calculation; only windows with room are offered.

## 3 APP EXPERIENCE

### Choose your pickup plan.

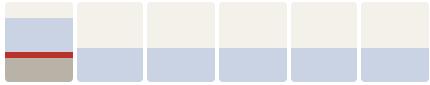
**Nearby** a convenient outlet and its estimated ready time.

**Earliest collection** the earliest feasible option, including travel.

**Later pickup** a collection window that suits the customer.

THE CHOSEN OUTLET'S WORKLOAD, NEXT HOUR

MRT-station outlet
walk 9 min · 14 cups a window



The customer chooses; the order joins that outlet's workload. A confirmed order is never moved automatically.

# Match each online order with a convenient pickup option

**INITIATIVE ONE** Forecast demand and estimate available capacity in ten-minute windows, then offer feasible pickup times and nearby outlets. Switching stays optional.

PICKUP PLANNER · ILLUSTRATIVE DEMO · MADE-UP OUTLETS AND WORKLOADS




**Pickup plan**

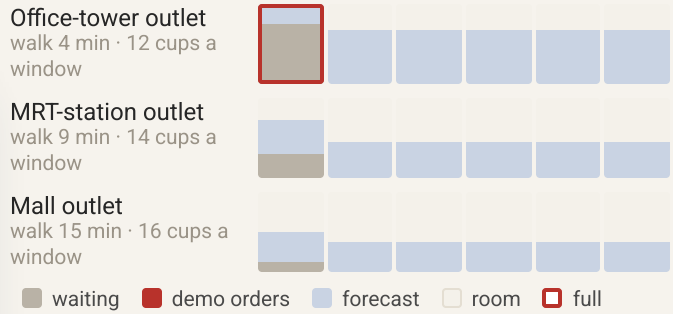
Jasmine milk tea · 1 cup · now 12:40

**Nearby** 13:00
Office-tower outlet · walk 4 min
drink ready 13:00

**Earliest collection** 12:50
MRT-station outlet · walk 9 min
drink ready 12:50

**Later pickup** 13:10
Office-tower outlet · walk 4 min
collect 13:10–13:20

OUTLET WORKLOAD · NEXT HOUR, CUPS PER TEN-MINUTE WINDOW




Options are optional and only use windows with room; a confirmed order updates capacity and never moves.

**Value.** Customer: clearer choices, convenient collection, more reliable pickup estimates. Chagee: online demand coordinated with capacity, spare capacity used, orders potentially retained. No improvement is claimed; a pilot would measure it.

**NEXT** Initiative two: offer a discount only where it is likely to add an order.

## SPEAKER NOTES · MATCH EACH ONLINE ORDER WITH A PICKUP OPTION

Initiative one, capacity-aware ordering. The customer orders ahead; the app should offer only pickup times and outlets that can actually deliver. Two kinds of number feed it, and we keep them apart. Predicted, by AI: incoming orders and preparation speed for each ten-minute window. Calculated, not predicted: each window's capacity, from the people on shift and the working equipment, less the cups already queued.

Step one, the customer: an office worker wants to order ahead with a time they can trust. Step two, the intelligence: queued orders, staff and equipment, forecast demand, preparation speed, travel time and the customer's preferred time. Dashed inputs would need data access: rosters and machine status, and location with consent. Step three, the app: three choices, nearby, earliest collection including travel, and a later window.

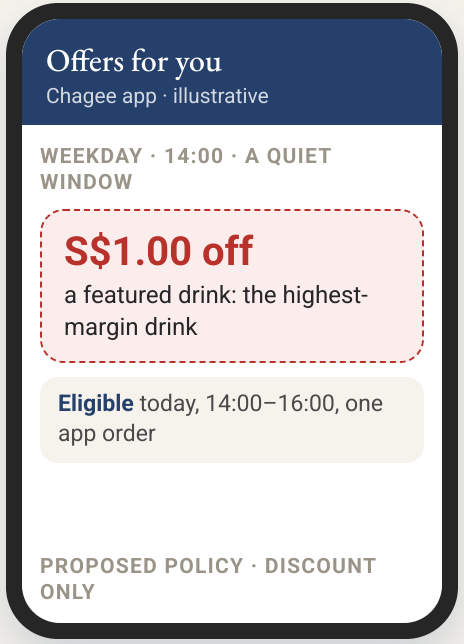
Then the demo, all illustrative: made-up outlets, workloads and walking times. Preparation runs while the customer walks, so collection is whichever comes later, the walk or the drink. Move the demand slider: the nearby outlet fills and the earliest option moves elsewhere. Confirm an order: capacity updates at once, and the order stays in its window even if demand changes. Switching outlet or time is always the customer's choice. We claim no measured improvement here; the business case follows.

Course link, Topic 1, online retailing: integrating online and offline channels. Research supports the direction, not the size: in one restaurant, longer waits went with customers leaving and returning less often (De Vries and co-authors, 2018), and a queueing model finds pooled capacity serves app and platform orders more profitably (Wang and co-authors, 2024). Neither is a Chagee estimate. About one minute.

# Offer a discount only where it is likely to add an order

**INITIATIVE TWO** Targeted promotional pricing: discounts only, never surcharges. The offers below are the team brief's proposed policy, not proven optimal decisions.

THE APP, BY SCENARIO · ILLUSTRATIVE




Printed: the off-peak scenario; all four are in the table.

## Why this offer, in this scenario

Spare capacity in a quiet window. An offer pays only if it brings orders that would not otherwise happen; a model estimates who that is likely to be.

## Proposed policy · all four scenarios

PROPOSED, NOT PROVEN

| SCENARIO | OFFER | WHEN |
|---|---|---|
| **Off-peak** | up to S$1.00, highest-margin drink | quiet windows |
| **Peak** | none; S$0.50 off a pre-order collected later | busiest hours |
| **Weather or event** | S$0.50 hot; S$1.00 normal or rain; none at events | by forecast |
| **Inactive member** | up to S$1.00 off a favourite; then a free upsize | 7 days, then 14 more |

## Where AI comes in

A fixed scenario rule is not AI. A model would estimate **demand in each window** and each member's **incremental response** to an offer; the offer then goes where expected incremental contribution is highest, within the member's preferences and the outlet's capacity.

**BREAK-EVEN** | At S$1.00 off and about S$3.54 contribution a cup, an offer pays only if at least 28% of redeemed orders are new. Test it against a no-offer group.

**NEXT** Initiative three: reward customers who collect it themselves.

SPEAKER NOTES · TARGETED DISCOUNTS

Initiative two, targeted discounts: targeted promotional pricing, so every adjustment is a discount, never a surcharge. Click through the four scenarios on the phone. Each shows the offer as it would appear in the app, its eligibility window, and the business reason.

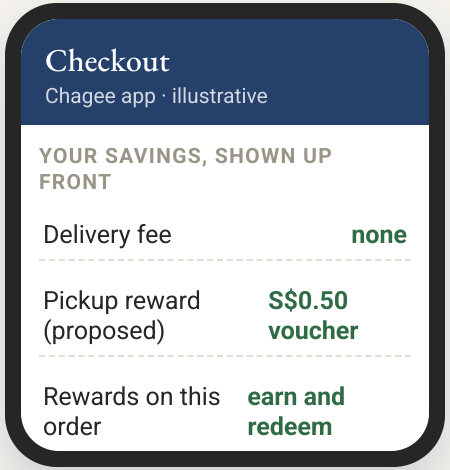
Off-peak: up to S$1.00 off the highest-margin drink, in a quiet window, to fill spare capacity. Peak: no vouchers; S$0.50 off a pre-order only if collection moves into a window with room, because ordering earlier alone does not cut the peak's production workload; and limiting Grab delivery when slots are full, which depends on what Grab's merchant tools allow. Weather and events: S$0.50 off in hot weather, S$1.00 in normal weather or rain, none during nearby events. A member becoming inactive: up to S$1.00 off their favourite for 7 days, then a free upsize after 14 more days.

These amounts and timings are the team brief's proposal, not optimal decisions. A fixed rule by scenario is not AI. The AI part is the model behind it: it estimates demand in each window and each member's incremental response, so an offer goes only where it is likely to add an order, within the member's preferences and capacity. The break-even is simple: a discount is paid on every redeemed order, including those that would have happened anyway, so with about S$3.54 contribution a cup, at least 28% of redeemed orders must be new. Only a no-offer comparison group can measure that. For context, delivery platforms with dynamic pricing show higher demand than static ones in China (Tong and co-authors, 2020); that is an association elsewhere, not a Chagee estimate. About one minute.

# Reward collecting it yourself, and count only the cost Chagee avoids

**INITIATIVE THREE** Show transparent savings and an eligible reward at checkout. Two different journeys, valued separately; moved orders shift revenue, they do not add it.

THE CUSTOMER'S CHECKOUT · ILLUSTRATIVE




Printed: delivery → chagee-app pickup, the savings step; the other journeys are in the notes.

## Delivery → Chagee-app pickup · changes fulfilment

The order leaves delivery for in-app pickup: no rider and no platform commission. Its revenue moves channel; it is not added unless the customer buys more.

Chagee gains about **S$1.09** an order: S$5.90 × (30% commission − 3% payment) − S$0.50 reward. Assumptions, not Chagee's terms.

## What exists today

CHECKED OCT 2026

GrabFood orders earn CHAGEE rewards once the membership is linked to CHAGEE on GrabFood; rewards are redeemable only on in-app pickup orders. In-app delivery exists where the address is in coverage. Whether Grab self-pickup orders earn is not stated.

## Not assumed

Chagee cannot identify Grab customers or see their purchase history unless they link their account. Rewarding Grab self-pickup through membership is a **proposed integration**: account linking, transaction verification and reward rules must be confirmed.

**VALUE** | Delivery to app pickup gains about S$1.09 an order after the reward; Grab pickup to app pickup gains only if Grab's pickup commission is above 11%.

**NEXT** The business case and the manager's decision.

## SPEAKER NOTES · REWARD CONVENIENT SELF-PICKUP

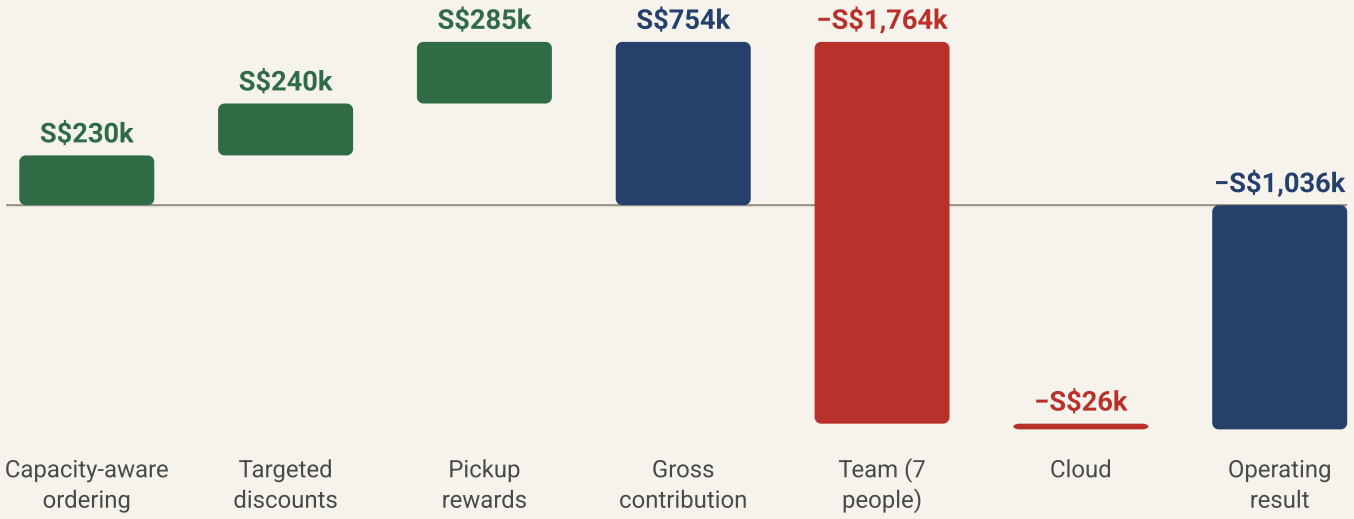
Initiative three, rewarding convenient self-pickup. Step through the checkout: the customer chooses pickup, sees transparent savings, and receives an eligible reward. Then switch journeys, because they are not the same conversion and do not save the same.

Delivery to Chagee-app pickup changes fulfilment and channel: Chagee avoids the platform commission, assumed 30% as on the expansion slides, less a 3% app payment cost and the reward, about S$1.09 an order on our assumptions. Grab self-pickup to Chagee-app pickup changes only the ordering channel: Chagee avoids Grab's pickup commission, which is not public; it pays only above about 11%. In both, the revenue moves channel; it is not added unless the customer buys more.

What we checked, in Chagee Singapore's Help Centre in October: GrabFood orders earn rewards once accounts are linked, rewards are redeemable only on in-app pickup orders, and the app now offers delivery where the address is in coverage. Whether Grab self-pickup orders earn is not stated. So the brief's idea of rewarding Grab pickup through membership is shown as a concept, a proposed integration, and is not in the totals. We never assume Chagee can identify Grab customers or see their histories. Context: in a Singapore choice experiment, consumers reacted more to menu-price premiums than to delivery fees (Ma and co-authors, 2024), and app adopters spent more in a US loyalty programme (Kim and co-authors, 2015). About one minute.

# The initiatives add contribution, but not enough to fund the proposed team

A FULL-SCALE YEAR · SINGAPORE · OUR ASSUMPTIONS, NOT THE BRIEF'S




Base scenario. Moved orders shift revenue and count only the commission avoided, less rewards. Gross: S$128k low to S$1,158k high. Implementation spend S$880k; payback: none within 5 years.

## Proposed plan

TEAM BRIEF · THREE PHASES, TWO GATES

| Build and test | Pilot | Scale |
|---|---|---|
| months 1–6 · 5 people | months 7–12 · 7 people | months 13–18 · 7 people |

**Gate 1 · ready to pilot** · month 6: forecasts and capacity checks reliable in shadow mode; app flows and control groups working; Grab linking confirmed or dropped

**Gate 2 · ready to scale** · month 12: incremental contribution after incentives and operating costs above the control group; pickup reliability and satisfaction hold

## What would make it pay

- offers: at least **28%** of redeemed orders new
- Grab-pickup moves: pickup commission above **11%**
- run team: base contribution covers about **2** people, not 7

reconciliation: appendix →

MANAGER'S DECISION

**Digital commerce manager**

with CRM and operations

**Which combination of pickup options, targeted offers and rewards increases completed orders and contribution while maintaining reliable service?**

PROPOSED

Pilot all three in 3 outlets against matched outlets and a no-offer group; scale only past Gate 2, with a run team the contribution can carry.

MEASURE IN THE PILOT

- conversion and pickup reliability
- satisfaction; incremental purchases against a no-offer group
- contribution after incentives and operating costs

NEXT Once an order reaches the outlet, how should we organise the counter to serve it?

The business case, on the deck's own assumptions: 44 outlets, about 556 cups an outlet a day, S$5.90 a cup and 60% gross margin. Read the waterfall left to right. At base, rerouting keeps about S$230k of contribution a year, targeted offers add about S$240k after paying the discount on every redeemed order, and pickup moves save about S$285k after rewards: about S$754k gross contribution, S$128k to S$1,158k across our scenarios. Moved orders shift revenue; they are not new sales. Rerouted peak orders are not counted again in the counter chapter.

Then the costs. The brief's seven-person team, at the deck's approved specialist rate, costs about S$1,764k a year, plus about S$26k of cloud. So the operating result is about −S$1,036k a year at base, and the plan does not pay back within 5 years in any of our scenarios. Base contribution would carry a run team of about 2 people. That is why we do not repeat the brief's S$1.23m sales and S$0.89m profit: its arithmetic, reconciled in the appendix, counts discounts on new orders only, values pickup moves before rewards and leaves out the team.

The decision for the digital commerce manager, with CRM and operations: which combination of pickup options, targeted offers and rewards increases completed orders and contribution while keeping service reliable? Proposed: pilot all three in 3 outlets through the brief's three phases over eighteen months. Gate 1, at month six, checks readiness; Gate 2, at month twelve, requires incremental contribution after incentives and operating costs above matched outlets and a no-offer group before scaling. Then the transition: once an order reaches the outlet, how should we organise the counter to serve it? About one minute.

# APPENDIX · ONLINE RETAILING · THE BUSINESS CASE, AND THE TEAM BRIEF RECONCILED (THE EARLIER ONLINE SLIDES)

## INPUTS: THE DECK'S OWN VALUES, AND WHERE EACH COMES FROM

| Input | Value | Source |
|---|---|---|
| Outlets | 44 (store directory, 15 Oct 2026). The store locator listed 46 on 24 Oct 2026: at that count every volume line is 5% higher | facts.sg_outlets; online_case.outlets_locator |
| Days, cups, price, margin | 360 days; 200,000 cups an outlet a year (about 556 a day); S$5.90 a cup; 60% margin, so S$3.54 contribution a cup | store; storyboard |
| Channels | Chagee-app pickup and in-store app orders 60%; Grab delivery 30% at 30% commission; Grab self-pickup 5%; in-app delivery 5% (rider cost unknown, not valued) | site_ext (as on the expansion slides); online_case.channel_shares |
| Peak and off-peak | peak = the 4 busiest hours, 41% of cups; off-peak the rest | store.hourly_demand_share |

## EACH INITIATIVE, A FULL-SCALE YEAR: LOW · BASE · HIGH

| Initiative | Eligible volume and rule | Contribution |
|---|---|---|
| Capacity-aware ordering | 2,164,800 peak-hour Chagee-app cups (Grab orders cannot be rerouted); 1% · 3% · 5% kept × S$3.54 | S$77k · S$230k · S$383k |
| Targeted discounts | 3,115,200 off-peak app cups; 10% redeemed with S$1.00 off; 20% · 50% · 60% of them new. Contribution = new × S$3.54 − redeemed × S$1.00; break-even 28% new | −S$91k · S$240k · S$350k |
| Delivery → app pickup | 2,640,000 Grab delivery cups; 5% · 10% · 15% move; each gains S$5.90 × (30% − 3%) − S$0.50 reward = S$1.09; S$1,558k of revenue moves at base, none added | S$144k · S$289k · S$433k |
| Grab pickup → app pickup | 440,000 Grab self-pickup cups; each gains S$5.90 × (10% − 3%) − S$0.50 = S$-0.09; pays only if Grab's pickup commission is above 11.5% | −S$2k · −S$4k · −S$8k |
| **Gross contribution** | added sales (rerouting, plus new offer orders less every discount): S$184k · S$991k · S$1,430k | **S$128k · S$754k · S$1,158k** |

## THE TEAM BRIEF, LINE BY LINE: WHAT ITS FIGURES IMPLY, AND HOW WE TREAT THEM

| Line | Brief | What it implies | Here, base |
|---|---|---|---|
| Base | 46 × 500 cups × 365 days × S$6.00 = S$50,370,000 | the locator's count; 365 trading days | S$51,920,000 on the deck's inputs |
| Rerouting | sales S$604,000; profit S$423,000 | 3% of all peak revenue (40%), Grab included; a 70% margin | app orders only, 60% margin: S$230k |
| Dynamic pricing | sales S$630,000; profit S$252,000 | 5% of S$12,600,000, which is 25% of the base: all delivery revenue, not off-peak, where app vouchers cannot reach; 40% margin; no discount on orders that would happen anyway | off-peak app orders, discount on every redeemed order: S$240k |
| Self-pickup | S$1,260,000 moves; profit S$214,000 | 10% of that delivery revenue × (20% − 3%); no reward cost; Grab pickup still pays Grab | two journeys, the deck's 30% commission, reward deducted: S$285k |
| Total | sales S$1,234,000; profit S$889,000 | gross: no team, cloud or integration cost | gross S$754k; operating −S$1,036k after the run team and cloud |
| Payback | within a year if build costs stay below the annual profit | build cost against one year's gross; the team's running cost left out | phased cash flow: no payback within 5 years in any scenario |
| Scale | stores averaged over 1,500 cups a day, Q2 2025 | could not be verified (transcript inaccessible); most likely group or China, not Singapore | not used |

SPEAKER NOTES · ONLINE RETAILING: BUSINESS CASE AND RECONCILIATION

Backup for the earlier online business-case page. Left: every input, with the deck's value and its source, and how each initiative's eligible volume and contribution are built at low, base and high. Right: the costs, the phased cash flow and the payback, then the team brief's figures line by line: what each implies and how we treat it. In short, its base uses 46 outlets at S$6.00 and 365 days; its pricing line applies a 5% uplift to all delivery revenue, which app vouchers cannot reach, and deducts no discount on orders that would have happened anyway; its pickup line values moves before any reward; and its payback leaves out the team. Soft copy only.

### COSTS, CASH FLOW AND PAYBACK · BASE (S$; LOW AND HIGH IN BRACKETS)

| Year | Benefit | Team | Cloud | Integration | Net | Cumulative |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | S$26k | −S$1,512k | −S$1k | −S$250k | −S$1,737k | −S$1,737k (−S$1,759k; −S$1,723k) |
| 2 | S$608k | −S$1,764k | −S$21k | – | −S$1,177k | −S$2,914k (−S$3,441k; −S$2,575k) |
| 3 | S$754k | −S$1,764k | −S$26k | – | −S$1,036k | −S$3,950k (−S$5,103k; −S$3,207k) |
| 4 | S$754k | −S$1,764k | −S$26k | – | −S$1,036k | −S$4,986k (−S$6,765k; −S$3,839k) |
| 5 | S$754k | −S$1,764k | −S$26k | – | −S$1,036k | −S$6,022k (−S$8,428k; −S$4,471k) |

Implementation spend, months 1 to 6: S$880k (team and integration). Run cost from month 19: S$1,764k team (7 people × S$21,000 a person-month, the approved specialist rate) and S$26k cloud. Payback: none within the horizon. With a 3-person run team the base operating result would be −S$28k a year.

### PROPOSED OFFER POLICY (TEAM BRIEF): DISCOUNTS ONLY, NOT PROVEN OPTIMAL

| Scenario | Offer | Condition we add |
|---|---|---|
| Off-peak | up to S$1.00 on the highest-margin drink | only to members the model scores as likely to add an order |
| Peak | no vouchers; S$0.50 off a pre-order; limit Grab delivery when slots are full | the pre-order discount only if collection moves into a window with room; Grab limits as Grab's merchant tools allow (to confirm) |
| Weather, events | S$0.50 off in hot weather; S$1.00 in normal weather or rain; none during nearby events | weather and event effects estimated, not assumed |
| Inactive member | up to S$1.00 off their favourite for 7 days; a free upsize after 14 more days | only members the model scores as lapsing and responsive |

### PROPOSED PLAN: THREE PHASES, TWO GATES, AND THE TEAM AS IT JOINS

| Phase | Months | Scope | People | Team cost |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Build and test | 1–6 | capacity forecast by ten-minute window, offer engine, pickup reward flow; no-offer control group set up | 5 | S$630k |
| Pilot | 7–12 | pilot outlets against matched control outlets and a no-offer group | 7 | S$882k |
| Scale | 13–18 | roll out across Singapore outlets, ramping evenly | 7 | S$882k |

**Gate 1 · ready to pilot** (month 6): forecasts and capacity checks reliable in shadow mode; app flows and control groups working; Grab linking confirmed or dropped; **Gate 2 · ready to scale** (month 12): incremental contribution after incentives and operating costs above the control group; pickup reliability and satisfaction hold. Roles: Product manager (1, from month 1), Data scientists (2, from month 1), App engineers (2, from month 1), CRM analyst (1, from month 7), Store-operations lead (1, from month 7).

### SOURCES THE BRIEF CITES, CHECKED 24 OCT 2026

| Source | Supports | Does not support |
|---|---|---|
| De Vries, Roy and De Koster 2018 | longer waits relate to customers leaving and returning less (one Indian restaurant) | the 'nearly 15%' is a simulation without any waiting, not a Chagee uplift |
| Wang and co-authors 2024 | pooled capacity for app and platform orders gives more profit and throughput, in a queueing model | a size for Chagee |
| Tong and co-authors 2020 | platforms with dynamic pricing show higher demand (China O2O) | that targeted discounts lift Chagee's orders; an association |
| Ma and co-authors 2024 | Singapore consumers more sensitive to menu-price premiums than to delivery fees (stated choices; partly verified) | observed Chagee behaviour |
| Kim, Wang and Malthouse 2015 | app adopters spend more (US loyalty programme) | a Chagee uplift |
| Traynor and co-authors 2022; Liu and Li 2023 | operators see commissions as a cost (US interviews); a model that assumes and caps commissions | Chagee's commission rate |
| CHAGEE SG Help Centre, Oct 2026 | rewards redeemable only on in-app pickup; GrabFood orders earn once accounts are linked; in-app delivery within coverage; app payment methods | that Grab self-pickup orders earn; 'no delivery in the app' (the page says delivery is available) |
| Q2 2025 earnings call | could not be accessed | the '1,500 cups a day' figure; not used |

SPEAKER NOTES · ONLINE RETAILING: OFFERS, PLAN, TEAM AND SOURCES

Backup for the earlier online slides: the brief's offer rules as a proposed policy, the three phases and two gates with the team as it joins and what it costs, and each cited source with what it does and does not support. Research findings come from other settings; they support the direction, not the size, of any Chagee effect. Soft copy only.

# Chagee's data collection: what is public, what is to confirm

*Only what our sources say; everything else in the deck is synthetic or illustrative.*

- **Public sources**
  - Chagee's annual report: *"Our business generates and processes personal, transactional and other data."*
  - The app: *"Order and pay digitally"*, *"Order for self-pickup ahead of time"*, *"Locate our outlets and their operating hours"*.
  - After the Singapore reopening queues, *"the brand rolled out in-app ordering and delivery"*.

  · Chagee Form 20-F, FY 2025 · CHAGEE App Store listing · Vulcan Post, Oct 2024

- **Chagee source, anonymous**
  - Singapore outlets run under **one company and one data system**.
  - All delivery is through **third-party apps**, so delivery orders arrive by platform.
  - People are deployed on **local expertise**: the GM and outlet teams make the staffing calls.

  An internal staff member who asked not to be named; paraphrased, not quoted.

- **To confirm**
  - The **app's share** of Singapore orders: not in the parts of the annual report we read.
  - Whether **searches or location** are logged. The app's privacy label lists precise location as not linked to the user and does not list search history (storefront seen: not Singapore).
  - **Wait times, footfall and walk-aways**.
  - Any use of app data needs **consent** under Singapore's data protection law (PDPA).

**TAKEAWAY** | Orders are recorded in one system; searches, location and waits are to confirm. That is why our app and site data are synthetic (the group-orders slide and slide 06).

SPEAKER NOTES · CHAGEE'S DATA COLLECTION

Backup for slide 01's "Why Chagee?" and the data trail (appendix). Only three public sources speak to Chagee's data: the annual report's risk factors, the app's store listing and Vulcan Post on the reopening. Our Chagee source, who asked not to be named, added that Singapore runs on one company and one data system, that delivery is all third-party, and that staffing is decided by the GM and outlet teams. What we could not confirm: the app's share of orders, whether searches or location are logged, and waits or walk-aways; that is why the app and site data in the deck are synthetic.

# From one customer's rule to the tipping point, and how far a friend network moves it

### DERIVATION (OPIM639 TOPIC 8, SLIDES 30 TO 36)

Customer x in (0, 1) has interest r(x) = 1 - x. With a share z of friends participating, x joins if r(x) k z >= p, that is x <= 1 - p/(k z): the share who would join is 1 - p/(k z). An equilibrium is a share that reproduces itself, z = 1 - p/(k z), which gives **p = k z (1 - z)**. This hump is the equilibrium curve of the population; one customer's benefit is r k z, a straight line in z.

The hump peaks at k/4, at z = 50%. If p < k/4 the effort line crosses it twice: **z' = (1 - sqrt(1 - 4p/k))/2**, the unstable tipping point, and **z" = (1 + sqrt(1 - 4p/k))/2**, the stable level. At p = k/4 they merge at 50%; above it there is no positive equilibrium and participation falls to zero from any start. Rounds: z_next = max(0, min(1, 1 - p/(k z))).

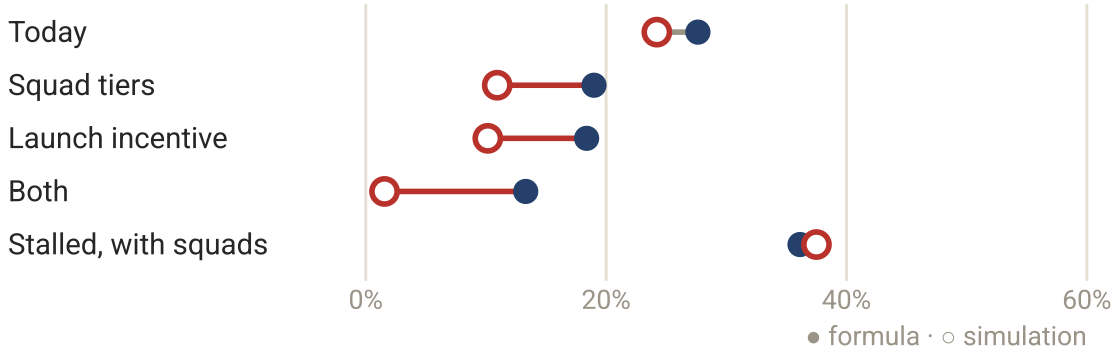
### PARAMETERS (ILLUSTRATIVE INDEX, NOT CHAGEE DATA)

**r** individual interest, 0 to 1, uniform across customers. **k** value of friends participating; squads are hypothesised to raise it. **z** share of a customer's friends participating. **p** effort score of joining or progressing, 0 to 1: 1 is the whole benefit a fully interested customer gets with every friend on at k = 1; not money. Slider defaults: p 0.2, k 1, incentive 0, z0 0.35. Levers, read from the scenario table: squads add 0.3 to k; a launch incentive takes 0.05 off p.

### SCENARIO TABLE, COMPUTED (SIM/MEMBERS.JS); THE BUILD FAILS IF IT DIFFERS FROM MEMBERS.EXPECTED_TABLE

| Scenario | p | k | 4p/k | z' | z" |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Today | 0.20 | 1.0 | 0.80 | 28% | 72% |
| Squad tiers | 0.20 | 1.3 | 0.62 | 19% | 81% |
| Launch incentive | 0.15 | 1.0 | 0.60 | 18% | 82% |
| Both | 0.15 | 1.3 | 0.46 | 13% | 87% |
| Stalled app | 0.30 | 1.0 | 1.20 | none | none |
| Stalled, with squads | 0.30 | 1.3 | 0.92 | 36% | 64% |

### NETWORK CHECK · CLOSED FORM AGAINST THE FRIEND-NETWORK SIMULATION




| Scenario | Closed form z' | Simulated | Gap, points |
|---|---|---|---|
| Today | 28% | 24% | -3.4 |
| Squad tiers | 19% | 11% | -8.1 |
| Launch incentive | 18% | 10% | -8.2 |
| Both | 13% | 2% | -11.7 |
| Stalled app | none | none | |
| Stalled, with squads | 36% | 38% | +1.4 |

2,000 customers on a seeded random graph with about 8 friends each, interest uniform; a customer is on next round if r k (share of friends on) >= p. 20 seeded runs; the simulated tipping point is the smallest starting share (to 0.01) from which the mean run ends above 10%. Gaps above five points mean the friend-group structure matters: with a handful of friends each, pockets of friends keep each other on, so the network tips lower than the formula, which assumes everyone sees the whole population's share. We report the gap, not hide it.

SPEAKER NOTES · MEMBERS: THE MODEL AND ITS CHECKS

Soft copy only. Backup for the members slides: the derivation, every parameter, the computed scenario table and the network check.

# The break-even across the margin range, every new input, and what the sources say

## BREAK-EVEN OF THE GROUP-ORDER CREDIT

Contribution per member a month = price x (margin x E - credit x (B + E)), with E extra orders and B group orders a member would place anyway. Break-even E* = credit x B / (margin - credit); none if the credit reaches the margin. Price S$5.90, credit 5%, B 2, E 1.

| Gross margin | Extra orders needed a month | With AI cost (CRM manager's decision) | Contribution a member a month at E |
|---|---|---|---|
| 50% | 0.22 | 0.24 | S$2.06 |
| 60% | 0.18 | 0.20 | S$2.65 |
| 70% | 0.15 | 0.17 | S$3.24 |

With personalised suggestions (the CRM manager's decision) a flat AI cost a of S$0.05 a member a month is added: E* = (credit x B + a / price) / (margin - credit). Personalisation must add a / (price x (margin - credit)) = 0.02 orders a month on top of squads alone at the base margin.

## NEW INPUTS (ASSUMPTIONS.JSON MEMBERS; ASSUMPTION, NOT CHAGEE DATA)

**group credit share**: 0.05 (range 0, 0.1). New input, assumption, not Chagee data.

**extra orders per member month**: 1 (range 0, 3). New input, assumption, not Chagee data.

**base group orders per member month**: 2 (range 0, 6). Invented for the break-even (the credit is paid on orders that would have happened anyway); assumption, not Chagee data.

**ai cost per member month**: 0.05 (range 0, 0.3). Illustrative placeholder, not sourced: the running cost of personalised suggestions per participating member, allocated. Replace with a quoted cost before any decision. Used only on slide 08 to show what personalisation must add on top of squads.

**squad size**: 2, 6. Our proposal, a design choice, not a Chagee feature claim.

**example interest**: 0.5. Display only: a middling customer, to separate one customer's benefit from the equilibrium curve.

**app rules**: points own drink 10, points per squad drink 5, points now 220, points next 300, tier now Silver, tier next Gold, people Mei, Jun, Aisha, Ravi, squad name Lunch squad, prefs Mei usual Jasmine milk tea · 50% sugar, suggest Oolong milk tea · 50% sugar, why you often pick floral teas at lunch and rated an oolong highly, Jun usual Black milk tea · less ice, suggest Black milk tea · 25% sugar, why you switched to less sugar in your last few orders, gift options Black milk tea · 25% sugar, Oolong milk tea · less ice, Fresh fruit tea, Aisha usual Fresh fruit tea, suggest Jasmine milk tea · no ice, why you liked jasmine teas when ordering for yourself, Ravi usual Oolong milk tea, suggest Oolong milk tea · less sugar, why close to your usual, with the sugar level you picked last week. Our illustrative rules for the proposed experience, used consistently on slide 06. Not Chagee's membership rules, which are to confirm. The group-order credit is members.group_credit_share. Preferences and suggestions are illustrative data, not learned from anyone. Recalling the last order is the baseline; the proposed AI part ranks alternatives from each member's own choices, acceptances and dismissals. No real messages, purchases or accounts.

**network**: customers 2000, friends per customer 8, runs 20, max rounds 200, z0 step 0.01, takeoff share 0.1. Assumption: eight friends each, a squad plus a few more. The closed form assumes everyone sees the whole population's share; a friend group sees a noisy sample of it.

## SOURCE EXCERPTS · QUOTED WORD FOR WORD

> "we cannot accurately predict the rate or range of consumers who will join our membership program"
>
> Chagee Form 20-F, FY 2025, Item 3.D, risk factors

> "we may not be able to use our membership program to deepen our understanding of our target consumers"
>
> Chagee Form 20-F, FY 2025, Item 3.D, same risk factor

> "The value z′ is the hump the firm must get over in order to succeed."
>
> OPIM639, Topic 8, Service Platforms, slide 34

> MEMBERSHIP OPERATIONS TEAM, CHAGEE
>
> Paraphrased, not quoted: the barrier to levelling up is not outlet operations; it is whether customers think the effort of tiering up is worth it.

SPEAKER NOTES · MEMBERS: BREAK-EVEN, ASSUMPTIONS AND SOURCES

Soft copy only. Backup for the CRM manager's decision, and the source excerpts behind the chapter.

# How the enhanced forecast is built, and how it compares on synthetic windows

## WHAT THIS IS

A synthetic demonstration of the mechanics only: one outlet's peak half-hour pickup window, with squad signals generated by our assumptions. The enhanced forecast can only help to the extent we assume the signals carry information, so this shows how the forecast would work, not measured accuracy. Nothing here feeds any other slide.

## THE FORECASTS

**Baseline**: the calendar expectation for the window, cups a day x the peak hour's share x half an hour. **Enhanced**: the baseline's non-squad part, plus cups confirmed so far, plus predicted cups not yet confirmed: open baskets' unconfirmed invitees x the chance learned from synthetic history that they still confirm by then, unredeemed gifts x the learned chance of redemption, and the squad cups history says arrive from baskets and gifts not yet started. Each forecast uses only signals up to its time; a confirmed cup is counted once; an invitation or an unredeemed gift is never a confirmed drink.

## MEAN ABSOLUTE ERROR, CUPS, OVER 400 SYNTHETIC WINDOWS

| Squad share | 120 min before: baseline / enhanced | 60 min before: baseline / enhanced | 30 min before: baseline / enhanced | 10 min before: baseline / enhanced |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0% | 6.75 / 6.75 | 6.75 / 6.75 | 6.75 / 6.75 | 6.75 / 6.75 |
| 15% | 6.86 / 6.83 | 6.86 / 6.28 | 6.86 / 6.16 | 6.86 / 5.95 |
| 30% | 7.29 / 7.23 | 7.29 / 6.11 | 7.29 / 5.65 | 7.29 / 5.31 |
| 45% | 7.79 / 7.70 | 7.79 / 6.13 | 7.79 / 5.19 | 7.79 / 4.63 |

With no squad share the two are identical. The enhanced forecast improves only because the synthetic squad signals were generated to move with demand; on single days it can be worse, when walk-in demand moves and squads cannot see it. Not measured accuracy.

## SIGNALS AND WHERE THEY STAND

**Documented**: completed purchases (Chagee's Form 20-F: the business generates personal, transactional and other data; L-sec20f-data); in-app ordering at a chosen outlet (Vulcan Post, P-vulcanpost-comeback; App Store listing, P-appstore, not checked by us). **To confirm**: drink customisations and the pickup time chosen, in Chagee's Singapore app. **Proposed, needing collection and consent**: group size and confirmed quantities, suggestion accepted, edited or dismissed, gifts sent and redeemed, open baskets and invitations.

## INPUTS (ASSUMPTIONS.JSON SQUADCAST; ASSUMPTION, SYNTHETIC, NOT CHAGEE DATA)

**window minutes**: 30 minutes in the pickup window. The window is the peak hour's first half (store.hourly_demand_share), so its calendar baseline is the deck's own volume: cups a day x the peak hour's share / 2.

**lead minutes**: 120 minutes before the window that the playback starts. Display and simulation horizon.

**social share**: 0.3 share of the window's cups that come through squad group orders and gifts, on average (range 0, 0.5). Hypothesis to test; zero means no squad signals, and the enhanced forecast then equals the baseline.

**invites per basket**: 4 people invited to a group basket, on average (squad size 2 to 6) (range 2, 6). Illustrative.

**member conversion**: 0.75 share of invited members who confirm a drink (range 0.3, 1). Illustrative; the forecast does not know it and estimates it from synthetic history.

**confirm delay minutes**: 8 average minutes from a basket opening to a member confirming. Illustrative.

**gifts per window**: 1.5 gifts sent for this window, on average, at the default squad share (scales with the squad share). Illustrative.

**gift redeem share**: 0.6 share of gifts redeemed for this window. Illustrative; an unredeemed gift is never counted as a drink.

**gift redeem delay minutes**: 30 average minutes from sending a gift to its redemption. Illustrative.

**day shock sd**: 0.2 spread of the day's demand around the calendar baseline (both walk-in and squad cups move with it). Illustrative: why the calendar baseline misses on any one day.

**history windows**: 400 past synthetic windows the enhanced forecast learns its conversion and late-arrival rates from. Synthetic history, same generator, different seeds.

**eval windows**: 400 synthetic windows used to compare the two forecasts (appendix). Different seeds from the history.

**eval leads**: 120, 60, 30, 10 minutes before the window at which the forecasts are compared. Appendix table.

**day picks**: 0.8, 1, 1.25 actual cups against the calendar baseline for the three example days on the slide (quiet, typical, busy). Display: the example days are the seeds whose actual cups, as a share of the baseline, are closest to these.

**success pick**: 1.45 actual cups against the calendar baseline for the fourth example day on slide 07 (squad rush). Display: a success case chosen by rule, not by hand. Among the same 300 synthetic windows, only those where the squad forecast is closer than the history-only forecast at the slide's default minute; of those, the one whose actual cups are closest to this share of the baseline. The slide also states the share of all windows where the squad forecast was closer, so the case is not presented as typical of every day.

**drink mix**: Jasmine milk tea 0.35, Oolong milk tea 0.3, Black milk tea 0.2, Fresh fruit tea 0.15 share of cups by drink, for predicted cups not yet chosen. Illustrative generic drinks, not Chagee's menu or sales mix.

**Course link**: OPIM639 Topic 1, slide 12 (capture demand data, not just sales data) and slide 13 (personalised service); Topic 2, slide 17 (the operator that provides fulfilment holds the detailed data). C-topic1, C-topic2.

SPEAKER NOTES · GROUP ORDERS TO FORECASTS: METHOD AND RESULTS

Soft copy only. Backup for the group-orders slide: the forecast definitions, the synthetic comparison and every input.

# Can the same crew handle a more complex menu?

**BUSINESS PROBLEM** Introducing toppings adds work to some orders. As uptake grows, how can Chagee maintain service speed while controlling cost?

Toppings plan: project-provided context, to confirm with Chagee




**AT THE PEAK** · click a person, a machine or the screen

### Standard drinks flow

Before toppings: cup and ice, tea and milk, finishing, sealing, hand-over. Follow the numbered cups; the crew keeps up.

### Toppings are introduced

Some tickets now carry a topping icon: those cups need an extra manual step at the topping bar. A proposed change, not today's workflow.

### Workloads become uneven

Every topping lands on Ben, so cups wait while Ana has time to spare. Simulated at 50% toppings: Ben busy about 88% of the peak, Ana about 34%.

### The manager considers the response

Can we share this extra work, or do we need dedicated capacity? A queue at one step is not a failing.

## Proposal 2: test whether a bucket brigade can absorb topping complexity with the same crew

PROPOSED DESIGN, NOT A MEASURED CHAGEE RESULT

✓ **Anticipate demand**
forecast how many orders will include toppings

✓ **Balance the work**
compare fixed responsibilities with a bucket brigade

✓ **Know the limit**
identify when dedicated staff or equipment is needed

## SPEAKER NOTES · CAN THE SAME CREW HANDLE A MORE COMPLEX MENU?

Solution two, in-store management. The order has reached an outlet; the question now is how that outlet fulfils it. We start with the person: the outlet manager at a busy hour. The business problem: introducing toppings adds work to some orders; as uptake grows, how can Chagee keep service fast while controlling cost? Say clearly that the toppings plan is our project's scenario: we found no documented Chagee plan to add toppings, so it is to confirm with Chagee, and toppings are not part of today's workflow as we show it.

The counter is driven by our simulation, not a cartoon loop: 120 orders an hour, three people, fixed responsibilities. Ana does cup and ice; Ben runs tea and milk, toppings and finishing; Cai the sealer and hand-over. Click Next through four points. One: standard drinks flow, no toppings, and the crew keeps up; follow the numbered cups. Two: toppings are introduced; some tickets now carry the topping icon and those cups take an extra manual step, 12 seconds in our assumption. Three: workloads become uneven; every topping lands on Ben, so cups wait on Ben's shelf while Ana has time to spare. At 50% of orders topped, Ben is busy about 88% of the hour and Ana about 34%, averaged over 20 simulated hours. The scene is one run: at minute 15 it shows 4 cups waiting for Ben; across many runs the median at that minute is 2, and about 31% of runs show 4 or more, so this run sits towards the long end. Four: the manager asks, can we share this extra work, or do we need dedicated capacity? Click a person, a machine or the screen for a short explanation; Pause stops the motion.

The layout, who does which step and the timings are our illustration, to validate by watching real peaks; a queue at one step is not a failing. The last Next shows the proposal: test whether a bucket brigade can absorb topping complexity with the same crew, in three ideas: anticipate demand, by forecasting how many orders include toppings; balance the work, by comparing fixed responsibilities with a bucket brigade; and know the limit, when dedicated staff or equipment is needed. Design aims, not measured results. About forty-five seconds.

# What a bucket brigade actually does

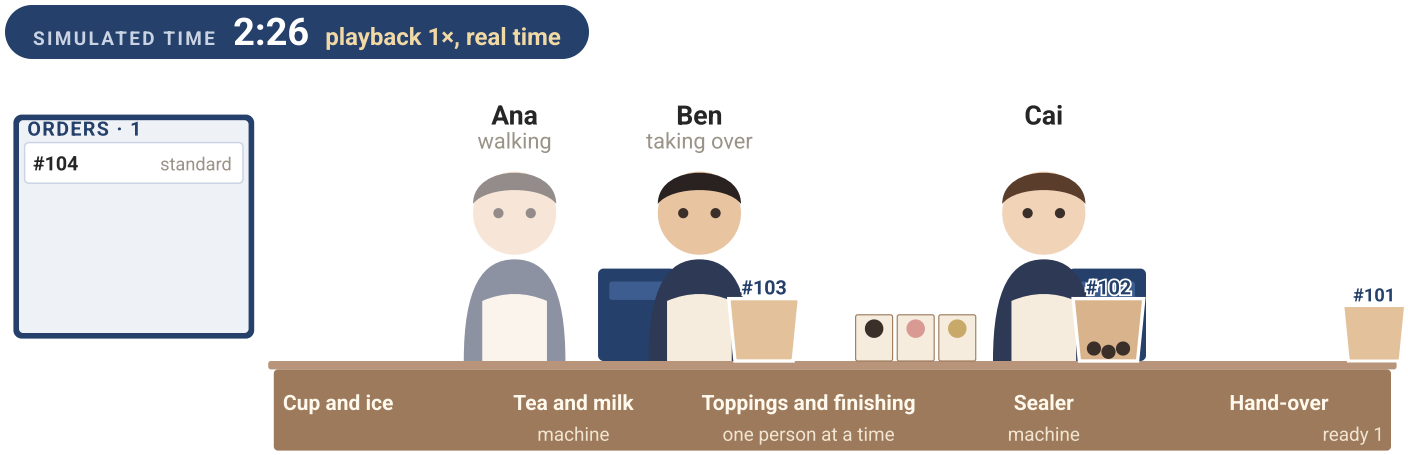
**THE SOLUTION** Test whether a bucket brigade can absorb topping complexity with the same crew. AI forecasts topping demand and workload; the brigade rule governs how trained staff share eligible work; the manager decides.

## 2 What it needs, where it stops

People trained on the steps they take over; hand-overs only between steps; nobody overtakes and one person per machine or spot. A full topping bar, dispenser or sealer cannot be fixed by moving people, and balance is not guaranteed when recipes vary. Flexible assistance, sending one person to help a busy station, is a different rule (appendix).

## 3 AI forecasts, the rule shares, the manager decides

AI would forecast how many orders include toppings and the workload they bring. The bucket-brigade rule, not AI, governs every hand-over. The manager keeps the brigade or adds dedicated capacity.




③ Ben takes over #103 from Ana at a safe point. Ana walks back.

### 1 Carry forward

Each person carries an order forward through the steps they are trained for.

### 2 Return and take over

When the last person hands an order over, they walk back and take over the upstream colleague's cup, as soon as that colleague finishes the step in hand.

### 3 The chain continues

That hand-over sends the colleague back to take over earlier work; the first person starts the next order.

**TAKEAWAY** | Trained people pass work back up the line at safe points, so spare time flows to the extra topping work. It cannot add machine or bar capacity.

A proposed operating rule to trial, not a measured Chagee result.

## SPEAKER NOTES · WHAT A BUCKET BRIGADE ACTUALLY DOES

What a bucket brigade actually does, in three steps; Next, Previous and Replay drive it. Step one plays one complete hand-over cycle slowly, from our simulation, with labelled people and numbered cups. The rule has three parts. One: each person carries an order forward through the steps they are trained for. Two: when the last person hands an order over, they walk back and take over the cup of the colleague upstream, but only once that colleague finishes the step in hand, a safe point. Three: that hand-over sends the colleague back to take over earlier work, and the first person starts the next order. On screen: Cai hands over order 101, walks back to the sealer and takes order 102 from Ben; Ben walks back and takes order 103 from Ana; Ana starts order 104. Nobody decided who helps whom: the rule moved the spare time to where the work was.

Step two, what it needs and where it stops. People must be trained on the steps they take over: Cai is not yet trained on toppings and finishing, so Cai waits at the sealer. Cups change hands only between steps, never mid-topping. Nobody overtakes, and one person at a time uses each machine and spot. Two limits to say out loud: if the topping bar, a dispenser or the sealer is full, moving people adds no capacity there; and with very uneven recipes, balance is not guaranteed. And we keep it separate from ordinary help-the-busy-station behaviour: that is flexible assistance, a different rule, kept as an alternative in the appendix.

Step three, keep the roles apart. AI would forecast topping demand and workload: how many orders in the next hour, and what share with toppings. That forecast is proposed, not built. The bucket-brigade rule governs how trained staff share eligible work; no AI directs any hand-over. The manager decides whether the brigade is enough or dedicated capacity is needed. Course link: Week 5's bucket brigade. About one minute.

# Fixed responsibilities or a bucket brigade?

**Share of orders with toppings** in a pilot, from the AI forecast; here, set by hand **50%**

SIMULATED PEAK **60:00** of 60:00 hour over

## A Fixed responsibilities

each person keeps their own steps; cups wait on a pass shelf

ready 117 · in progress 7




## B Bucket brigade

carry forward, walk back, take over at a safe point

ready 122 · in progress 2




**Order-to-ready time** median · 90th percentile

A **2:09** 5:28 B **1:15** 2:47 — B 54 s faster

**Orders completed in the peak** of 119 placed

A **112** B **116** — +4 with B

**Paid labour cost, this hour** 3 people × S$15.06

A **S$45** B **S$45** — same crew · S$0.40 vs S$0.39 an order

**Task:** toppings add 12 s to one step · **Work content:** 42 s standard, 54 s with toppings, the same on A and B · **Customer waiting:** order to ready, including queueing; only this changes · mean of 20 simulated peak hours; the animation plays one

MANAGER'S DECISION

**Operations manager / outlet GM**

**As topping demand grows, can the existing crew balance the extra work, or should we add dedicated capacity?**

PROPOSED

Trial the brigade against fixed responsibilities as toppings launch; keep the crew while service holds.

IF THE CREW CANNOT KEEP UP

A dedicated topping person or topping-dispensing equipment; a robotic arm only as an investigation →. See execution steps →

NEXT With orders sent to an outlet with room and the counter fulfilling them, where should the next outlet be?

## SPEAKER NOTES · FIXED RESPONSIBILITIES OR A BUCKET BRIGADE?

Now the comparison. Two views of the same counter: A, fixed responsibilities, and B, a bucket brigade. Held identical: the three people and their paid hour, the equipment, the incoming orders, which orders carry toppings, and every step's time; only the rule for sharing the work changes. The main slider is the share of orders with toppings: in a pilot that would come from the AI forecast; here you set it, and both views get the same order sequence with the same orders topped. The clock and playback speed are at the top; Skip to end shows the full hour. The numbers below are the average of 20 simulated peak hours; the animation plays one of them.

At 50% toppings, 120 orders an hour: median order-to-ready time is about 2:09 under fixed responsibilities and 1:15 with the brigade, and orders completed in the hour about 112 against 116. Paid labour cost is the same, S$45 for the hour: the same three people. The brigade moves work to where the spare time is; it does not cut paid labour. Keep three measures apart: task duration, a topping adds 12 seconds to one step; work content, 42 seconds for a standard order and 54 with toppings, the same under both rules; and customer waiting, order to ready, which also includes time queued. Only the last changes between A and B.

Show where it gives little. Slide to no toppings: both complete about 116 and 117 orders, so the brigade adds little to throughput, though the median falls from 1:09 to 0:56. Slide to all orders topped: fixed falls to about 100 completed; the brigade keeps about 114. Open Assumptions: at the longest topping time, 30 seconds, with every order topped, the one-person topping bar would need 120% of its time, so no sharing rule can complete more than about 100 orders an hour there: fixed completes about 67, the brigade 82. Moving people cannot add bar time; a second position lifts the brigade to about 88. Training Cai on toppings changes little here, a median of about 1:14 against 1:15, because Ana already has the spare time; with a different crew it may matter more, which Assumptions lets you test.

1

### CONFIRM THE TOPPINGS PLAN AND TIME THE COUNTER

Which drinks would carry toppings and what uptake is expected; time each step with and without toppings at real peaks.

2

### CHECK TRAINING, SPACE AND SAFE HAND-OVER POINTS

Who is trained on toppings and finishing; whether two people can work at the topping bar; where a cup can be passed safely.

3

### TRIAL THE BRIGADE AGAINST FIXED RESPONSIBILITIES

Alternate the two rules on comparable peaks, off-peak first; run the topping-share forecast in shadow mode alongside.

4

### DECIDE ON DEDICATED CAPACITY

If order-to-ready time or orders completed slip as topping share rises, or the bar is the limit, cost a dedicated topping person or topping-dispensing equipment.

**Decision-maker:** the operations manager or outlet GM decides after each step whether to continue. Dedicated staff and topping-dispensing equipment are follow-up alternatives; a robotic arm stays an investigation needing evidence on topping compatibility, cleaning, space, safety, throughput and cost ( **equipment, appendix →**). No labour saving, sales or profit is estimated.

#### THE TOPPINGS COMPARISON: EVERY SETTING (ASSUMPTIONS.JSON TOPPINGS; ILLUSTRATIVE, TO VALIDATE WITH CHAGEE)

| | |
|---|---|
| Toppings plan | Introducing toppings is project-provided context (our team's scenario). We found no documented Chagee plan to add toppings; to confirm with Chagee. |
| Counter | cup and ice 10 s and hand-over 8 s by hand (stations.human_seconds_per_cup); tea and milk 10 s and the sealer 8 s by machine (stations.machine_seconds_per_cup), attended by whoever carries the cup, one cup at a time |
| Finishing and toppings | finishing 6 s on every order; toppings 12 s more on orders with toppings (Assumptions: 4–30 s). Together they replace the deck's 12 s topping/finish step on these slides, so topping work is not counted twice |
| Crew | Ana speed 1.2, trained on toppings and finishing; Ben speed 1.0, trained on toppings and finishing; Cai speed 0.8, not yet trained on toppings and finishing (ops_tool.crew) |
| A: fixed responsibilities | Ana: cup and ice; Ben: tea and milk, toppings, finishing; Cai: sealer, hand-over; cups pass on a shelf |
| B: bucket brigade | Week 5's rules with safe hand-overs: carry forward through trained steps; the last person walks back and takes over the upstream colleague's cup when that colleague finishes the step in hand; nobody overtakes |
| Moving and passing | 1 s to walk one station; 2 s for every pass between people, on both sides |
| Topping bar | 1 person at a time by default; Assumptions tries two |
| Orders | 120 an hour, one drink each, Poisson arrivals; task-time variation ±25%; the same order sequence and topping draws on A and B; an order has toppings when its draw is below the share |
| Measured | one 60-minute peak from an empty counter; orders placed in it followed up to 30 more minutes; 20 runs per setting |
| Paid labour | 3 people × S$15.06 an hour (costs.labour_cost_per_hour), the same on both sides |

The AI forecast of topping demand is proposed, not built: on the comparison page the share is set by hand. The alternative, flexible assistance with a manager's tablet, is kept on its own pages: **how the tablet works →**. **Back to the comparison →**

SPEAKER NOTES · PROPOSAL 2: EXECUTION STEPS

Proposal 2's execution steps: confirm the toppings plan and time the counter; check training, space and safe hand-over points; trial the brigade against fixed responsibilities with the topping-share forecast in shadow mode; then decide on dedicated capacity. Below them, every setting of the toppings comparison page and where it comes from. No labour saving or profit is estimated.

Separate rule · not a bucket brigade

# From live workload to a practical staffing recommendation

**THE SOLUTION** Spot the next bottleneck and put help where it matters: AI predicts the workload, operational rules compare feasible actions, and the manager decides.

### 1 See the workload

Outstanding orders and drink mix, task times and equipment status, staff assignments and skills, and expected demand reach the manager's tablet. Orders are recorded today; step timestamps, equipment status and a skills record are proposed and need instrumentation.

### 2 Predict the constraint

AI predicts the workload; bottleneck analysis finds the step where work due exceeds capacity, across a forecast range. The longest list, at the order screen, is not the constraint.

### 3 Recommend a feasible response

Move one trained colleague with time to spare, keep the allocation, or escalate when the crew or the equipment cannot resolve the constraint. The manager approves or declines.

RECOMMENDATION **REASSIGN**

## Finishing is building up. Assign Ana, available and trained, to help, then review when the backlog clears.

**Why Ana:** trained on finishing; about 32% of Ana's time is predicted spare at cup and ice.

**Ana's own step:** cup and ice stays Ana's; Ana goes back whenever 3 drinks wait there.

**Review:** the help ends once finishing is down to 1 drink or fewer.

**Not the others:** Ben already works finishing; Cai is not yet trained on finishing.

**Outlet manager**
approves or declines; nothing moves until then

## Not every rush needs a move

**KEEP** **Keep the current allocation**
No step is building up: the backlog clears without moving anyone.

**ESCALATE** **No one trained has time to spare**
Moving someone would only move the queue: call in cover, or steer new orders (Proposal 1).

**ESCALATE** **Equipment is the constraint**
If the sealer runs slow, moving people adds no capacity: fix or work around the machine.

**AI predicts → rules compare feasible actions → the manager decides**

Bottleneck analysis · Capacity · Workload balancing

See execution steps →

**TAKEAWAY** | Put help where capacity falls short, only from someone trained with time to spare, and stop once the backlog clears.
A proposed design to test in shadow mode, not a measured Chagee result.

## SPEAKER NOTES · ALTERNATIVE: FLEXIBLE ASSISTANCE, THE BOTTLENECK TABLET

An alternative to the bucket brigade, kept from an earlier version of Proposal 2: flexible assistance, where a tablet suggests sending one trained colleague to help at a busy step. It is a different rule from the brigade and is not part of our recommendation. How the tool works, in three steps; Next, Previous and Replay drive it, and the small i icons open the detail. Step one, see the workload. Four inputs reach the manager's tablet: outstanding orders and their drink mix; task times and equipment status; current staff assignments and skills; and expected incoming demand. Be precise about the data. Orders are recorded today, as far as we know, and the demand forecast is built from them. Step-level timestamps, equipment status and a skills record are proposed: they need instrumentation or a new record before any pilot.

Step two, predict the constraint. AI predicts the workload over the next 15 minutes; bottleneck analysis then compares the work due at each step with that step's capacity. Finishing is the constraint, because work due there exceeds what Ben can do, while the order screen has the longest list but is quick. So we do not assume the longest visible queue is the bottleneck. The forecast is uncertain, so the tool projects the low, base and high end, here plus or minus 20%, and says whether its call holds across them.

Step three, recommend a feasible response. Operational rules compare the feasible actions: who is trained, who has time to spare, and what happens to their own step. The call here: finishing is building up, so assign Ana, who is available and trained, to help, then review when the backlog clears. Ana's own step stays Ana's: Ana goes back whenever 3 drinks wait there. Cai is not yet trained on finishing, so Cai is not eligible. The manager approves or declines. The tool can also say keep the current allocation, when nothing is building up, or escalate, when no one trained has time to spare or when equipment such as the sealer is the constraint, because moving people adds no machine capacity. Keep the roles distinct: AI predicts, operational rules compare feasible actions, the manager decides.

Separate rule · not a bucket brigade

# Compare the options before moving the crew

**Counter workload** · A busy outlet at the lunch rush · 12:05 — Incoming drinks an hour **260**

| LONGEST LIST Order screen | Cup and ice | Tea and milk | Finishing | Sealer | Hand-over |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| machine | Ana | machine | Ben + Ana | machine | Cai |
| 7 waiting | 1 waiting | 1 waiting | 6 waiting | 0 waiting | 1 waiting |
| 16% of capacity | 68% of capacity | 82% of capacity | 95% of capacity | 71% of capacity | 90% of capacity |

**Ana** — A — On cup and ice → helps at finishing
Busy at own step, next 15 min 68%
CAN HELP AT · ONE STEP AT A TIME
- Help at finishing — trying
- Help at hand-over — eligible

**Ben** — B — On finishing · trained on every hand step
Busy at own step, next 15 min — over capacity
CAN HELP AT · ONE STEP AT A TIME
- Help at cup and ice — busy
- Help at hand-over — busy

**Cai** — C — On hand-over · newer
Busy at own step, next 15 min 75%
CAN HELP AT · ONE STEP AT A TIME
- Help at cup and ice — eligible
- Help at finishing — not trained

THE TABLET RECOMMENDS **REASSIGN**

Finishing is building up. Assign Ana, available and trained, to help, then review when the backlog clears.

Finishing: work due is about 120% of capacity over the next 15 minutes; Ana has about 32% spare at cup and ice.

Forecast range ±20%: at the low end, keep; at the high end, escalate.

| | CURRENT ALLOCATION | THIS ALLOCATION |
|---|---|---|
| **Order-to-ready** median, min:s | 3:46 runs 2:47–4:50 | 3:08 0:39 faster runs 2:04–4:05 |
| **Orders completed** in 15 min | 64 16 still in progress | 67 +4 13 still in progress |
| **Workload** share of time · striped: moving | Ana 68% · Ben 99% · Cai 72% | Ana 90% · Ben 97% · Cai 77% |

BOTTLENECK ANALYSIS · CAPACITY · WORKLOAD BALANCING — Same crew and paid hours, equipment, incoming drinks and drink mix on both sides · reassignment moves work; it does not reduce paid labour cost

MANAGER'S DECISION
**Operations manager / outlet GM**

**Should I reassign someone now, retain the current allocation, or escalate because the available crew cannot resolve the constraint?**

PROPOSED
Let the tablet recommend; the manager approves, declines or escalates. Run it in shadow mode first, then pilot.

NEXT STEPS
See execution steps →
Equipment purchases: a separate investigation (appendix) →

## SPEAKER NOTES · ALTERNATIVE: TRY THE MANAGER'S TABLET

The alternative, flexible assistance, live. The tablet is the main visual: the counter's steps with the drinks waiting now and the predicted load against capacity; the three staff cards with each person's step and the steps they are trained for; and one recommendation with its reason. The crew, equipment, incoming drinks and drink mix are held identical between the allocations compared; only who does which step changes. Every number is an illustrative simulation on our assumptions, not Chagee data.

At 260 drinks an hour, the tablet recommends moving Ana to help at finishing. Press Try this allocation. Over the next 15 minutes, the median order-to-ready time goes from about 3:46 to 3:08, and orders completed from about 64 to 67. Workload evens out: Ana works more, Ben stays busy. It is not free: Ana changes step about 6 times, paying 20 seconds of set-up on every move and 3 seconds of coordination on every drink away from cup and ice, and goes back whenever 3 drinks wait there. The help ends when finishing's backlog clears. The result comes from a separate seeded simulation, not from the recommendation, so a recommended move could lose.

Move the demand. Below about 210 drinks an hour the tablet says keep the current allocation. From about 280 it says escalate, because even with help finishing keeps building, and at the top no one trained on finishing has time to spare. Tick Sealer running slow: the constraint becomes the sealer, the tablet escalates, and moving Ana to finishing changes nothing: about 44 orders completed either way. Click a staff card's steps to try any allocation; Cai cannot be moved to finishing, not being trained, and nobody can help at two steps at once.

Two cautions out loud. Reassignment does not reduce paid labour cost: the same three people are paid either way; it moves work to where it is needed. And these are simulated results under stated assumptions. The decision belongs to the operations manager or outlet GM: reassign someone now, keep the current allocation, or escalate because the available crew cannot resolve the

1

### OBSERVE AND VALIDATE THE COUNTER

Watch real rushes: the steps, who does what, task times and how often one step queues while another is free.

2

### CONFIRM THE DATA

Order and drink detail, equipment status, the roster and a skills record: what exists, what needs logging.

3

### RUN IN SHADOW MODE

The tablet predicts and recommends, but nothing is shown to the crew; compare its calls with what managers did and what happened.

4

### PILOT MANAGER-APPROVED ACTIONS

Managers approve or decline. Measure order-to-ready time, orders completed, disruption to the original step, and how often managers override.

**Decision-maker:** the operations manager or outlet GM decides after each step whether to continue. No timing, cost, labour saving or profit is estimated. Equipment purchases are a separate investigation: **machine comparison, appendix →**

#### THE TABLET'S INPUTS

| Input | What | Status |
|---|---|---|
| Outstanding orders and drink mix | orders not ready yet, drinks on each | recorded today, as far as we know · orders recorded · drink detail to confirm |
| Task times and equipment status | time per step; machine slow or down | proposed: needs instrumentation or a new record · proposed · needs step timestamps |
| Staff assignments and skills | who is where; who is trained for what | proposed: needs instrumentation or a new record · roster to confirm · skills record to build |
| Expected incoming demand | forecast for the next quarter hour | recorded today, as far as we know · forecast from recorded orders |

#### THE ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO AND THE RULES (ASSUMPTIONS.JSON OPS_TOOL; TO VALIDATE WITH CHAGEE)

| | |
|---|---|
| Counter | today's split (our scenario): machines on order screen, tea and milk, sealer; seconds per drink from stations.*, machine units as the counter simulation |
| Crew | Ana on cup and ice, trained on cup and ice, finishing, hand-over; Ben on finishing, trained on cup and ice, finishing, hand-over; Cai on hand-over, trained on hand-over, cup and ice; speeds 1 ± 0.2 (people.worker_speed_spread) |
| Drink mix | milk teas 50%, finishing ×0.75; fruit and topped teas 50%, finishing ×1.5 |
| Demand | 260 drinks an hour by default, slider 150–380; forecast range ±20% |
| Comparison | the next 15 minutes; 24 seeded runs per allocation, the same drinks and task-time variation for each |
| Waiting at the start | order screen 7, cup and ice 1, tea and milk 1, finishing 6, sealer 0, hand-over 1 |
| Moving | walking at illustration.walk_back_speed; 20 s set-up on every move; 3 s per drink away from one's own step (sharing.assist_handover_sec) |
| Review and return | a helper goes back when 3 drinks wait at their own step, and returns to help once it is clear; the help ends when the constraint is down to 1 |
| Rules | keep if the constraint clears within the window; escalate if it is a machine, or if no trained colleague with at least 20% spare time can clear it; otherwise the one move that leaves the least work waiting |
| Equipment scenario | Sealer running slow: the sealer at ×2.5 its seconds per drink |

#### WHAT WE DO NOT CLAIM

The counter layout, skills, timings and drink mix are ours, to validate by observing Chagee's counters; we have not observed them, and a queue at one step in a rush is not a failing. The demand forecast is an illustrative input, not a trained model. Reassignment moves work between the same paid people: no labour saving, sales or profit is estimated. Results are a simulation under stated assumptions. **Back to the tablet →**

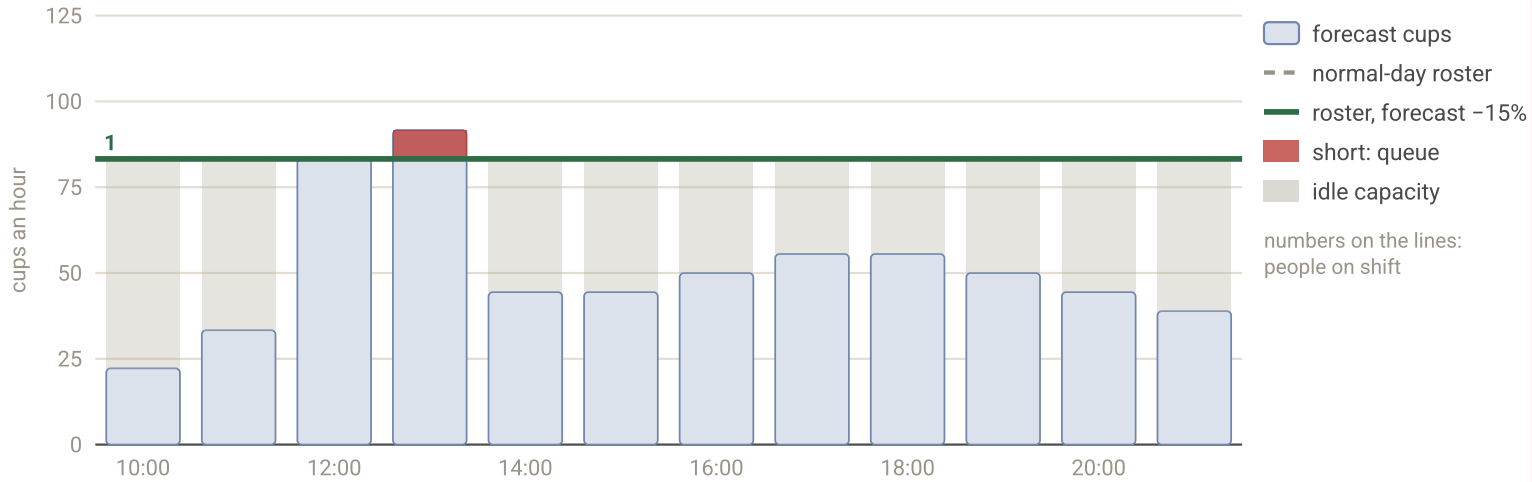
SPEAKER NOTES · FLEXIBLE-ASSISTANCE TABLET: STEPS, INPUTS AND RULES

The printed copy of the tablet's execution steps, with its inputs, which of them exist today, and the rules' illustrative settings. The tablet is flexible assistance, an alternative to the bucket brigade kept from an earlier version of Proposal 2. No timing, cost, labour saving or profit is estimated for it.

# A forecast sets the crew each hour needs

**BUSINESS PROBLEM** Staffing and task allocation may not match changing demand, leaving queues, walk-aways or idle capacity. Observed people deployed on local expertise (Chagee source, anonymous); long reopening queues (Vulcan Post). Simulated everything below. To confirm Chagee's waits and walk-aways.

CUPS AN HOUR AGAINST CREW CAPACITY · BUSY DAY · ILLUSTRATIVE SIMULATION




SHOWN

Busy day, today's split, forecast −15% low. Other days: the deck's interactive version.

**TAKEAWAY** | Forecast −15% low: **1** at the peak, **20.8%** walk away, S$372 a day; peak-hour contribution **S$233** against S$287 with an exact forecast.

SPEAKER NOTES · DEMAND MOVES BY THE HOUR

Solution two, in-store management. The order has reached the outlet; now the counter has to serve it. The business problem: staffing and task allocation may not match changing demand. The solution: forecast staffing requirements and compare practical ways to organise people and machines. What we have observed: a Chagee source who asked not to be named told us outlet teams deploy people on local expertise, and Vulcan Post reported long queues at the Singapore reopening. What we have not observed: Chagee's own wait times and walk-aways. Everything on the chart is simulated, on our assumptions.

Step one is the forecast: cups an hour from historical order shares and the calendar. App signals, like the squad signals in the appendix, could refine it nearer the time, but they are not in these numbers. Step two: keep the normal-day roster on a busier day and the peak runs short, in red, while the morning crew stands idle, in grey. Step three: the forecast roster follows demand. Keep three things apart: the forecast says how many people; a sharing rule decides how they share the work; machines decide which steps people do at all. The next slide compares two ways for the same crew to share the work, then the equipment page compares automation setups; the bucket-brigade demonstration is in the appendix.

Step four, the sensitivity. On a busy day, a forecast 15% too low puts on 1 person at the peak instead of 2, and walk-aways go from 0.0% to about 21%. A forecast too high costs little: about S$15 more a day on an event day. The full table is behind Numbers. These error steps are scenarios, not Chagee's measured accuracy. About one minute.

# Use the same crew more effectively during peak periods

*Can the same crew serve peak demand better by changing how work is shared?*

**Order received** — machine 2 s → **Cup preparation** — person 10 s → **Dispensing** — machine 10 s + person 12 s → **Finishing and sealing** — machine 8 s → **Collection** — person 8 s

**Illustrative counter setup, to validate with Chagee.** Hand-over is an assumed 8 s step, not a drink's make time. All by hand a cup is 60 s of work; here people do 30 s.

**13:20:00** simulated · minute 20 of 60 · printed frame

Demand shown: 153 orders an hour.

## A Fixed responsibilities

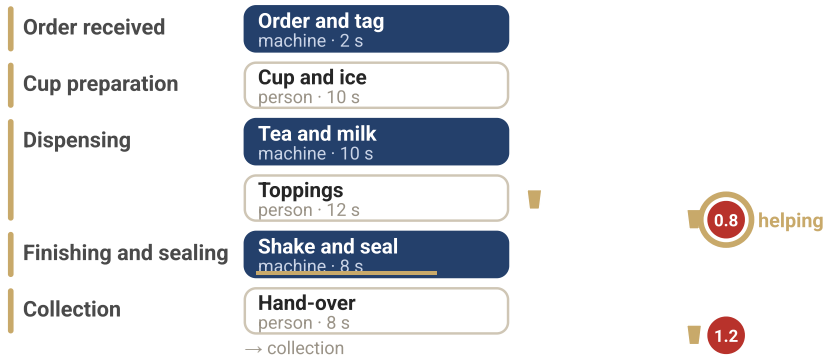
each person stays on their own steps · 2 people




orders placed **53** ready **35** in progress **12** walked away **6**

## B Flexible assistance

a free person helps a queued step · 2 people




orders placed **53** ready **49** in progress **4** walked away **0**

### ORDER-TO-READY · MEDIAN / 90TH PERCENTILE

A **4:10** / 6:28

B **2:04** / 4:18

### ORDERS COMPLETED IN THE PEAK HOUR

A **134** of 151 · 11 unfinished · 7 away

B **144** of 151 · 7 unfinished · 1 away

### PAID LABOUR FOR THE HOUR

A **S$30** · 2 people

B **S$30** · the same crew

Mean of 20 simulated peak hours at 153 orders an hour · orders placed 13:00–14:00, timed from order to collection · green: better.

**TAKEAWAY** | At 153 orders an hour the same 2 people, sharing flexibly: median 4:10 → **2:04**, 90th percentile 6:28 → **4:18**, 134 → **144** orders completed, same paid hour. A simulation result under our assumptions.

SPEAKER NOTES · SHARE THE WORK AT THE PEAK

The question for the operations manager: can the same crew serve peak demand better just by changing how the work is shared? The top strip is the counter as a sequence: order received, cup preparation, dispensing, finishing and sealing, collection, with machines on three steps and people on three. That split is our illustrative setup, to validate with Chagee; it is not Chagee's operation.

Be precise about the timing. The hand-over is an assumed 8-second step, not the time to make a drink. If every step were done by hand, a cup would take 60 seconds of human work in total; in this setup people do 30 seconds of it. Work content, the time between finished cups and the customer's order-to-ready time are three different measures: the last one includes waiting in queues.

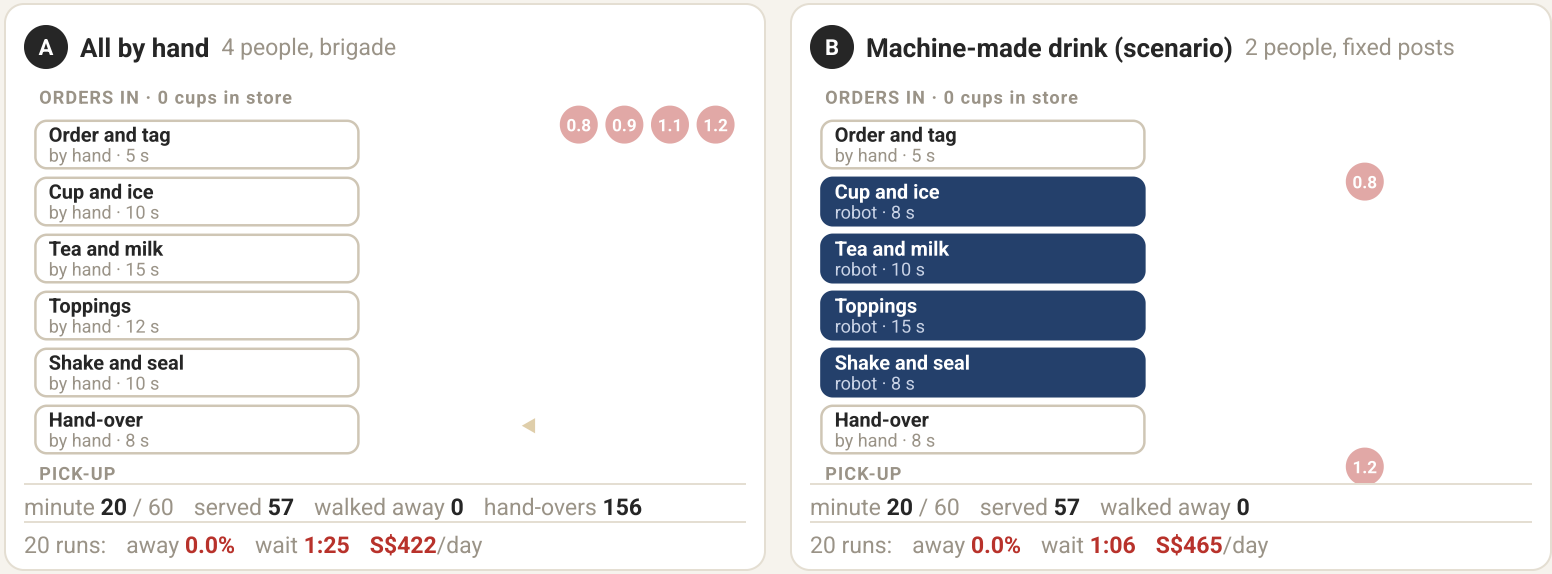
Counter A keeps fixed responsibilities: each of the 2 people stays on their own steps, using the split that balances the work best. Counter B allows flexible assistance: when a person's own steps have nothing waiting, they walk to another hand step with at least 2 cups waiting and help, paying the walk and 3 seconds of coordination on every cup; they go back as soon as their own step has work. This is a separate rule from the bucket brigade in the appendix. Same crew, machines, orders and drink times on both sides.

Play it at the event-day peak: on A, cups pile up at toppings while the colleague on cup and ice stands free. In the mean of 20 runs, B's median order-to-ready time is about 2:04 against 4:10, and its upper percentile 4:18 against 6:28, for the same paid hour. Move the demand to the normal-day peak: both rules perform the same, because no one is overloaded. These are simulation results under stated assumptions, not observations.

Forecast-informed staffing (the forecasting page) and machine investment (the equipment page) are separate comparisons, so each improvement keeps its cause. The decision is on the operations decision page. About one and a half minutes.

# In our model, one tea-and-milk machine is cheapest every day

PEAK HOUR · ILLUSTRATIVE SIMULATION




Navy = robot, white = by hand (click to switch) · red circle = a person · faded = walking · red cup = waiting for a person.

COST A DAY · EVENT DAY · WITHIN THE WALK-AWAY LIMIT

| | |
|---|---|
| One machine (tea and milk) ✓ | S$335 |
| Today's split (our scenario) | S$402 |
| All by hand | S$422 |
| Machine-made drink (scenario) | S$465 |
| All robots | S$562 |

✓ cheapest that keeps walk-aways within 2%. Full table: Numbers.

**TAKEAWAY** | One machine on tea and milk lets the roster drop a person off-peak for the cost of one unit. That holds only while a unit costs more than about S$905 a month; Chagee's real cost is unknown.

SPEAKER NOTES · SPLIT THE COUNTER

The forecast set how many people, and the sharing page how they share the work; this slide asks which counter steps go to machines. Side A opens on human-only: people do every step. Side B opens on machine-made drink: machines make the drink, people tag the order and hand it over. Both are our illustrative scenarios, not Chagee's disclosed setup. Chagee's own equipment cost is not public; its Singapore relaunch used semi-automated equipment, according to Vulcan Post.

Keep two things apart. Machine automation is the split, the equipment on each side. AI here is AI-assisted staffing: the demand forecast sets the crew. Numbers shows the AI layer on its own. Each side keeps its equipment, customers and sharing rule; only the crew moves from the normal-day roster to the forecast roster. On an event day, all by hand without AI has 2 people, and about 40% of peak-hour orders walk away; with AI the forecast puts on 4, walk-aways fall to 0.0%, median wait 5:32 to 1:24, for S$422 a day against S$361. On the machine-made drink the forecast keeps 1 person, so AI changes nothing there: 7.2% still walk away, and the split table adds a person to meet the limit. In our model, forecasting matters most where people do the work. The band follows the day and the equipment you pick; walk-aways and wait are the peak hour, mean of 20 runs; cost is the day's roster plus machines, without lost sales. Illustrative assumptions throughout.

How to use it: choose a split for each side, or click any station to hand it to a robot or a person, then run the peak hour or press End to compare. Each side starts with the fewest people, from the forecast roster up, that keep walk-aways within 2%.

The bars on the right compare five options on the chosen day, cheapest first; the full table is behind Numbers, mean of 20 runs: today's split, the machine-made drink, all by hand, all robots, and one tea-and-milk machine from the machine ladder in the appendix. In our model, one tea-and-milk machine is the cheapest of the five on every day type, because it lets the roster drop a

# Roster to the forecast, test flexible sharing, pilot one machine

ONE LEVER PER COLUMN · PEAK HOUR · EVENT DAY · MEAN OF 20 RUNS

| CRITERION | TODAY<br>normal-day roster · today's split | + FORECAST<br>forecast roster · today's split | PROPOSED PILOT<br>+ ONE MACHINE<br>forecast roster · tea-and-milk machine |
|---|---|---|---|
| Crew at the peak | 1 | 2 | **3** |
| Median wait | 7:24 | 2:38 | **1:44** |
| Walk-aways | 53.8% | 1.2% | **0.2%** |
| Cups served per person, peak hour | 69 | 74 | **50** |
| Peak-hour contribution | S$230 | S$491 | **S$482** |
| Cost a day: roster and machines | S$372 | S$402 | **S$335** |
| Flexible sharing, same crew: median ready time (sharing page) | one person, no one to help | 4:10 → 2:04 | **2:18 → 2:14** |

READING THE TABLE

**Green** is the proposed pilot. Each column adds one lever: the forecast changes only the crew, the machine only the equipment. The upper rows share work by the bucket brigade (appendix); the last row compares the sharing page's two rules with that column's crew and machines. Illustrative simulation.

IF THE FORECAST IS OFF

A busy-day forecast 15% too low leaves about **21%** walking away (forecasting page).

MANAGER'S DECISION

**Operations manager / outlet GM**

**What staffing, task allocation and equipment best meet demand at an acceptable service level and cost?**

PROPOSED, CONDITIONAL

In 3 outlets, try flexible assistance at the peak first; where queues remain, roster to the forecast or pilot one tea-and-milk machine. Simulated gains hold only under our assumptions.

MEASURE IN THE PILOT

- actual task times and equipment cycles
- who works which step, and movement limits
- order arrivals and order-to-ready times

NEXT After improving fulfilment across existing outlets, where would an additional store improve access and create value?

SPEAKER NOTES · THE OPERATIONS MANAGER'S DECISION

The decision for solution two belongs to the operations manager or outlet GM: what staffing, task allocation and equipment best meet demand at an acceptable service level and cost?

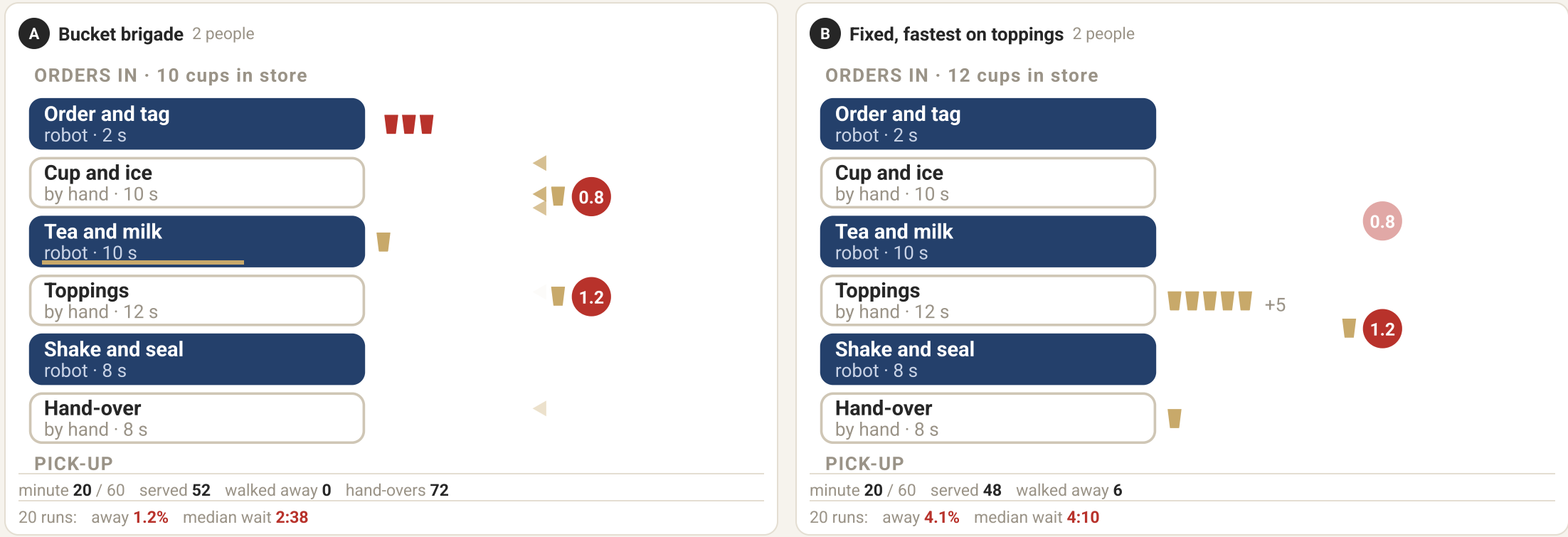
Read the table left to right; each column changes one lever. First, today: today's split and the normal-day roster. Second, the forecast changes only the crew. Third, a machine changes only the equipment, with the forecast crew. The upper rows share work by the bucket brigade, now in the appendix; the last row keeps each column's crew and machines and compares fixed responsibilities with flexible assistance, the sharing page's rules, so the sharing rule shows up on its own. That keeps task allocation, forecast staffing and machines apart.

The criteria are the ones the brief asks for: waiting time, walk-aways, productivity as cups served per person at the peak, and operating contribution. And the forecast will be wrong sometimes: on a busy day a forecast 15% too low lets about 21% walk away, while a forecast too high costs only about S$15 a day on an event day.

Our proposal is conditional. Try flexible assistance first, because it costs no extra paid hours: in the simulation it helps where one hand step queues while a colleague is free, as with the forecast crew on an event day, and changes little where no one is overloaded or where a machine already reshapes the work. Where queues remain, the fix is crew (roster to the forecast) or equipment (pilot one tea-and-milk machine against today's split), in 3 outlets. Every gain here is a simulation result under stated assumptions. The pilot must measure actual task times, equipment cycles, who works which step and how far they can move, order arrivals and order-to-ready times. Then the transition: after improving fulfilment across existing outlets, where would an additional store improve access and create value?

# A bucket brigade balances a lean crew by itself

PEAK HOUR · SAME CUSTOMERS ON BOTH SIDES · ILLUSTRATIVE SIMULATION




Red circle = a person (number = speed) · gold ring = held back · faded = walking · ▲ = hand-over · navy = robot · red cup = waiting for a person

**TAKEAWAY** | With a lean crew, work flows to whoever is free, so the line balances itself. With spare people, well-assigned fixed posts are as good or a little faster.

SPEAKER NOTES · SHARE THE COUNTER

The forecast on the forecasting page set how many people. This slide is how they share the work: same counter, same customers, two sharing rules side by side. The counter is today's split, our scenario, not Chagee's disclosed setup. Robots, the navy boxes, take the order, brew tea and milk, and shake and seal. People do cup and ice, toppings and hand-over.

Left, a bucket brigade: each person carries a cup forward; the last hands it over, walks back and takes over a colleague's cup. Right, fixed stations: each person owns a station.

Press play on an event day. Then set the right side to "slowest on toppings": the queue builds at toppings and customers walk away. The brigade never needed to know who was fast.

Be honest about the other case: add people and fixed stations catch up, or are a little faster. About one minute.

If asked what the forecast changes here, open Numbers: the band there shows the AI layer on its own. Machines are automation, and here they stay exactly as they are: today's split on both sides. AI means AI-assisted staffing: the demand forecast sets the crew. Equipment, customers and each side's sharing rule are held fixed; only the crew changes. Without AI, the normal-day roster of 1 faces an event day: about 54% of peak-hour orders walk away with a brigade, 54% with fixed posts. With AI, the forecast crew of 2 brings that to 1.2% and 4.1%, for S$402 a day against S$372. The band follows the day you pick. Walk-aways and wait are the peak hour, mean of 20 runs; cost is the day's roster plus machines and leaves out lost sales. All illustrative assumptions.

Course link: the bucket-brigade simulation from Week 5 and Week 6, equipment and technology, inspired this counter replica. Same idea, a different use case.

# Counter comparisons for every day type

FORECASTING PAGE (EARLIER VERSION) · FORECAST ERROR: THE ROSTER FOLLOWS A WRONG FORECAST, THE CUSTOMERS DO NOT (TODAY'S SPLIT, BUCKET BRIGADE)

| Forecast | Normal day<br>crew · away · S$/day | Busy day<br>crew · away · S$/day | Event day<br>crew · away · S$/day |
|---|---|---|---|
| 30% low | 1 · 0.9% · S$372 | 1 · 20.8% · S$372 | 2 · 1.2% · S$402 |
| 15% low | 1 · 0.9% · S$372 | 1 · 20.8% · S$372 | 2 · 1.2% · S$402 |
| exact | 1 · 0.9% · S$372 | 2 · 0.0% · S$402 | 2 · 1.2% · S$402 |
| 15% high | 1 · 0.9% · S$372 | 2 · 0.0% · S$402 | 3 · 0.0% · S$417 |
| 30% high | 1 · 0.9% · S$372 | 2 · 0.0% · S$402 | 3 · 0.0% · S$432 |

BUCKET BRIGADE (APPENDIX) · SHARING RULES AT THE FORECAST CREW, TODAY'S SPLIT

| Rule | Normal day<br>crew · away · wait | Busy day<br>crew · away · wait | Event day<br>crew · away · wait |
|---|---|---|---|
| Bucket brigade | 1 · 0.9% · 2:08 | 2 · 0.0% · 1:14 | 2 · 1.2% · 2:38 |
| Fixed posts, fastest on toppings | 1 · 1.0% · 2:10 | 2 · 0.0% · 1:14 | 2 · 4.1% · 4:10 |
| Fixed posts, slowest on toppings | 1 · 1.0% · 2:10 | 2 · 0.7% · 3:26 | 2 · 34.9% · 9:47 |

SHARING PAGE (EARLIER VERSION) · SAME CREW OF 2, FIXED RESPONSIBILITIES AGAINST FLEXIBLE ASSISTANCE, AT EACH DAY TYPE'S PEAK HOUR

| Rule | Normal day peak, 61 orders an hour<br>median · 90% · completed · unfinished · away | Busy day peak, 92 orders an hour<br>median · 90% · completed · unfinished · away | Event day peak, 153 orders an hour<br>median · 90% · completed · unfinished · away |
|---|---|---|---|
| A · fixed responsibilities | 1:07 · 1:34 · 58 · 1 · 0 | 1:14 · 2:09 · 88 · 2 · 0 | 4:10 · 6:28 · 134 · 11 · 7 |
| B · flexible assistance | 1:07 · 1:32 · 58 · 1 · 0 | 1:13 · 1:54 · 88 · 2 · 0 | 2:04 · 4:18 · 144 · 7 · 1 |

EQUIPMENT PAGE · FIVE SETUPS: THE FEWEST PEOPLE THAT KEEP WALK-AWAYS WITHIN 2%

| Setup | Normal day<br>people · away · wait · S$/day | Busy day<br>people · away · wait · S$/day | Event day<br>people · away · wait · S$/day |
|---|---|---|---|
| Today's split (our scenario) | 1 · 0.9% · 2:08 · S$372 | 2 · 0.0% · 1:14 · S$402 | 2 · 1.2% · 2:38 · S$402 |
| Machine-made drink (scenario) | 1 · 0.0% · 1:14 · S$435 | 1 · 0.0% · 1:28 · S$435 | 2 · 0.0% · 1:06 · S$465 |
| All by hand | 2 · 0.3% · 1:16 · S$361 | 3 · 0.0% · 1:13 · S$392 | 4 · 0.0% · 1:24 · S$422 |
| All robots | – · 0.0% · 0:52 · S$562 | – · 0.0% · 0:52 · S$562 | – · 0.0% · 0:58 · S$562 |
| One machine (tea and milk) | 2 · 0.0% · 1:10 · S$305 | 2 · 0.1% · 1:36 · S$305 | 3 · 0.2% · 1:44 · S$335 |

THE FORECAST'S EFFECT AT THE COUNTER: NORMAL-DAY ROSTER → FORECAST ROSTER, SAME EQUIPMENT AND CUSTOMERS

| Setup, bucket brigade | Normal day<br>crew · away · S$/day | Busy day<br>crew · away · S$/day | Event day<br>crew · away · S$/day |
|---|---|---|---|
| Today's split (our scenario) | 1→1 · 0.9%→0.9% · S$372→S$372 | 1→2 · 20.8%→0.0% · S$372→S$402 | 1→2 · 53.8%→1.2% · S$372→S$402 |
| Machine-made drink (scenario) | 1→1 · 0.0%→0.0% · S$435→S$435 | 1→1 · 0.0%→0.0% · S$435→S$435 | 1→1 · 5.4%→5.4% · S$435→S$435 |
| All by hand | 2→2 · 0.3%→0.3% · S$361→S$361 | 2→3 · 5.8%→0.0% · S$361→S$392 | 2→4 · 40.1%→0.0% · S$361→S$422 |

Peak hour, mean of the seeded runs; cost is the day's roster and machines. Illustrative assumptions, not Chagee data.

SPEAKER NOTES · COUNTER COMPARISONS, EVERY DAY TYPE

Backup for the Serve chapter: the forecast-error sensitivity (forecasting page), the three sharing rules (bucket-brigade appendix), the five setups (equipment page) and the forecast's effect at the counter, for every day type.

 TBC · DRAFT, TO BE CONFIRMED

# Four modelled decisions by owner: where to open for the expansion manager; what to automate, how many people and how to share for the operations manager

| | DECISION | WHY, FROM THE MODEL | REVISIT WHEN |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 **Where to open** expansion manager · slide 06 · DBSCAN + assumed demand model | **Open where app searches cluster, not beside an existing outlet.** | **+731** against **+216** cups a day for the same new outlet. Synthetic app-search data: this shows the method, not a finding about real outlets. | Rerun on Chagee's app logs, if searches and location are recorded, before any lease. |
| 2 **What to automate** operations manager · equipment · physical AI | **In our model, one tea-and-milk machine is the cheapest on every day type; pilot it against today's split (our scenario).** | **S$305–335** a day against S$372–402. The two cost the same at about **S$905 a month per machine unit** (1 unit against 3), with wage, volume, station speeds and crews held fixed; we assume S$1,909. Amacha's S$10,000 is a one-off price; without machine life, upkeep and financing we cannot turn it into a monthly cost. | When Chagee's real machine cost is known. |
| 3 **How many people** operations manager · forecast page, benefit slide · forecast + economic rule | **Economic rule: add a person on event days, not on busy days.** | With the one machine: peak crew 2 → **3** on event days; 2 on busy days, where an extra person costs more than the orders it keeps. | When the forecast peak moves. |
| 4 **How to share** operations manager · bucket-brigade appendix | **Test a bucket brigade against fixed posts for the hand steps.** | In the recommended setup (one machine, 3 people, event day): **0.2%** walk away with a brigade, 0.4% with well-assigned fixed posts, 22% with badly assigned ones; median wait 1:44 against 2:18. | Fixed posts once there is spare staff. |

- **Pilot in 3 outlets**

| Shadow | Roster | Machine |
|---|---|---|
| forecast only | economic rule | one vs today's split |

KPIs: cups per labour hour, wait time and walk-aways at the peak. Compare forecast and actual cups weekly.

- **Limits we know**

All figures are illustrative assumptions, not Chagee data. Machine costs and speeds are assumed; breakdowns and breaks are not modelled.

- **To confirm with Chagee**

The real machine cost per unit, whether outlets log wait times and walk-aways, and how today's local staffing calls compare with the forecast.

**ASSUMED BASELINE** illustrative — One machine and a flat crew of 2 every day: **23%** of event-day peak orders walk away.

**PROPOSED SCENARIO** in our model — The forecast and the economic rule add a person on event days only (2 → 3): **0.2%** walk away; busy days stay at 2 (0.1%).

SPEAKER NOTES · THE DECISIONS IN DETAIL

**TBC:** this slide is a draft and still to be confirmed by the team; present it as work in progress.

The detail behind two of the three owners' decisions: four modelled decisions, one per simulation, all on our assumptions. The CRM manager's decision is in the appendix. One, for the expansion manager, where to open: DBSCAN clusters app searches and our assumed demand model scores the sites. The searches are synthetic, so this shows the method; rerun it on Chagee's app logs, if searches and location are recorded, before any lease.

Two to four belong to the outlet GM or operations manager. Two, what to automate: in our model one tea-and-milk machine is the cheapest on every day type, so pilot it against today's split, which is our scenario, not Chagee's disclosed setup. The two cost the same at about S$905 a month per machine unit, comparing one unit against three, with the wage, volume and crews held fixed. We assume S$1,909. We cannot turn the one-off price one small shop paid into a monthly cost without machine life, upkeep and financing, so Chagee's real cost decides this.

Three, how many people: the economic rule adds a person on event days but not on busy days. Four, how to share: test a bucket brigade against fixed posts; in the recommended setup the brigade does a little better than well-assigned fixed posts and much better than badly assigned ones. Then a pilot in 3 outlets: shadow the forecast, roster by the economic rule, and run one machine against today's split, judged on cups per labour hour, wait time and walk-aways. About one minute.

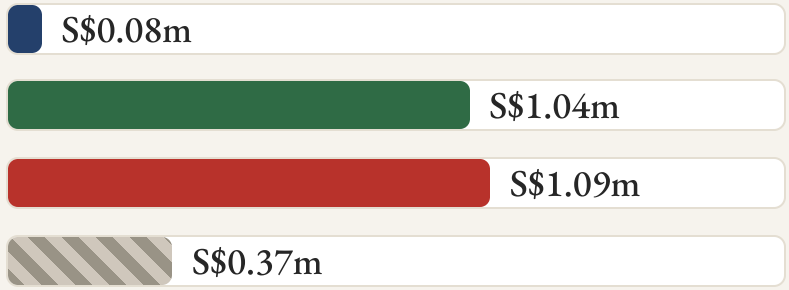
 TBC · DRAFT, TO BE CONFIRMED

# In our model, about S$1.09m a year across 44 outlets against an illustrative baseline, almost all from one machine's labour saving

*Modelled avoided costs on stated assumptions, not demonstrated savings and not savings against Chagee's actual operations, where the GM and teams staff on local expertise. The pilot compares one machine with today's split (our scenario).*

PROFIT A YEAR, ALL 44 OUTLETS · ECONOMIC RULE THROUGHOUT

AGAINST THE ILLUSTRATIVE ALL-HAND BASELINE (FLAT NORMAL-DAY ROSTER)




PILOT COMPARISON: THE PROPOSED SCENARIO AGAINST TODAY'S SPLIT (OUR SCENARIO), BOTH ON THE ECONOMIC RULE




Profit = orders kept × price × margin, plus labour saved, minus machine cost. Calendar: 104 busy days (weekends) and 11 event days (public holidays) a year, an illustrative definition. Baseline: all by hand, the normal-day crew every day. Peak hour only, so orders kept are a floor. Every figure, range and both crew rules: appendix.

PHYSICAL AI · ONE TEA-AND-MILK MACHINE

**Most of the benefit: labour**

Lets the roster drop from 2 people to 1 in the off-peak hours: **S$1.04m** a year after the machine's cost.

FORECAST + ECONOMIC RULE

**Adds event-day orders on top of the machine**

Adds a person on event days only (2 → 3), keeping about 35 more orders per outlet that day: 390 a year, **S$0.05m** across Singapore. On its own, all by hand: S$0.08m.

READ WITH CARE

**The big number rests on one assumption**

The minimum crew, 2 by hand and 1 with machines, is ours. Without it, S$1.09m falls to **S$0.37m**. The pilot arm beats today's split by S$1.22m: more than the headline, because today's split is itself S$0.14m below the baseline.

ASSUMED BASELINE
illustrative

Flat normal-day roster, all by hand: about **1,291** peak-hour orders a year walk away per outlet.

PROPOSED SCENARIO
in our model

Both levers, one run: **1,278** kept a year per outlet, profit **S$1.09m** across 44 outlets (S$0.37m without the minimum-crew rule).

SPEAKER NOTES · THE SIZE OF THE BENEFIT

**TBC:** this slide is a draft and still to be confirmed by the team; present it as work in progress.

One number and where it comes from, all in our model. Against an illustrative baseline, an all-by-hand counter with the normal-day crew every day, the proposed scenario gives about S$1.09m a year across 44 outlets. That baseline is ours, not Chagee's operations, so these are not savings Chagee would see; they are modelled avoided costs on stated assumptions. Every figure uses the economic rule, the rule the playbook recommends.

Read the bars. Almost all of it is the one tea-and-milk machine, which lets the roster drop a person off-peak. Rostering to the forecast by the economic rule adds a person on event days only and keeps about 35 more orders per outlet that day, S$0.05m a year across Singapore. The last bar is the pilot comparison: the proposed scenario against today's split, our scenario, both on the economic rule, a difference of S$1.22m.

Say the caveat out loud: the machine's saving comes from our minimum-crew assumption; without it, the total falls to about S$0.37m. Ranges and both crew rules are in the appendix. About one minute.

# Per outlet, about 61 orders kept on an event day and 5 on a busy day; on an illustrative calendar, S$7,539 of revenue a year

*Modelled avoided costs on stated assumptions, not demonstrated savings, against an illustrative baseline, not Chagee's operations. Economic rule for the headline figures. Peak hour only; conservative. Prices to our knowledge, based on public sources.*

Profit a year, 44 outlets: **S$1.09m** = counter automation, physical AI **S$1.04m** (depends on the minimum-crew rule) + forecast roster, predictive AI **S$0.05m** | Without / with the minimum-crew rule: **S$0.37m to S$1.09m**

## ONE OUTLET AT 556 CUPS A DAY · BOTH LEVERS, ONE RUN

**EVENT DAY**
61 orders kept
Revenue S$358 (× S$5.90) · profit S$241
Counter: labour saved − machine S$27

**BUSY DAY**
5.4 orders kept
Revenue S$32 (× S$5.90) · profit S$76
Counter: labour saved − machine S$57

**NORMAL DAY**
0.2 orders kept
Revenue S$1 (× S$5.90) · profit S$58
Counter: labour saved − machine S$57

| A YEAR | PER OUTLET | 44 OUTLETS, IF ALL LOOKED LIKE THIS MODEL |
|---|---|---|
| **Orders kept** peak hour, busy and event days | **1,278** range −121 to 1,452 | **56,221** |
| **Revenue** orders × price | **S$7,539** range −S$832 to S$10,015 | **S$331,704** |
| Profit margin 50%–70%: −S$754 to +S$754 | S$24,660 | S$1,085,027 |
| Labour saving, counter labour saved − machine cost; shown on its own | S$20,136 | S$886,005 |

Revenue and labour are never added: revenue is orders × price; profit is orders × price × margin, plus labour saved, minus machine cost.

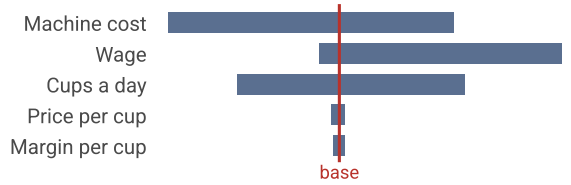
Calendar: 104 busy days (weekend days) and 11 event days (Singapore public holidays) a year: an illustrative definition, to confirm with Chagee; sliders on screen.

| ORDERS · PROFIT A YEAR | WALK-AWAY RULE | ECONOMIC RULE |
|---|---|---|
| Forecast crew | 1,242 · S$603 | 670 · S$1,711 |
| Machine | 888 · S$23,611 | 888 · S$23,611 |
| **Both, one run** | **1,278 · S$24,660** | **1,278 · S$24,660** |
| Both, today's split counter −S$305/month | 1,124 · −S$3,142 | 1,124 · −S$3,142 |

Walk-away rule: fewest people keeping peak-hour walk-aways within 2% (the forecast crew at 556 cups a day). Economic rule: add a person only when orders kept × price × margin beat the extra labour. "Both" is one run, not a sum: the levers keep many of the same orders, and with the machine the forecast crew needs fewer extra hours (−S$662 profit against the sum). Headline figures use the economic rule.

**Against what**
A flat normal-day roster and an all-by-hand counter. Chagee deploys people on local expertise (Chagee source, anonymous), so this baseline is ours, not Chagee's.

**All inputs at their worst/best end together**
Profit a year, one outlet: low **−S$15,660** · base **S$24,660** · high **S$101,166**




**Fragile: the minimum crew**
The counter lever rests on the model's minimum crew off-peak: 2 by hand, 1 with machines. Profit a year per outlet: S$24,660 with it; S$8,395 with 1 either way.

**Not sized**
Delivery levers (third-party; channel margins not disclosed), membership and CRM, waste (no inventory model in this deck), and the new-store site forecast (shown as cups added only).

**ASSUMED BASELINE** illustrative
Flat normal-day roster, all by hand: about **1,291** peak-hour orders a year walk away per outlet.

**PROPOSED SCENARIO** in our model
Both levers, one run: **1,278** kept a year per outlet, profit **S$1.09m** across 44 outlets (S$0.37m without the minimum-crew rule).

SPEAKER NOTES · THE BENEFIT IN DETAIL

Backup for the benefit slide. This answers part c of the brief: how big is the benefit, for Singapore only. Against what: a flat normal-day roster and an all-by-hand counter. Chagee deploys people on local expertise, the GM and outlet teams making the calls, so this baseline is ours, not Chagee's practice.

Lead with orders. On an event day the model keeps about 61 orders per outlet in the peak hour that would otherwise walk away, about S$358 of revenue; on a busy day about 5. Over a year it depends on how many such days there are: our illustrative calendar is 104 busy days, the weekends, and 11 event days, the public holidays. That is an input, not a measurement.

Profit is the second line, using a margin we assume because Chagee does not disclose one. The labour saving is shown separately and never added to revenue. The two levers are run together, not added, because they share the same labour hours. The strip at the top splits the profit: most is counter automation, physical AI, the machine on its own; the forecast, predictive AI, adds a small share on top.

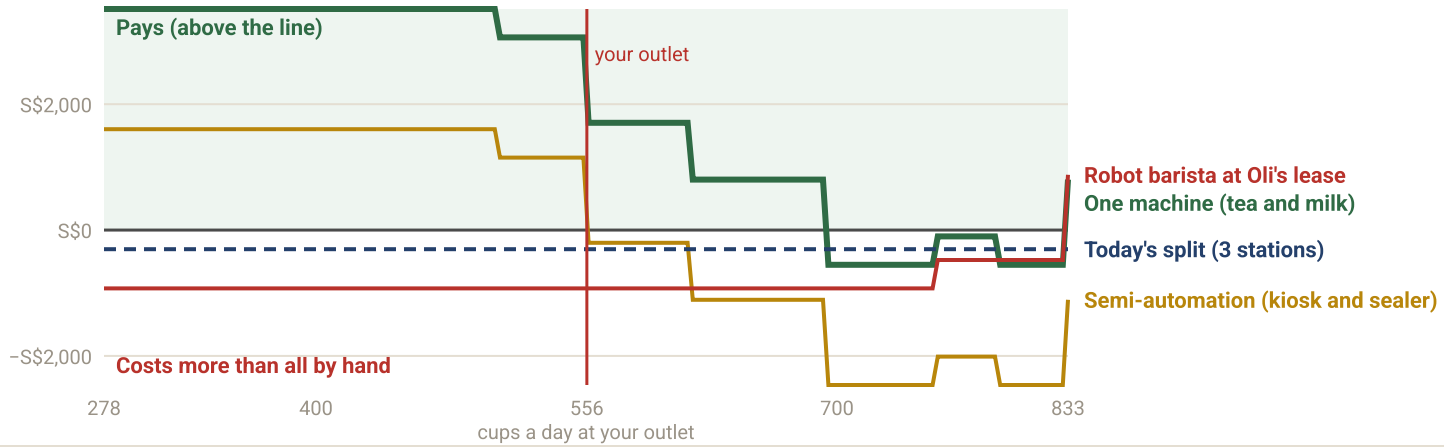
Two crew rules for rostering to the forecast. The walk-away rule adds people until peak-hour walk-aways are within 2%; at our default volume that is exactly the forecast crew. The economic rule adds a person only when the orders kept are worth more than the extra hours. They differ on busy days by hand, where the economic rule adds no one.

Be honest about fragility: most of the profit is the counter's labour saving, and it comes from the model's minimum crew, 2 by hand and 1 with machines. Drop that rule and the profit falls to about S$8,395 a year per outlet. And rostering to the forecast pays on event days, not on busy days, where the extra hours cost more than the orders won back. These are modelled avoided costs on stated assumptions, not demonstrated savings. About one minute.

# A machine pays only when it removes a person-shift for less than the shift costs

*To our knowledge, based on public sources; vendor list prices, not cost to implement. Chagee's equipment cost is not public; its Singapore relaunch used semi-automated equipment (Vulcan Post).*

NET GAIN A MONTH AGAINST ALL BY HAND · ONE OUTLET




Shown at 556 cups a day, wage S$15.06 an hour, S$1,909 a month per machine unit (sliders on screen).

| | 1 Semi-automation | 2 Beverage platform | 3 Milk-tea machine | 4 Robot arm | 5 Robot barista |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Gong Cha Singapore | Gong cha Super Wu | Amacha, one shop | Richtech ADAM | Oli; coffee-first |
| | *Not disclosed* | *Not disclosed* | S$10,000 to buy | *Not disclosed, rental only* | US$4,990/mo lease |
| | PRESS | COMPANY CLAIM | PRESS | VENDOR PAGE | VENDOR PAGE |

The model's S$1,909 a month is per station unit (our reading: a semi-automated station). Semi-automation and the beverage platform are priced at it because their real prices are not disclosed; robot prices are per setup. Full table and sources in the appendix.

START HERE

**One machine on the tea and milk**

+S$1,706 a month vs all by hand

Saves 8 person-hours a day (S$3,614 a month) for one S$1,909 unit. Simple payback, if it lets the roster drop one person-shift: 2.8 months on Amacha's S$10,000.

WATCH

**Today's 3-station split**

−S$305 a month vs all by hand

Saves 12 person-hours a day (S$5,422) but pays for 3 units (S$5,726).

WAIT FOR VOLUME

**Robots: arm or barista**

757+ cups a day before they save more labour than today's split (labour only, not a cost break-even)

At 556 cups, Oli's lease (S$6,350) is S$928 a month worse; a robot setup would need to cost under S$5,422 a month. The arm's price is not disclosed.

**Model assumption that drives all three:** minimum crew 2 by hand, 1 with machines, off-peak. Station speeds are the model's, not vendor claims. Rosters step in whole people, so results flip with volume and wage.

WITHOUT AI
our assumed baseline

All by hand at 556 cups a day: **24 person-hours** a day, **S$10,843** a month of labour.

WITH AI
our proposal

One tea-and-milk machine: **16 person-hours** a day, **+S$1,706** a month after its unit cost. A robot setup (four stations on machines) starts to save more labour than today's split at about 757 cups a day; labour only, not a cost break-even.

SPEAKER NOTES · MACHINE LADDER

Backup for the equipment page, for questions on which machine to buy. This is physical AI: automation and machines at the counter. The predictive AI is the forecast that sets the roster. One rule explains the whole slide: a machine pays only when it removes a person-shift, and costs less than that shift.

The chart shows the net gain a month against an all-by-hand counter as volume changes; above the line it pays. One tea-and-milk machine lets the roster drop from 2 people to 1 in 8 off-peak hours, about one person-shift a day, for one station unit: it pays across most of the range. Today's split saves 12 person-hours but pays for 3 units, so it ends up a little dearer than all by hand. A robot setup, four stations on machines, saves no more labour than today's split until about 757 cups a day. That is where extra labour saving begins, not a cost break-even; at Oli's lease it only pays at the top of our range.

Three things to say out loud. The minimum crew, 2 by hand and 1 with machines, is our model's assumption and drives this result. Every option runs at the model's station speeds, not vendor claims. Payback is simple payback, if the machine lets the roster drop one person-shift, with no installation, maintenance or financing. Chagee's own equipment cost is not public. About one minute.

Takeaway: At 556 cups a day: start with one machine (about +S$1,706 a month); today's 3-station split costs S$305 a month more than all by hand; robots save no more labour than today's split until about 757 cups a day.

APPENDIX · MACHINE LADDER, TIERS AND SOURCES

# Every rung, every price as published, and where it comes from

*To our knowledge, based on public sources. Physical AI: automation and machines. A gap is "not disclosed", never a guess.*

| RUNG | EXAMPLE | AUTOMATES · STEPS ON MACHINES (OUR MAPPING) | VENDOR LIST PRICE | CLAIMS (NOT MODEL INPUTS) | RELIABILITY | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 **Semi-automation** | Gong Cha Singapore | Sugar dispensers, cup sealers, self-order kiosks. **Order and tag, Shake and seal**. Kiosk = order and tag, sealer = shake and seal. Sugar dispensing sits inside tea and milk, so it is not modelled. | *Not disclosed* | Over 20% productivity from self-ordering; 5% manpower saving (no baseline given) | PRESS | https://www.ntuc.org.sg/uportal/news/Technology-Brewing-Up-the-Bubble-Tea-Business/ |
| 2 **Beverage platform** | Gong cha Super Wu (Feb 2026) | Dispenses tea, sweeteners and syrups; brewing and shaking stay manual. **Tea and milk** | *Not disclosed* | Up to 65% higher peak productivity | COMPANY CLAIM | https://marketech-apac.com/gong-cha-launches-gong-cha-2-0-to-modernise-global-operations-and-store-design/ |
| 3 **Single automated milk-tea machine** | Amacha (one small shop, owner interview) | Makes the milk tea itself. **Tea and milk** | S$10,000 to buy | The shop's total opening cost was S$209,000 (not a machine cost) | PRESS | https://www.malaymail.com/news/life/2026/10/05/opening-a-milk-tea-shop-in-singapore-can-rack-up-to-s209000-even-before-the-first-cup-is-poured/237715 |
| – | **Our scenario: today's split** | **Order and tag, Tea and milk, Shake and seal**. A scenario of ours (slides 09 and 10), not Chagee's disclosed setup | Model: S$1,909 a month per station unit | | OUR ASSUMPTION | assumptions.json |
| 4 **Robot arm that makes boba** | Richtech ADAM | Cup, ice, tea, toppings and sealing by one robot arm. **Cup and ice, Tea and milk, Toppings, Shake and seal** | *Not disclosed*. Rental only; price not published | – | VENDOR PAGE | https://richtechrobotics.com/solutions/adam |
| 5 **Robot barista** | Oli | A whole drink station in one unit. **Cup and ice, Tea and milk, Toppings, Shake and seal**. Coffee-first. No tea drinks listed for Oli or Artly. | US$59,000 (≈ S$75,078) to buy; US$4,990 (≈ S$6,350) a month lease | – | VENDOR PAGE | https://olirobotics.com/best-robot-barista |
| | Artly | | US$68,000–88,000 (≈ S$86,530–111,980) to buy; US$2,500–4,000 (≈ S$3,181–5,090) a month lease; US$2,500–4,000 a month software<br>Oli's estimate of a competitor. The figures as given do not say whether the lease replaces or adds to the purchase, so no verdict is computed. | – | VENDOR PAGE | https://olirobotics.com/best-robot-barista |
| | Cafe X | | US$250,000 (≈ S$318,125) to buy<br>Oli's estimate of a competitor's price. | – | VENDOR PAGE | https://olirobotics.com/best-robot-barista |
| – | **Chagee Singapore** | Chagee's own equipment cost is not public. Its Singapore relaunch used semi-automated equipment. | *Not public* | – | PRESS | https://vulcanpost.com/872176/chagee-singapore-comeback-after-sudden-exit/ |

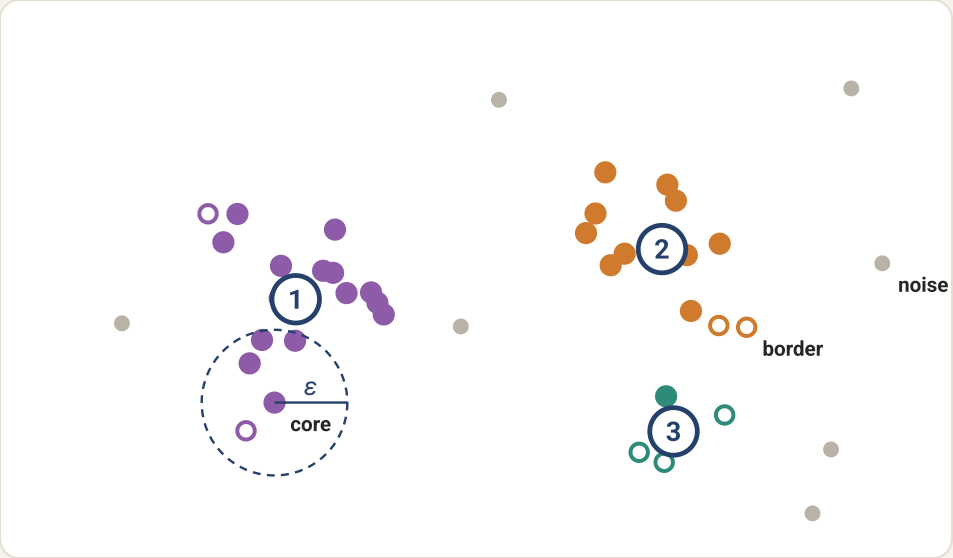
**Vendor list prices,** not cost to implement: installation, training, maintenance, power, space and import are not included; USD converts at S$1.2725 per US$. **Simple payback** = list price ÷ labour saved a month, with no maintenance or financing. **The model's S$1,909 a month** is per station unit: our reading: one semi-automated station unit (for example a dispenser or a cup sealer), amortised with upkeep. Not a robot barista lease; robot prices in machine_tiers.json are per setup. **Vendor speed and throughput claims** are listed, never used: every rung runs at the model's station speeds. **Steps on machines** is our mapping. Artly and Cafe X prices are Oli's estimates of competitors.

SPEAKER NOTES · MACHINE LADDER: TIERS AND SOURCES

Backup for the machine ladder. Every price is as the source publishes it; where a source gives no price we say not disclosed. Claims such as Gong cha's productivity figures are listed for context and are not inputs to our model. Soft copy only.

# DBSCAN finds where searches bunch up; a proximity model turns a pin into cups

## DBSCAN IN FOUR MOVES · TOY EXAMPLE




1. **Radius ε.** Two searches are neighbours if they are within ε of each other (the cluster-radius slider).
2. **Core.** A search with at least the minimum number of searches within ε (counting itself) is a core point.
3. **Grow.** A cluster spreads from core to core. Searches it reaches that are not core join as border points.
4. **Noise.** Searches no cluster reaches. Unlike k-means, nobody picks the number of clusters, and odd shapes are fine.

Unsupervised: no labels or past openings are needed. Ester, Kriegel, Sander and Xu (1996). On slide 06 it runs only on searches with no outlet within walking distance; each cluster's centre is a candidate site.

## THE SIMULATED NUMBERS, IN ORDER · AT THE SLIDER DEFAULTS

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **App searches** | Synthetic dots on land: 15% spread evenly, 35% around the outlets' malls, the rest around 20 towns | **3,000 dots** |
| 2 | **No store nearby** | The nearest outlet is further than the walking distance | **1 km · 46% of dots** |
| 3 | **DBSCAN** | Clusters the no-store-nearby dots | **ε 0.6 km · min 15 · 11 clusters** |
| 4 | **Pull of a store** | Fades with distance d: exp(−½ (d/L)²), with the length L set by the walking distance | **L = 1 km** |
| 5 | **Who buys where** | A dot buys at a store in proportion to its pull, against the pull of not buying (a store next door = one) | **not buying 0.3** |
| 6 | **Calibration** | Each dot's weight is set so the average outlet sells the deck's cups a day (cups a year ÷ open days) | **556 cups a day** |
| 7 | **Score a pin** | Cups for Chagee = what the new store sells − what it moves from nearby outlets | **top: 837 − 106 = +731** |
| 8 | **Verdict** | Share of the new store's cups that are new to Chagee | **strong ≥ 60% · weak < 40%** |
| 9 | **Opening roster** | Peak-hour cups ÷ cups one person handles, with the safety margin | **one per 83 cups** |

All synthetic: the dots, towns and weights are assumptions on the team's map (not to scale), not Chagee app logs or population data. With real app logs, steps one and two change; the rest runs unchanged.

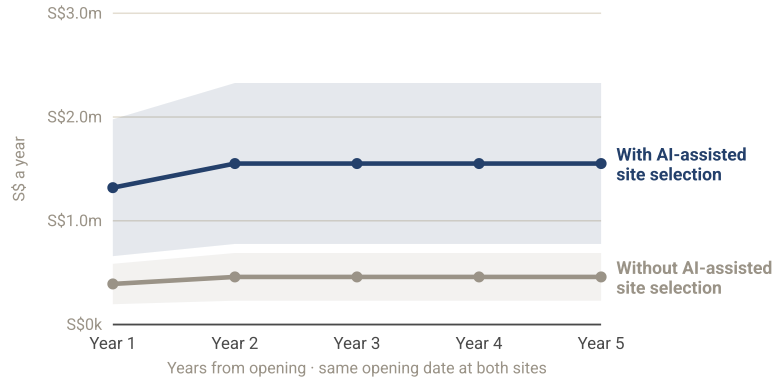
SPEAKER NOTES · HOW THE SITE FORECAST WORKS

Backup for questions on slide 06. Left: DBSCAN in four moves on a toy set. A search is a core point if enough searches sit within the radius; clusters grow from core to core; border points join; the rest is noise. We do not choose the number of clusters.

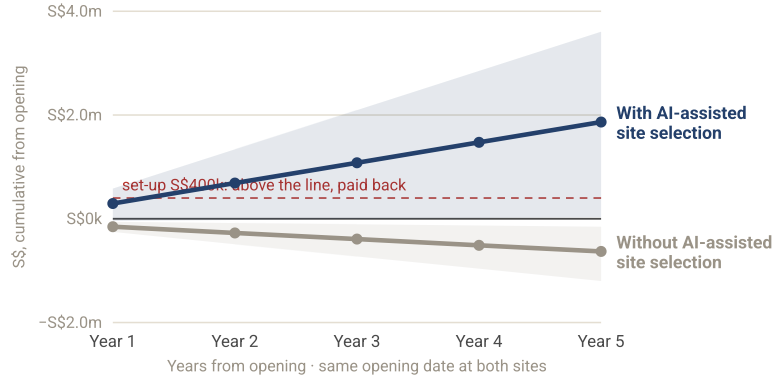
Right: every simulated number, in the order the model uses it. The forecast is only as good as these assumptions; with Chagee's real app logs, the first two rows would be replaced by data and the rest would run as is.

# Same new outlet, same opening, same counter: the AI site adds about S$2.5m more operating profit over 5 years, in our model

ANNUAL INCREMENTAL REVENUE TO CHAGEE, S$




CUMULATIVE INCREMENTAL OPERATING PROFIT, S$




THE BRIDGE, FIVE-YEAR TOTALS, BASE SCENARIO

| 5 YEARS, BASE SCENARIO | WITHOUT AI · +216 | WITH AI · +731 | DIFFERENCE |
|---|---|---|---|
| New-store sales | S$6.2m | S$8.6m | S$2.4m |
| − Sales displaced from nearby Chagee outlets | −S$4.0m | −S$1.1m | S$2.9m |
| **= Net additional network sales (incremental revenue)** | **S$2.2m** | **S$7.5m** | **S$5.3m** |
| − New-store ingredients, packaging and delivery commission | −S$3.1m | −S$4.2m | −S$1.2m |
| − New-store labour (same staffing rule) | −S$325k | −S$412k | −S$87k |
| − Machines, rent, utilities, maintenance | −S$1.4m | −S$1.4m | S$0k |
| + Nearby outlets' variable costs saved (their rent and staff stay) | S$2.0m | S$537k | −S$1.4m |
| − AI recurring cost (allocated) | S$0k | −S$120k | −S$120k |
| **= Incremental operating profit, before depreciation, interest and tax** | **−S$630k** | **S$1.9m** | **S$2.5m** |

Illustrative scenarios on our assumptions, not a demonstrated causal gain from AI. DBSCAN finds the search clusters; the assumed demand model estimates the sales. Shaded: the scenario range (our per-outlet volume range), not a confidence interval.

5-YEAR RESULTS · BASE · ILLUSTRATIVE

| | |
|---|---|
| Revenue uplift | S$5.3m |
| Operating-profit uplift | S$2.5m |
| Payback, with AI | 1.4 years |
| Payback, without AI | beyond year 5 |

Cumulative cash flow after the S$400k set-up (AI site S$460k). AI cost repaid in 2 months. Volume range: S$1.2m to S$3.8m profit uplift.

ASSUMPTIONS · S$ · REUSED UNLESS MARKED NEW

360 days · S$5.90 a cup, held flat · ingredients and packaging 40%
delivery 30% of cups at 30% · wage S$15.06 an hour, same staffing rule
rent S$15,000, utilities S$2,500, maintenance S$800 new a month · same machines
year-one ramp-up 85% new · growth 0.0% new · cost inflation 0.0% new
AI S$60k to build, S$24k a year, 100% on this outlet new · set-up S$400k, outside operating costs

TAKEAWAY

Beside the nearest outlet: **+216** net cups a day → about **S$2.2m** of network sales over 5 years, and **−S$630k** operating profit: the contribution lost at its neighbours outweighs what it makes. With AI-assisted site selection: **+731** net cups a day → about **S$7.5m** and **S$1.9m** after the AI costs: **S$2.5m** more profit than the baseline. Illustrative, not a proven causal gain.

SPEAKER NOTES · THE NEW STORE IN MONEY: FIVE-YEAR P&L

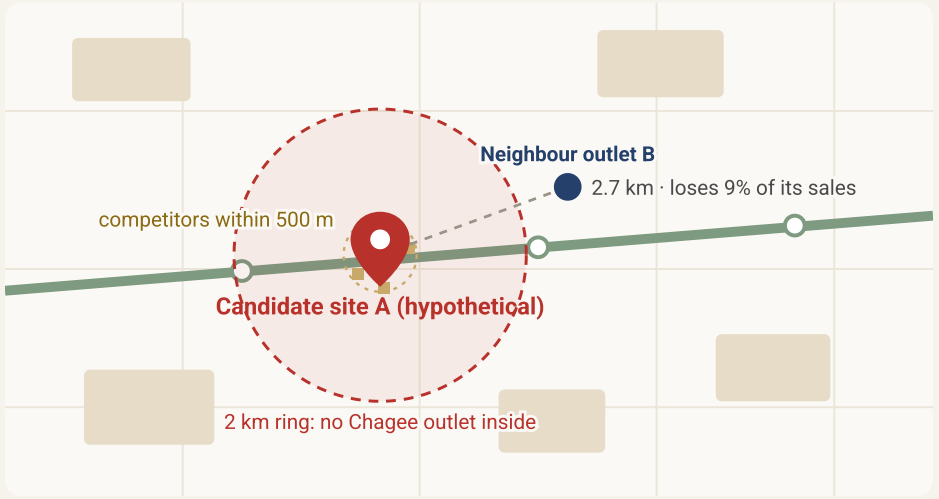
Soft copy and print companion of slide 06's P&L view, at the default inputs and the suggested site. The on-screen view updates with the selected site and the assumption sliders; this page shows the defaults.

Extension: where this scales next. Not included in the S$ benefit.

# Four scores for every location

*Corporate drops a pin; the model rates it on four things (illustrative). Decision owner here: the expansion manager.*

SCHEMATIC MAP · HYPOTHETICAL PINS




**Demand score** HAND-SET — 84
Residents, workers and transit riders within reach, plus footfall.

**Delivery demand score** HAND-SET — 78
Orders from the area on third-party delivery apps.
All Chagee delivery goes through third-party apps (anonymous Chagee source, to confirm), so we use area demand, not "served from a farther outlet". Whether the platforms share this data is to confirm.

**Competition score** HAND-SET — 61
Bubble-tea and cafe outlets within 500 m; dense competition lowers the score, a few prove demand.

**Cannibalisation factor** COMPUTED · SLIDE 06 ENGINE — −13
Site A: 13% of its cups would move from existing Chagee outlets; neighbour outlet B loses 9%. Deducted so the result is net to Chagee.

**Site score** WEIGHTED — 76
Demand 50%, delivery 20%, competition 30% (hand-set weights).

**ATTRIBUTES THE MODEL TAGS TO EACH PIN** residents and workers within 1 km · MRT and bus tap-ins · footfall · delivery orders from the area · competing outlets within 500 m · Chagee outlets within 2 km · rent per sq ft · staff needed at peak

**WHAT IS AI HERE** Scoring a pin from its attributes would be a supervised model trained on outlets' results: a production idea. Here the three scores are set by hand, and the cannibalisation factor is computed by the slide 06 engine on synthetic data. The next slide runs the supervised model.

Illustrative. Synthetic data, not Chagee data. Chagee's opening history is internal and we do not have it.

SPEAKER NOTES · FOUR SCORES FOR EVERY LOCATION

An extension: where this scales next, and not part of the benefit figure. The decision owner here is the expansion manager. This builds on Jin's site-selection framework.

Step through it. Corporate drops a pin; the model tags its attributes; three scores follow. Demand, delivery demand and competition are set by hand here, and you can drag a bar to test another value: in production, a supervised model would score them. We call the second one delivery demand, not delivery relief, because all Chagee delivery runs through third-party apps, according to an anonymous Chagee source; whether the platforms share this data is to confirm.

The cannibalisation factor is computed by the same engine as slide 06: about 13% of site A's cups would move from existing outlets. Switch to the pin with an outlet inside the ring, or the one beside an outlet, and watch it jump. All synthetic. About thirty-five seconds.

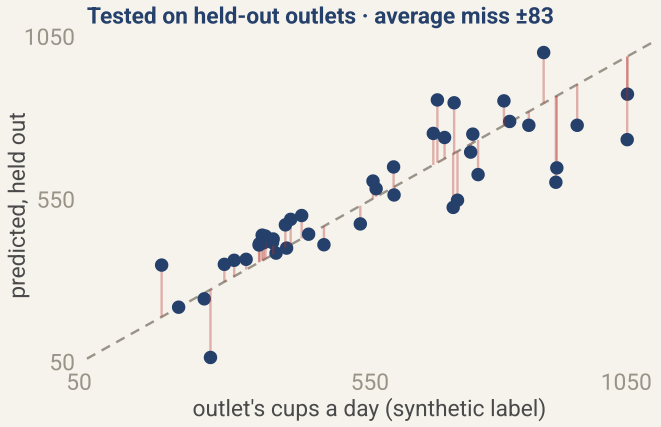
Extension: where this scales next. Not included in the S$ benefit.

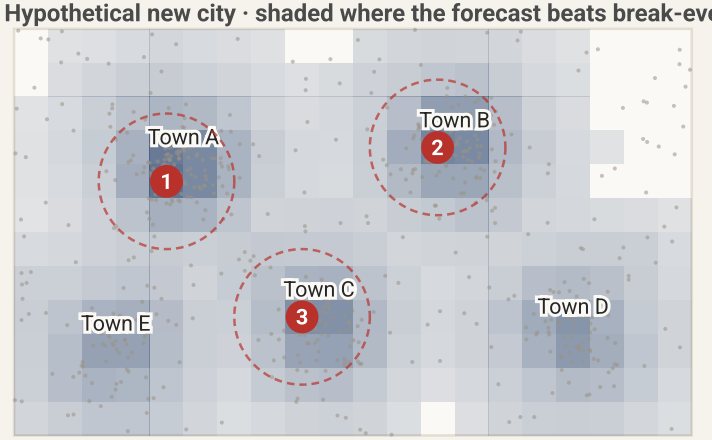
# Trained on Singapore's outlets, the model picks where to open in a city where Chagee has no data yet

*Supervised learning: keep only the inputs a new city has, test the model on outlets it has not seen, then let it score every spot in a hypothetical city (illustrative, synthetic).*

TRAIN ON 44 OUTLETS · TOGGLE THE INPUTS

- ☑ **People within reach** — NEW MARKET: HAS IT
- ☑ **Distance to a town centre** — NEW MARKET: HAS IT
- ☐ Delivery-area demand — NEW MARKET: TO CONFIRM
- ☐ Unserved app searches — NEW MARKET: NONE
- ☐ Chagee outlets nearby — NEW MARKET: NONE
- ☐ Distance to nearest Chagee outlet — NEW MARKET: NONE
- ⬚ Competitors within 500 m — NOT IN OUR DATA
- ⬚ Rent per sq ft — NOT IN OUR DATA




TESTED ON OUTLETS IT HAS NOT SEEN

**±83** cups a day, average miss

$R^2$ 0.76 with 2 inputs

| | |
|---|---|
| All inputs (Singapore) | ±41 · $R^2$ 0.95 |
| **New-market inputs only** | ±83 · $R^2$ 0.76 |
| No inputs: guess the average outlet | ±197 |

WHERE TO OPEN IN THE NEW CITY

1. Town A: ≈ **1,090** ± 83 · **above break-even even at 1,007** · **beyond what it learned**
2. Town B: ≈ **959** ± 83 · **above break-even even at 876**
3. Town C: ≈ **887** ± 83 · **above break-even even at 804**

Cups a day, forecast ± average miss. Break-even ≈ 275 at Singapore costs (the pin-to-profit slide), a stand-in. Picks ≥ 2 km apart.

**WHAT IS AI HERE** Supervised learning (ridge regression) from site attributes to cups a day. The labels are the slide 06 engine's synthetic outlets, so the fit flatters; Chagee's real opening history would fit worse. Using Singapore to score another market assumes its customers behave alike: check against the first outlets' actuals.

Illustrative. Synthetic data, not Chagee data. Chagee's opening history is internal and we do not have it.

SPEAKER NOTES · THE SUPERVISED MODEL

This is the model behind step three of the framework, actually running. It learns cups a day from a site's attributes, trained on Singapore's 44 outlets. The labels are synthetic, from the slide 06 engine, so read it as the method, not a forecast.

We test it fairly: each outlet is predicted by a model that never saw it. With every input, it misses by about 41 cups a day on average. Now the proxy for a new market: there is no Chagee app history and no outlet network yet, so switch those inputs off. With only population and distance to a town centre, the error grows to about 83 cups a day, still better than guessing the average outlet, about 197.

Then the point of it: where to open in a place with no local data. The right-hand map is a hypothetical city, generated at the same density as our Singapore data. With only the inputs that city has, the model scores every spot and picks the best sites at least 2 km apart, so they do not take sales from each other. Each pick shows its forecast with the error band, and whether it clears break-even at Singapore costs, which stand in until local costs are known. Picks beyond what the model saw in Singapore are flagged. So the model can travel, but only on inputs the new market has, with wide ranges: pilot the top site first and recheck the model against its actuals. That is the continual-learning step on the next slide. About fifty seconds.

Extension: where this scales next. Not included in the S$ benefit.

# From pin to net profit

*Six steps from a pin to a go / no-go, on profit net to Chagee overall (illustrative). Decision owner here: the expansion manager.*

**1 Pin a location**
Corporate clicks a point on the map.
NOT AI

**2 Tag attributes**
People, transit, footfall, delivery, competitors, outlets nearby, rent.
DATA

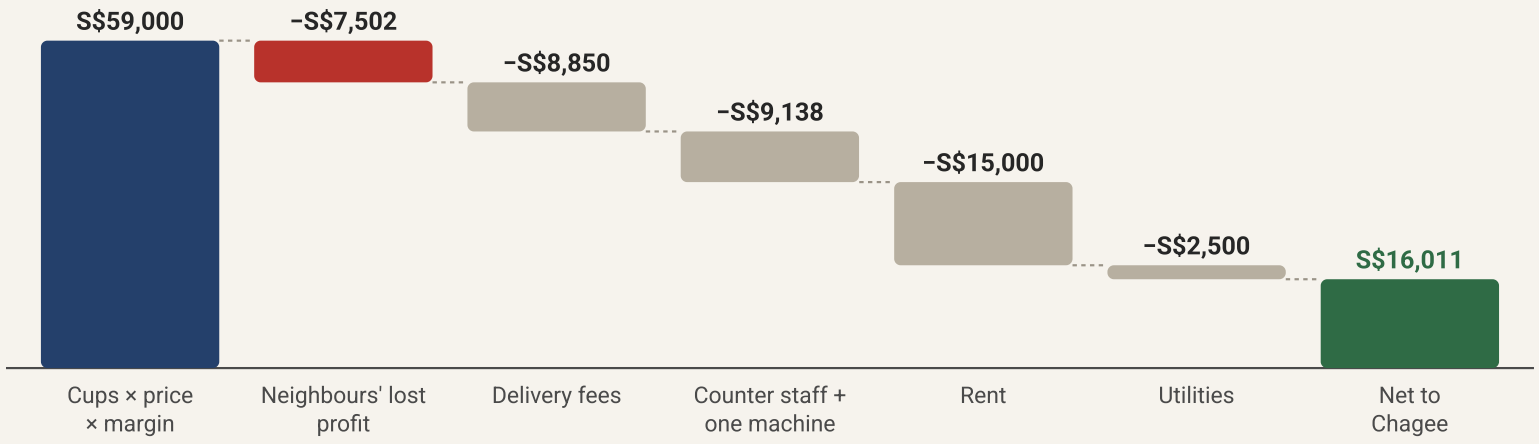
**3 Four scores**
Demand, delivery, competition, cannibalisation (previous slide).
AI · SUPERVISED MODEL

**4 Find look-alikes**
Anonymised outlets (Outlet 12, Outlet 27): their cups a day, what neighbours lost.
AI · SIMILARITY SEARCH

**5 Forecast net profit**
Cups a day, running cost, minus the profit neighbours lose.
COMPUTED BELOW

**6 Decide**
Open, pilot or skip. Actuals feed back: continual learning.
AI · CONTINUAL LEARNING

NET PROFIT TO CHAGEE, A MONTH · SITE A, TOP APP-SEARCH CLUSTER




At 278–833 cups a day: **−S$3,506** to **S$34,624** a month. Neighbour outlet B, 2.7 km away, loses 9% of its sales. Delivery fees: 30% of cups × 30% commission. Counter: the one-machine setup, normal-day roster (counter model).

STEP 6 · RECOMMENDATION

## Pilot

positive at 556 cups a day, negative at 278, the low end: test it before a full lease.

Site score **76 / 100 (four scores)**
Payback **≈ 25 months on S$400,000**

A strong-demand site can still fail if rent or staffing is too high, or if it mostly takes sales from our own neighbours.

In practice this needs Chagee's opening history. With about 44 outlets in Singapore the model must stay simple (few attributes, ranges not point values).

Illustrative. Synthetic data, not Chagee data. Chagee's opening history is internal and we do not have it. Cups a day, price and margin are the benefit slide's; rent, delivery, utilities and set-up cost are assumptions, not Chagee data.

SPEAKER NOTES · FROM PIN TO NET PROFIT

Six steps from a pin to a go or no-go. Steps three, four and six are where the AI would sit in production: a supervised model for the scores, a similarity search for look-alike outlets, and continual learning as each new outlet reports actuals. On this slide only step five is computed.

The waterfall starts from cups a day times price times margin, the same inputs as the benefit slide: 556 cups a day. Take off the profit neighbours lose, delivery fees, the counter, rent and utilities: about S$16,011 a month net to Chagee, a payback of about 25 months. At the low end of the cups range it loses money, so the call is: Pilot. Move rent, delivery or set-up cost and watch the call change; these are our assumptions, not Chagee data.

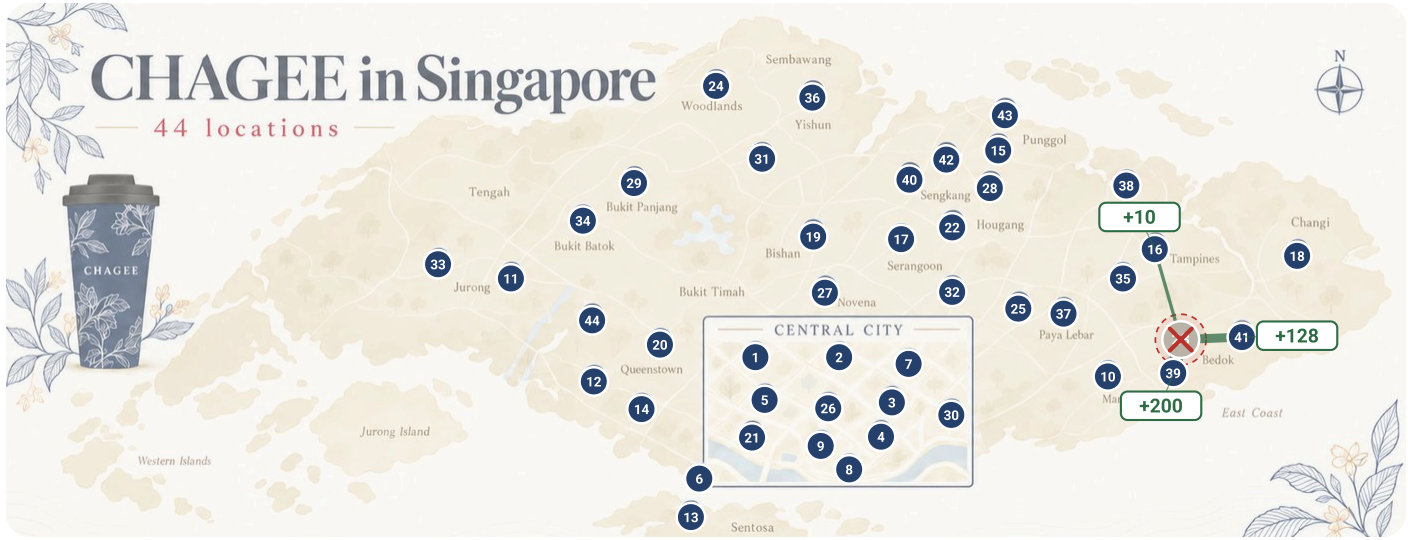
The honest point: switch to the pin with an outlet 1.7 km away. It takes 44% of its cups from our own outlets and comes out at −S$2,697 a month, a skip. About forty-five seconds.

Later: reuse in new markets via transfer learning, out of scope.

FURTHER APPLICATION · OPTIMISE THE EXISTING STORE NETWORK

# Where should we open, strengthen, relocate or consolidate?

The network view can also help investigate existing locations—not just choose new ones.




SELECTED OUTLET

## 23 · East Coast Road *temporarily unavailable*

about 561 cups a day today (model) · nearest outlet 1.4 km away

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO · NOT A CLOSURE RECOMMENDATION

| | |
|---|---|
| Demand potentially retained by nearby outlets | **355 a day · 63%** |
| Demand potentially lost to Chagee | **206 a day · 37%** |
| Customer travel, for those who move | **1.1 km → 1.3 km** |
| Additional workload at receiving outlets | |
| 39 · Bedok Mall | **+200 · 46% more** |
| 41 · Sceneca Square | **+128 · 18% more** |
| 16 · Tampines 1 | **+10 · 1% more** |

Same demand model as the new-store forecast, run in reverse; it has no capacity limit, so receiving outlets' service levels need checking.

EVIDENCE NEEDED BEFORE A REAL DECISION

- Costs actually avoided, lease commitments and exit costs
- Capacity and service levels at nearby outlets
- Customer willingness to switch locations
- Customer access and the store's strategic role

MANAGER'S DECISION · EXPANSION MANAGER

Does this location need operational improvement, relocation or a deeper consolidation review?

**Caution ·** Low sales alone do not justify closure. DBSCAN identifies demand clusters; closure or relocation decisions require a separate network and financial assessment. No closure savings are added to any financial total in this deck.

SPEAKER NOTES · FURTHER APPLICATION: EXISTING OUTLETS

A further application of the expansion network view, opened from the expansion manager's decision slide. New-store selection stays the main story; this shows the same model looking at an existing outlet instead. The printed scenario takes the outlet whose nearest neighbour is closest and makes it temporarily unavailable: the demand model, run in reverse, splits its cups between nearby outlets and customers lost to Chagee, and compares how far customers travel before and after.

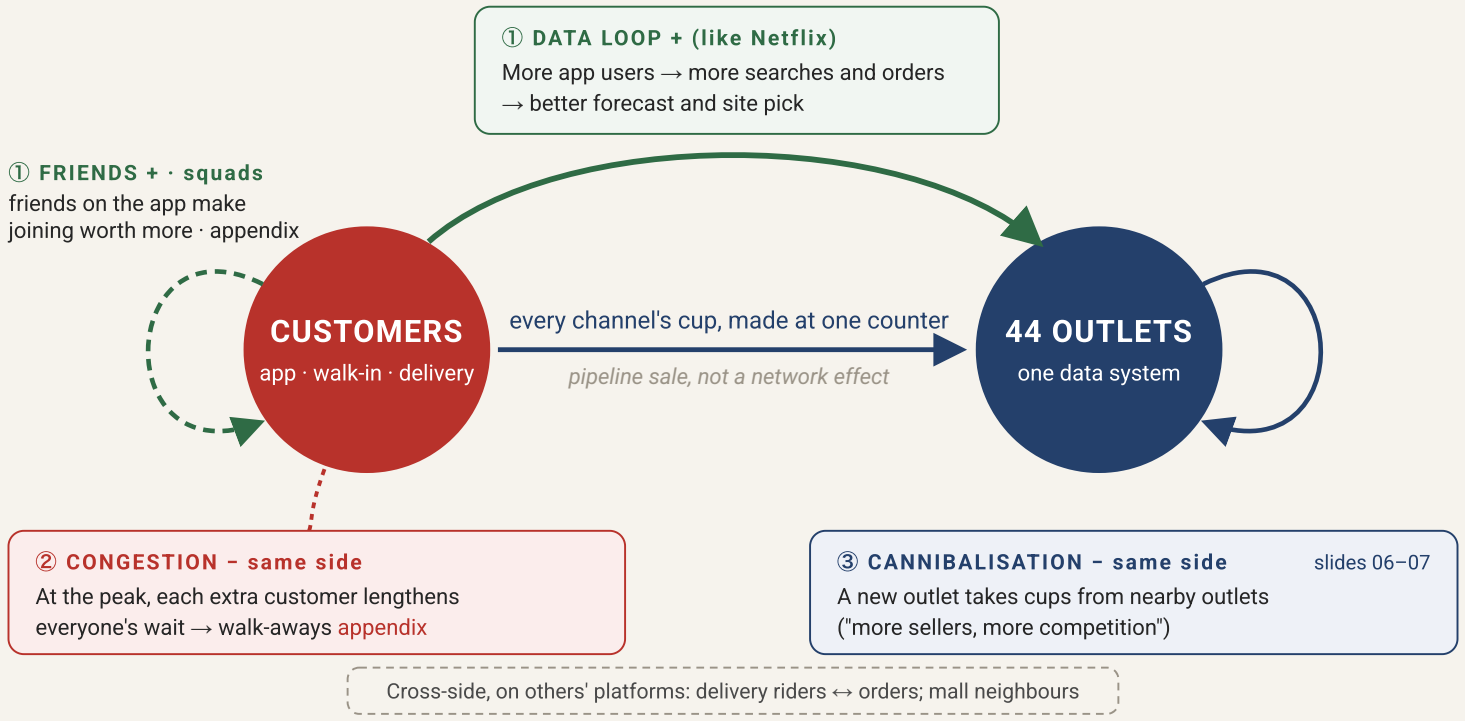
It is an illustrative scenario, not a closure recommendation. The model has no capacity limit, so the extra work at receiving outlets needs checking against their real capacity and service levels. Low sales alone do not justify closure: a real decision needs costs actually avoided, lease and exit costs, customers' willingness to switch, nearby capacity, customer access and the store's strategic role. DBSCAN identifies demand clusters; closure or relocation needs a separate network and financial assessment, and no closure savings are added to any total.

Course link · cross-side vs same-side network effects (eBay)

# Chagee's network effects sit on the customer side: we grow the friend and data loops, then cap the crowding they bring

*Our reading: Chagee sells its own tea, so there is no seller side to match. Part one grows the positive loops; parts two and three cap the crowding.*

WHERE CHAGEE SITS ON THE DIAGRAM · CLICK A LOOP




① GROW · PART ONE · APPENDIX

**Make friends worth more, feed the data loop**

Squads: friends taking part raise the features' value (not AI). **Why Chagee:** app-first and member-led: **257 million** members group-wide; repeat members place **more than 78%** of orders (earnings call, Aug 2026; SG to confirm).

② CAP · PART TWO · APPENDIX

**Absorb the peak crowd**

Forecast crew plus a bucket brigade: event day walk-aways **54%** → **1.2%** of peak-hour orders.

③ CAP · PART THREE · SLIDES 06–07

**Count cups added, not sold**

Of 837 cups at the new site, **106** (13%) move from nearby outlets. The score subtracts them.

NOT OUR LEVER

Delivery apps and malls own the cross-side effects; their riders still count in our peak.

**Takeaway** | Grow the friend and data loops, then make sure the counter and the outlet map can absorb the extra customers.

SPEAKER NOTES · NETWORK EFFECTS ACROSS THE THREE PARTS

This is how the three parts use network effects. A lens from the course: on eBay, buyers and sellers attract each other, a cross-side effect. Chagee is not that, in our reading: it sells its own tea, so customers to outlets is a pipeline sale. Its network effects sit on the customer side.

Two we grow, in part one. Friends: with squads, each friend on the app makes joining worth more to the others; the members slides in the appendix model that with an effort score and test whether it pays. That part is analytics and product design, not AI. And the data loop: more app use gives more search and order data, so the forecast and the site pick get sharper. That is why we chose Chagee: on its second-quarter 2026 call it reported 257 million registered members, and members with two or more purchases placed more than 78% of orders. Group-wide figures; Singapore's app share is to confirm.

Two we cap. Part two, congestion: at the peak every extra customer lengthens everyone's wait; a normal-day roster on an event day loses about 54% of peak-hour orders, and a forecast crew with a bucket brigade brings it to about 1.2%. Part three, cannibalisation: a new outlet takes cups from its neighbours; of 837 cups at the app-search site, 106 move from nearby outlets.

Cross-side effects exist, but on others' platforms, delivery apps and malls: not our lever. And we do not carry any modelled membership uplift into the counter or outlet numbers; each part stands on its own assumptions. About fifty seconds.

# Where every number comes from

## FACTS QUOTED

**Outlets in Singapore: 44**. Store count used on the storyboard deck. The doc also cites 46 (VnExpress, earlier); the later directory count is used. *[L-sg-directory]*

**Global context, group-wide, not Singapore: franchise share of FY2025 net revenue: 0.88**. Secondary source; flagged wherever shown. GROUP-WIDE: global context only, never applied to Singapore (Singapore is company-owned, I-sg-owned). *[L-koalagains]*

**Global context, group-wide, not Singapore: company-owned share of FY2025 net revenue: 0.12**. Secondary source; flagged wherever shown. GROUP-WIDE: global context only, never applied to Singapore (Singapore is company-owned, I-sg-owned). *[L-koalagains]*

**Registered members, group-wide, end of June 2026: 257000000**. Company statement on the Q2 2026 earnings call (COO, interpreted). Group-wide, not Singapore. Membership is on Chagee's mobile mini program (L-chagee-q1-2025). *[L-chagee-q2-2026-call]*

**Orders from members with two or more purchases, group-wide (more than): 0.78**. Company statement on the Q2 2026 earnings call. A floor ('more than 78%'). Group-wide, not Singapore. *[L-chagee-q2-2026-call]*

## SOURCES

**L-sg-directory** Chagee Singapore store directory, mapped by the team (44 locations, checked 15 Oct 2026); Mothership, Sep 2026, https://mothership.sg/2026/09/chagee-more-heartland-stores-singapore-eugene-lee/ gives the same count. Taken from the team's ideation doc (OPIM 639_ Ideation Process), not re-checked for this deck.

**I-sg-owned** PROJECT OWNER CONFIRMATION (23 Oct 2026): Chagee Singapore operates a company-owned model, not a franchise model. Confirmed by the project owner; not from the anonymous Chagee contact and not an external citation. Used on slide 01 (headline, step 1, card, notes). Supersedes the earlier 'ownership not claimed' framing. It does not change the group-wide revenue shares, which stay global context only.

**L-koalagains** KoalaGains, 'CHA business and moat', https://koalagains.com/stocks/NASDAQ/CHA/business-and-moat (SECONDARY - flag when used): FY2025 net revenue about 88% from the franchise (master franchise) model and about 12% from company-owned stores, the latter growing fastest. Taken from the team's ideation doc (OPIM 639_ Ideation Process), not re-checked for this deck.

**L-yfchuhai** YF Chuhai, https://www.yfchuhai.com/article/9751.html: Chagee's leaf supply chain is in China; it sources only two ingredients locally, fresh milk and fruit. Taken from the team's ideation doc (OPIM 639_ Ideation Process), not re-checked for this deck.

**L-sec20f** Chagee Holdings Form 20-F for FY2025, SEC EDGAR, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/2013649/000110465926050766/cha-20251231x20f.htm: separate centralized and regional warehouses to lower storage and logistics costs. Taken from the team's ideation doc (OPIM 639_ Ideation Process), not re-checked for this deck.

**L-unsw** UNSW BusinessThink, Oct 2024: Chagee semi-automation, baristas scan a QR code and the machine dispenses the formulation. (brief.md section 9)

**I-chagee-contact** CHAGEE SOURCE, ANONYMOUS (Oct 2026): a Chagee source who asked not to be named; do not identify them. Four points only: whether Singapore outlets are owned, a joint venture or franchised does not matter for this work, because the data sits in one system; Singapore outlets run under one company and one data system; all delivery is via third-party apps; people are deployed on local expertise: the GM and outlet teams make the staffing calls. Ownership itself is not attributed to this source: see I-sg-owned (project owner confirmation).

**I-sg-groundfloor** INFORMAL - quote in the team's ideation doc (Chagee Singapore's Lee: 'Whenever you see a Chagee, it's always on the first floor'; kiosk-style outlets in basements and MRT stations at entry in 2019). The article is not named in the doc; confirm the source before quoting.

**I-team-app-first** INFORMAL - team observation in the ideation doc: Chagee Singapore sells mainly through its app, with minimal order kiosks in outlets. Confirm before citing. SUPERSEDED on slide 01 (22 Oct 2026) by P-appstore, P-vulcanpost-comeback and L-sec20f-data; the app's share of orders stays to confirm.

**L-ester1996** Ester, M., Kriegel, H.-P., Sander, J. and Xu, X. (1996). A density-based algorithm for discovering clusters in large spatial databases with noise. Proceedings of the Second International Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (KDD-96), 226-231. The DBSCAN algorithm used on slide 14.

**P-honeycombers** PRESS - in-store sightings, indicative. Honeycombers (Feb 2026), https://thehoneycombers.com/singapore/china-bubble-tea-brand-singapore/ : Chagee price sightings in Singapore; not a current full menu.

**P-eatbook** PRESS - in-store sightings, indicative. Eatbook (Aug 2024), https://eatbook.sg/?p=168476 : Chagee price sightings in Singapore; not a current full menu, and older than the deck.

**I-team-expansion** INFORMAL - team research (Oct 2026): Chagee is looking to expand rapidly in Singapore; how many stores it is going for is confidential. Singapore only. Confirm before citing.

**I-team-site-framework** TEAM WORK (Oct 2026): Jin's site-selection framework, two team slides ('Four Scores for Every Location', 'From Pin to Profit Forecast'): four scores per pin, six steps from a pin to a go / no-go on profit net to Chagee. Used for the appendix pin-to-profit page (earlier extension). Its example values and outlet names are not used; ours are illustrative.

**L-chagee-q2-2026-call** Chagee (CHA) Q2 2026 Earnings Call, full transcript, TradingKey, 29 Aug 2026 (local copy: 'Chagee (CHA) Q2 2026 Earnings Call_ Profit Margin Improves as Overseas GMV Doubles.pdf', supplied by the team). COO's remarks, interpreted: 'As of the end of June, our total registered members reached 257 million. The repurchase rate among active members remain above 43%, while members who made 2 or more purchases accounted for more than 78% of total orders.' Group-wide, not Singapore. The page's AI summary is not used; the quote is from the transcript.

**L-chagee-q1-2025** Chagee Holdings, 'Chagee Announces First Quarter 2025 Unaudited Financial Results', GlobeNewswire, 30 May 2025 (local copy supplied by the team; the team's link https://investor.chagee.com/node/6736/pdf blocks automated access, so not checked by us). 'Chagee's Mobile Mini Program had a total of 192.4 million registered members as of March 31, 2025'; active members = registered members who placed an order at least once in a period. Shows that membership sits on Chagee's ordering app. Group-wide.

**P-appstore** CHAGEE app, App Store listing (team research, Oct 2026; no link supplied, not checked by us): 'Order and pay digitally', 'Order for self-pickup ahead of time', 'Locate our outlets and their operating hours'. The listing seen was the Saudi storefront; its privacy-policy URL includes 'SGMY' (our reading: Singapore and Malaysia, an inference). Privacy label: Precise Location under 'Data Not Linked to You'; search history not listed.

**P-vulcanpost-comeback** PRESS - Vulcan Post, Jayme Teo, 2 Oct 2024, https://vulcanpost.com/872176/chagee-singapore-comeback-after-sudden-exit/ : after the reopening, with some customers 'waiting for as long as an hour to receive their orders', 'the brand rolled out in-app ordering and delivery and constantly upgraded the ordering process.' Its 'kiosks' are a store format ('pivoting from their takeaway kiosks for comfortable dine-in, sit-down tea bars'), not ordering kiosks. Quotes checked by us, 22 Oct 2026.

**L-sec20f-data** Chagee Holdings Form 20-F for FY2025 (same filing as L-sec20f), risk factors: 'Our business generates and processes personal, transactional and other data.' and 'we may not be able to use our membership program to deepen our understanding of our target consumers.' No share of orders by app or mini program, and nothing on search or location data, in the parts we read. Quotes checked by us, 22 Oct 2026.

**L-sec20f-member** Chagee Holdings Form 20-F for FY2025 (same filing as L-sec20f), Item 3.D risk factor 'We may not be successful in expanding our membership and our ability to take advantage of our membership program may be limited.' Both quoted sentences checked word for word by us against the SEC EDGAR filing, 22 Oct 2026.

**C-topic8** OPIM639 course slides, Topic 8 (slides08 Service Platforms), slides 30-36: the economy with network effects, r(x) = 1 - x, f(z) = z, equilibria z' and z". Slide 34 quoted word for word, checked by us against the course file, 22 Oct 2026.

SPEAKER NOTES · SOURCES AND ASSUMPTIONS

Soft copy only.

# Every Australian input is a scenario assumption

## STATUS

Australia worked example, kept separate from every other section: nothing here feeds the main story (slides 01 to 16) or the benefit and nothing in them is changed. Every Australian input is a scenario assumption; no Australian data has been retrieved for this deck. Archetype areas stand in for real suburbs until Census and market data are pulled. Market status: no local Chagee operating history (assumed for this worked example).

## CANDIDATE AREAS (ARCHETYPES, SCENARIO ASSUMPTIONS)

**A · CBD office core**: residents within 1 km 12, workers within 1 km 90, tertiary students within 1 km 15, household income index 115, transit access 0.95, competitors within 500 m 9, rent, a$ a month 22000

**B · University precinct**: residents within 1 km 18, workers within 1 km 20, tertiary students within 1 km 40, household income index 80, transit access 0.75, competitors within 500 m 6, rent, a$ a month 12000

**C · Suburban rail interchange**: residents within 1 km 25, workers within 1 km 12, tertiary students within 1 km 5, household income index 95, transit access 0.7, competitors within 500 m 4, rent, a$ a month 10000

**D · Outer-suburb shopping centre**: residents within 1 km 20, workers within 1 km 5, tertiary students within 1 km 2, household income index 90, transit access 0.35, competitors within 500 m 2, rent, a$ a month 8000

## FEATURES AND WHERE REAL VALUES WOULD COME FROM (NONE RETRIEVED)

**Residents within 1 km**: stands in for walk-in demand from people living nearby; source to pull: national census, usual residents by small area.

**Workers within 1 km**: stands in for weekday lunch and after-work demand; source to pull: census place-of-work counts.

**Tertiary students within 1 km**: stands in for the young, app-first customer base; source to pull: university and TAFE enrolment by campus.

**Household income index**: stands in for willingness to pay for a premium tea; source to pull: census median household income.

**Transit access**: stands in for footfall past the counter; source to pull: public-transport timetable data, services per hour at the nearest stops.

**Competitors within 500 m**: stands in for rival bubble-tea and cafe supply (lowers the score); source to pull: business listings or a map-places count.

**Rent, A$ a month**: stands in for local cost (lowers the score); source to pull: retail lease listings or an agent quote.

**Left out**: chagee app searches nearby (needs Chagee app users in the market); delivery orders from the area (needs Chagee on the local delivery platforms); distance to the nearest chagee outlet (there is none yet); sales of existing chagee outlets nearby (there are none yet). They need existing Chagee activity. Missing is unknown, not zero: they are left out, never set to zero, so no area is marked down for a gap every area shares.

## INPUTS (ASSUMPTIONS.JSON NEW_MARKET)

**weights**: residents k 1, workers k 1, students k 1, income index 0.5, transit index 1, competitors 0.5, rent month 0.5 relative weight per feature in the suitability score (0-2) (range 0, 2). Our judgement, illustrative. The new-market ranking slide lets you move each; the sensitivity check re-ranks with each weight set to zero and doubled.

**sensitivity**: low 0, high 2 multipliers applied to one weight at a time. One-at-a-time sensitivity: each weight times zero (dropped) and times two; the rank range is reported per area.

**demand scenarios**: store.cups per store per year range and value / store.open days per year cups a day: low, base, high. Placeholder scale only: the Singapore per-outlet volume assumption (itself an assumption, not Chagee data) reused for every Australian area. The score does not set cups: without a calibration from real outlets, every area faces the same range.

**forecast error**: -0.3, 0, 0.3 share by which the pre-opening forecast misses realised cups a day (range -0.5, 0.5). Scenario assumption: before opening, the forecast cannot know actual demand. Under-forecast, exact, over-forecast.

**day mix**: moderate 104, large 12 busy and event days a year; the rest of store.open_days_per_year are normal days. Scenario assumption for the Australian pilot: busy days = weekend days; event days = a guess at local public holidays and events, not counted. Weights the year-average contribution on the new-market setup slide.

**wage per hour**: 36 AUD per hour worked, fully loaded (range 30, 45). Scenario assumption, not sourced. Replace with the applicable award rate plus on-costs before use.

**machine cost per unit per month**: 2000 AUD per station machine unit per month (range 700, 4000). Scenario assumption, not sourced; the Singapore figure is also an assumption and no exchange rate is applied.

**price per cup**: 8.5 AUD per cup, in store (range 7, 10). Scenario assumption, not sourced. Check menu prices in the pilot city.

**utilities per month**: 3000 AUD per outlet per month (range 2000, 4500). Scenario assumption, not sourced.

**setups**: all hand, heading storyboard.split_presets keys compared. Human-only against machine-made drink, as on slide 11; same station speeds and staffing rule (sim/counter.js).

**cannibalisation**: overlap km 5, max share 0.3 for a second opening: share of a new outlet's cups taken from the pilot, falling linearly to zero at overlap_km. Scenario assumption. Zero for the first opening: no Chagee outlet is in any catchment.

**trigger weeks**: 4 consecutive weeks a pilot signal must hold before acting. Our judgement, illustrative.

**currency**: AUD . Every money figure on the new-market slides and the new-market pilot slide is in Australian dollars (A$). No exchange rate is applied to any Singapore figure.

**Reused from the Singapore sections, labelled where used**: gross margin per cup (storyboard), the per-outlet volume range (store) as the placeholder demand scale, open hours and days, the hourly demand shape, day-type multipliers, station seconds, staffing rule and minimum crews (sim/counter.js, unchanged).

## METHOD (SIM/NEWMARKET.JS)

**Score**: each feature min-max scaled across the areas (turned round for competitors and rent), weighted mean out of 100. **Sensitivity**: each weight dropped, then doubled, one at a time. **Counter**: equipment sized for the base scenario; realised demand reaches the peak hour as a multiplier on the base arrivals; without AI, one crew all day, set for a normal day's planned peak; with AI, the forecast roster for the day type, the forecast missing realised demand by the stated error. **Contribution**: served cups x price x margin, less labour, machine units, rent and utilities, a day; the peak-hour walk-away share is applied to the busiest hours, other hours assumed served. **Worst case**: the lowest year-average contribution over demand scenarios and forecast errors, with AI staffing.

## CLAIMS WE DID NOT MAKE

No Australian data and no Chagee data are used. The areas are archetypes, not suburbs. The score is not a sales forecast; the supervised site model is not validated for Australia. No figure on the new-market slides feeds the main story or the benefit.

SPEAKER NOTES · NEW MARKET: INPUTS AND METHOD

Soft copy only. Backup for the new-market slides: every new-market input, how the numbers are worked out, and what we do not claim.